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DRINKS MODULE OVERVIEWS

Version 3.5.2

Product Guide



FRONTISPIECE

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This product information relates to:

Drinks Modules Version 3.5.2

Contents

CHAPTER 1 DRINKS SALES ANALYSIS OVERVIEW	1-1
INTRODUCTION	1-2
RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER MODULES.....	1-3
COMPANY PROFILE	1-4
THE SALES HISTORY DATABASE.....	1-5
UPDATES AND PROCESSING	1-6
ENQUIRIES	1-7
REPORTS.....	1-8
UTILITIES	1-9
PREREQUISITES	1-10
MODULE CONFIGURATION	1-11
<i>Expert Menu Codes</i>	1-14
<i>Installing Application Manager PTF's</i>	1-14
CHAPTER 2 DRINKS UK BONDED INVENTORY OVERVIEW	2-1
INTRODUCTION	2-2
RELATIONSHIPS WITH OTHER MODULES	2-3
MAINTENANCE.....	2-4
PROCESSING.....	2-5
ENQUIRIES	2-6
REPORTS.....	2-7
UTILITIES	2-8
PRE-REQUISITES.....	2-9
BASIC DATA.....	2-10
<i>Installing Application Manager PTF's</i>	2-11
CHAPTER 3 DRINKS DRP OVERVIEW	3-1
INTRODUCTION	3-2
RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER MODULES	3-3
MODULE CONFIGURATION	3-4
<i>Consumption of Forecast</i>	3-5
<i>Distribution Orders</i>	3-8
<i>Calendar Parameters</i>	3-9
MAINTENANCE OF REFERENCE DATA	3-10
<i>Periods</i>	3-11
<i>Stockrooms</i>	3-12
<i>Customers</i>	3-13
<i>Supply Networks</i>	3-14
<i>Item Master Details</i>	3-15
<i>Planner Codes</i>	3-16
FORECAST MANIPULATION	3-17
PROCESSING.....	3-18
<i>The DRP Cycle</i>	3-19
Review DC Forecasts	3-20
Evaluate DC Demand	3-21
Confirm Suggestions	3-22
Create Local Purchase Orders	3-23
Create Distribution Orders.....	3-24
Run Central Supply Plan	3-25
Create Purchasing / Production Orders	3-26
<i>Processing Options</i>	3-27

Full regeneration	3-28
Net Change	3-29
Selective Processing	3-31
<i>DRP Cycle Summary</i>	3-32
<i>Confirm Shipment Receipt</i>	3-33
ENQUIRIES	3-34
REPORTS	3-35
IMPLEMENTATION GUIDE	3-36
PREREQUISITES	3-37
MODULE CONFIGURATION	3-38
IMPLEMENTATION PROCEDURE	3-41
A RECOMMENDED PATH	3-43
PLANNING AND PREPARATION	3-45
<i>Entering Basic Data</i>	3-46
<i>Using Drinks Distribution Requirements Planning</i>	3-47
<i>Installing Application Manager PTF's</i>	3-48
CHAPTER 4 DRINKS EDI APPLICATION INTERFACE OVERVIEW	4-1
INTRODUCTION	4-2
OVERVIEW	4-3
PREMENOS EDI	4-4
RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER APPLICATIONS	4-6
APPLICATION CONFIGURATION	4-7
PROCESSING CYCLE	4-9
<i>Third Party Trading Partners</i>	4-11
CHAPTER 5 DRINKS INVENTORY MANAGEMENT OVERVIEW	5-1
INTRODUCTION	5-2
RELATIONSHIPS TO OTHER MODULES	5-3
OVERALL IMPLEMENTATION CONSIDERATIONS	5-4
<i>Drinks Inventory Management and other Modules</i>	5-5
<i>Drinks Inventory Management Companies</i>	5-7
MODULE CONFIGURATION	5-8
MAINTENANCE	5-9
PROCESSING	5-14
<i>Initial Stock Balance Take-On</i>	5-15
<i>Movement Transactions</i>	5-16
<i>Stock Counting</i>	5-18
<i>Stock Management</i>	5-21
PACKAGING REQUIREMENTS	5-24
ENQUIRIES	5-25
REPORTS	5-26
<i>Installing Application Manager PTF's</i>	5-27
CHAPTER 6 DRINKS US BONDED INVENTORY OVERVIEW	6-1
INTRODUCTION	6-2
RELATIONSHIPS WITH OTHER MODULES	6-3
MAINTENANCE	6-4
PROCESSING	6-6
INQUIRIES	6-7
REPORTS	6-8
UTILITIES	6-9
PRE-REQUISITES	6-10
<i>Basic Data</i>	6-11
<i>Installing Application Manager PTF's</i>	6-12
CHAPTER 7 DRINKS SALES ORDER PROCESSING OVERVIEW	7-1

INTRODUCTION	7-2
RELATIONSHIPS TO OTHER MODULES	7-3
<i>What Does It Do?</i>	7-4
<i>Using Drinks Sales Order Processing</i>	7-6
MODULE CONFIGURATION	7-7
<i>Company Profile</i>	7-8
MODULE REFERENCE DATA.....	7-9
ORDER PROCESSING CYCLE.....	7-13
<i>Enter Order Details</i>	7-14
<i>Stock Allocation</i>	7-15
<i>Pricing, Discounting and Credit Checking</i>	7-16
<i>Picking and Despatching</i>	7-20
<i>Invoicing</i>	7-21
ENQUIRIES	7-23
REPORTS	7-24
INITIAL DATA TAKE-ON	7-25
PREPARATION	7-26
<i>Entering Basic Data</i>	7-27
<i>Installing Application Manager PTF's</i>	7-28
CHAPTER 8 DRINKS PURCHASE MANAGEMENT OVERVIEW	8-1
INTRODUCTION	8-2
RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER MODULES.....	8-3
FEATURE INTEGRATION	8-6
DRINKS PURCHASE MANAGEMENT INTERFACES.....	8-7
CONFIGURATION	8-8
IMPLEMENTATION PROCEDURE.....	8-9
OPERATIONAL CONSIDERATIONS	8-10
MAINTENANCE OF REFERENCE DATA	8-12
PROCESSING.....	8-15
<i>Creating Orders</i>	8-16
RECEIVING GOODS.....	8-18
INVOICE MATCHING.....	8-20
ENQUIRIES	8-21
REPORTS.....	8-22
UTILITIES	8-24
<i>Installing Application Manager PTF's</i>	8-25
CHAPTER 9 DRINKS REQUISITIONING OVERVIEW	9-1
INTRODUCTION	9-2
RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER APPLICATIONS	9-3
APPLICATION CONFIGURATION	9-4
USING DRINKS REQUISITIONING.....	9-5
<i>Configuring the Application</i>	9-6
IMPLEMENTATION PROCEDURE.....	9-8
<i>Installing Application Manager PTF's</i>	9-9
CHAPTER 10 DRINKS TELESales OVERVIEW	10-1
INTRODUCTION	10-2
WHAT DOES TELESales DO?	10-3
TELESales STYLE.....	10-5
RELATIONSHIPS TO OTHER MODULES	10-6
MODULE CONFIGURATION	10-7
<i>Maintenance of Reference Data</i>	10-8
USING DRINKS TELESales.....	10-14
BASIC DATA.....	10-16
INITIAL DATA SET-UP	10-18

<i>Installing Application Manager PTF's</i>	10-19
CHAPTER 11 DRINKS TRANSPORT PLANNING OVERVIEW	11-1
INTRODUCTION	11-2
RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER MODULES	11-6
MODULE CONFIGURATION	11-7
MAINTENANCE OF REFERENCE DATA	11-8
<i>Transport Centres</i>	11-9
<i>Transport Planners</i>	11-11
<i>Routes and Nodes</i>	11-12
<i>Vehicle Types</i>	11-13
<i>Carriers</i>	11-14
<i>Carrier Rates</i>	11-15
<i>Areas</i>	11-16
<i>Delivery Profiles</i>	11-17
PROCESSING.....	11-18
ENQUIRIES	11-22
REPORTS	11-23
PRE-REQUISITES.....	11-25
DRINKS TRANSPORT PLANNING CONFIGURATION	11-26
<i>Installing Application Manager PTF's</i>	11-34
CHAPTER 12 DRINKS WAREHOUSING OVERVIEW	12-1
INTRODUCTION	12-2
RELATIONSHIPS TO OTHER MODULES	12-3
MODULE CONFIGURATION	12-4
MAINTENANCE OF REFERENCE DATA	12-5
PROCESSING.....	12-9
<i>Receiving and Putting Away</i>	12-10
<i>Intra-Warehouse Move</i>	12-12
<i>Picking and Despatching</i>	12-13
ENQUIRIES	12-16
REPORTS	12-17
OVERALL IMPLEMENTATION CONSIDERATIONS.....	12-18
IMPLEMENTATION PROCEDURE.....	12-19
<i>With Drinks Inventory Management already Installed</i>	12-20
<i>With Drinks Inventory Management newly Installed</i>	12-22
<i>Installing Application Manager PTF's</i>	12-24
GLOSSARY	I
GLOSSARY	II
INDEX	A
INDEX	B

-
-
-
-
-

Glossary



Glossary

-
-
-
-
-

Index



Index

Error! No index entries found.

-
-
-
-
-

Chapter 1

Drinks Sales Analysis Overview



Introduction

Drinks Sales Analysis enables you to produce your own views of sales information, to enable you to make comparisons and identify trends which are vital to strategic planning.

One of the great strengths of Drinks Sales Analysis is the extent to which each individual user is able to tailor the system to their own requirements without the need for any programming. This flexibility starts with the Sales History Database which is defined by the user, along with the level at which Sales History is held. The formats of enquiry are chosen by the user, and a new view of the information may be created quickly and easily without the need for data processing personnel.

Reports may be created via a simple series of prompts, may be requested on a regular basis or may be simple ad-hoc enquiries.

Relationship to Other Modules

Drinks Sales Analysis makes use of primary data held in Drinks Inventory Management and Drinks Sales Order Processing.

It is within Drinks Inventory Management that details of items are held, including data such as item type, item group, division and sub-division.

Drinks Inventory Management also contains a database of codes and descriptions, used to maintain an abbreviated code for such details as item group, or salesman, together with a meaningful description. The great benefit of the description database is that it enables a consistent and easily validated use of codes, and also provides for a meaningful description at report or enquiry time.

Customer details are held within Drinks Sales Order Processing, including data such as salesman, territory, and customer class.

Company Profile

As with all modules, Drinks Sales Analysis may be used by a number of companies, each with differing requirements. A profile of each company using the module is maintained, with details such as the name of the company and the level at which sales history is to be held.

Calendar

To maintain independence from financial or manufacturing time periods, Drinks Sales Analysis has its own calendar, which holds the dates on which sales weeks or periods end. This enables Drinks Sales Analysis to allocate each sale to the appropriate period, according to its date.

Budgets

Budgets may be defined within Drinks Sales Analysis, and have two main characteristics, a type and a format.

The type is an overall classification, such as 'Budget', 'Target' or 'Forecast'. The format describes the attribute or attributes to which the budget relates. For example, it is possible to have a 'Target' for Salesman, salesman being a possible item on the Sales History database, or a 'Forecast' for Customer account by Item group.

Budgets are entered by Sales History Period for a type and format previously defined. Spread profiles may be used to aid the creation of budgets, allowing an annual total to be spread over the year's sales periods according to a known pattern.

Drinks Sales Analysis reports enable the comparison of budgeted values with actual sales.

The Sales History Database

This is designed to enable a high level of tailoring to individual requirements without programming changes.

When the module is installed, you are able to choose the customer and item data elements which you wish to hold on the database. In addition to the item code, customer code and sales period, you may choose six data elements relating to the Drinks Inventory Management Item Master, and six relating to the Drinks Sales Order Processing Customer Master file. Quantity, Cost and Sales Value are also held, with provision for four further values.

You may also choose to change the screen and report headings for the data elements held on the database. For example, if you use Item type, to indicate whether an item is 'made in' or 'bought out', you can change the heading to say just that. This change is then fully incorporated within the database itself, allowing full utilisation of third party query utilities, which will print your chosen column headings.



Note: The database is common for all companies defined.

Updates and Processing

Sales History Update

Actual sales history is drawn from the Drinks Sales Order Processing invoice data. The Sales History Update function takes this data and adds it to the Sales History Database, using the calendar to determine the appropriate sales period.

This may be run as often as required, the actual frequency depending upon how up-to-date the Sales history needs to be.

Sales History Refresh

Drinks Sales Analysis enables you to selectively refresh customer or item data on the database in the event of a change.

For example, if sales regions are re-organised, so that customers fall into different regions, after the customer data in Drinks Sales Order Processing has been updated, it is possible to use the Sales History Refresh function to bring the Sales History Database into line with this re-organisation, and allow analysis to show past sales to customers, within their new regions.

Periodic Updates

Whilst Drinks Sales Analysis has no pre-defined 'month-end' reports, the functions are provided to allow you to run whatever regular reporting is required.

As you create your own reports, you are prompted to specify whether they are to be run on a regular basis, for example daily, or at month end. The daily, weekly, period-end, and year-end update functions select those reports you have requested, and produce them at the appropriate time.

These regular updates also maintain the current period and year, held on the company profile.

Enquiries

Drinks Sales Analysis provides a powerful enquiry function, which enables you to create a view of any data element on the database, analysed in terms of any other data item. The values displayed may also be chosen from the values on the database, and the time periods may be defined in a variety of different ways.

A new view may be created simply by asking for an analysis which has not previously been used, and the module will then offer to create it.

The Sales Enquiry provides you with four columns of values, chosen by means of a number of formats, created and set up at installation time.

A format specifies the time periods to be displayed, together with the particular value to be displayed.

For example:

- This period
- Last period
- 3 periods ago
- 4 periods ago
- Value to be shown = Sales Value.

Or:

- This period
- Last period
- This year
- Last year
- Value to be shown = Quantity.

To enquire on sales history, in a chosen format, you must enter two items:

- The data element on which to enquire.
- The data element by which to analyse.

For example, enquire on salesman '01' by item group, would show a breakdown by item group of salesman '01' sales. The enquiry may then be advanced to show the next salesman's sales by item group, and so forth.

Options are provided to invert the display, in order to show the sales of a selected item group by all salesmen, and thus view product group by salesman, in order to see the sales by all salesmen of a particular item group.

A bar chart function is also provided to give a graphical representation of the data.

Reports

Drinks Sales Analysis contains report generator functions which allow you to specify your own reports simply and quickly. For example, a report may be produced showing item sales summarised by salesman or a ranking of the best selling item groups comparing one sales period with another.

A report can be created to run regularly, perhaps at month-end, or a report may be used once to answer an ad-hoc enquiry.

Item File Print

This provides a listing of the items defined within Drinks Inventory Management, together with their attributes chosen for inclusion on the Sales History Database.

Customer File Print

This provides a listing of the Customers defined within Drinks Sales Order Processing, together with their attributes chosen for inclusion on the Sales History Database.

Report Specification Print

This function provides a listing of the specifications of reports defined within Drinks Sales Analysis.

Sales Report

The Drinks Sales Analysis system provides functions which enable you to run an existing sales report, or to create and optionally run a new or ad-hoc report.

Such is the ease of creating a report that Drinks Sales Analysis is particularly adept at providing reports for ad-hoc queries.

A report is created using a series of prompts by means of which you specify the report's sequence, selection and content, and when the report is to be run.

The report specification may be saved, and is then available to be run regularly, or on request.

Ranking Analysis

The Ranking Analysis function within Drinks Sales Analysis is used to sequence or rank elements by the results of a summarised value, and optionally, make comparisons between one period and another.

Thus, you could for example, choose to rank salesmen by sales value, which would summarise their sales values in order. You might choose to make a comparison and compare this month's ranking with last month's, to see what changes have taken place.

The ranking function may also be made to work at a second level, and rank one element within another. For example you could rank item groups within region, showing the best selling item groups for each region.

Utilities

Drinks Sales Analysis contains a set of utility functions which are intended for use at module installation time, or under certain special circumstances.

These utilities facilitate software installation, and continued maintenance.

Prerequisites

This section deals with all the steps involved from the initial installation of the module to the production of the first enquiries and reports.

Drinks Sales Analysis may be installed as an additional module within an existing environment, or may be part of a new installation.

The logical prerequisites are the same in both cases.

As with other products, Drinks Sales Analysis is supported by Application Manager, which must be installed first.

Drinks Sales Analysis also requires that Drinks Inventory Management and Drinks Sales Order Processing are installed. It obtains details from Drinks Inventory Management about the items which are sold and obtains details of customers and invoice details (representing sales) from Drinks Sales Order Processing .

In order for Drinks Sales Analysis to extract information about sales, the item details held within Drinks Inventory Management must be maintained so that the information for analysis is present. Likewise, the customer details required for analysis must be present within Drinks Sales Order Processing and some invoices must have been printed.

In order to print some of the reports contained in Drinks Sales Analysis, it is necessary to use printers which support 198 character line widths.

Module Configuration

Before you can use Drinks Sales Analysis you have to configure the module by providing the system with information on your business procedures.

These details can be split into five areas:

- Basic Data
- Database
- Budgets
- Sales History
- Technical Configuration

Entering Basic Data

You must enter the following basic data.

- Company Profile

A company profile must be created for each company which is to use the module. This contains processing details specific to each company, and also the current year and period, maintained by period-end routines.

- Calendars

Drinks Sales Analysis provides information grouped by sales period, whereas invoices are created as individual dates. In order for invoices to be placed in the appropriate period, a calendar is used.

Calendars must be created before processing starts. If you choose to hold history at a weekly level, calendars should be created for both week and period for all years which you intend to process.

- Sales History Time Period Selection

The information shown on the Drinks Sales Analysis enquiry is determined by the creation of formats.

These formats define the time periods and the values which will be shown, and must be created before any attempt is made to use the enquiry function of Drinks Sales Analysis.

A default format '1' is used by the module, and therefore, this at least must be created.

Database

Central to Drinks Sales Analysis is its database, which must be defined before processing is to start.

- Change Initial Field Descriptions

Within Drinks Sales Analysis, data elements or fields have internal names, which cannot be altered, but also external names by which they are identified to users of the system. The Change Initial Field Descriptions function may be used to step through the data elements, and change the names or descriptions of these in order to suit a particular installation.

- Define Database

The database must be created before processing can begin. You should consider the data elements which you wish to hold before you create the database. See the section 'Sales History Database'.

Budgets

Within Drinks Sales Analysis you may choose to maintain budgets, and in reports, compare budgets with actual sales. You may choose to run the module without budgets initially and introduce them later. A budget is defined in terms of a budget format and a budget type.

- Definition

In order to describe the data element(s) to which a budget applies, a format must be created. This also determines the kind of value to be held, for example, cost value or sales value.

The Budget Format function should be used to create the formats you require.

- Spread Profiles

The Spread Profiles function enables you to define the pattern of sales over a year, by period. A number of profiles may be created and used to aid budget entry.

- Budget Entry

Budgets may be entered for a year, against the data elements defined by the budget format, for the values also specified by the format.

Spread profiles may be used to spread an annual total over all periods in a year.

Sales History

Drinks Sales Analysis draws its information on sales from data within Drinks Sales Order Processing. For processing to start, invoices must have been printed within Drinks Sales Order Processing.

- Updating Drinks Sales Analysis

The Sales History Update function takes printed invoice data and posts the information to the Sales History Database. Once posted, the invoices are marked as such and will not be included in subsequent updates. If large volumes of data are involved this function may take some time to complete.

- Enquiry

The Sales Enquiry function will prompt you to enter a data element on which to enquire, and to select a data element by which to analyse. The first time a new enquiry combination is selected, the system will build summary data, but there after the enquiry will be performed straight away.

- Reporting

Drinks Sales Analysis enables you to create your own Sales Reports and Ranking Analysis Reports.

The Reports Specifications and Ranking Analysis Specification functions allow you to define reports quickly and easily. They may be created and run as part of the specification maintenance, or they may be selected by name at a later time, or included in the regular update runs.

Expert Menu Codes

You can access any menu in any linked module to which you are authorised by simply keying in the expert mode menu code of the menu you want from a command line.

This is done by entering a '/' followed by the code, e.g. /DAM (for the Drinks Sales Analysis Maintenance menu). The Drinks Sales Analysis codes are as follows:

<u>Code</u>	<u>Menu</u>
/DK	Customer Service and Logistics Initial Menu
/DA	Drinks Sales Analysis Initial menu
/DAP	Drinks Sales Analysis Processing menu
/DAM	Drinks Sales Analysis Maintenance menu
/DAE	Drinks Sales Analysis Reports and Enquiries menu
/DAU	Drinks Sales Analysis Utilities menu

The codes have been designed to be easily memorised. However, if you do forget a code, you can still enter the menu the normal way, and once there, the menu code is displayed in the top left hand corner.

You can go straight into a program by selecting the option number and menu at the same time. Simply enter the option number followed directly by a '/' and then the expert menu code. For example, instead of keying /DAM to get to the Maintenance menu and then taking option 4 to maintain calendars, simply keying 4/DAM takes you into the option. This is very convenient once the options you use most have become familiar to you.

Installing Application Manager PTF's

Application Manager PTF's must be restored and installed as QSECOFR.



Note: To install the Application Manager PTF's the system must be in a minimum state (that is with no users or subsystems / jobs running - this is important)

Use a normal User ID to create the state then sign off and sign on as QSECOFR.

At the first screen, add in library OSLPTP1 (ADDLIB OSLPTP1 *FIRST)

Type in MNGPTF and install the PTF as normal.

Once installed, the library and PTF object can only be removed by QSECOFR. Install this PTF then sign off and sign back in as PTFOWNER for subsequent PTF's.

If the above is NOT done, PTFOWNER, being inside Application manager, will say the AM PTF is installed when it has not, as PTFOWNER is using one of the objects the PTF requires, and the system will work - but will NOT have been updated.

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Chapter 2

Drinks UK Bonded Inventory

Overview



Introduction

Drinks Bonded Inventory Management provides the wine, spirit and beer distribution industry in the United Kingdom, with an efficient method of controlling stocks in a duty free environment.

One of the key benefits of Drinks Bonded Inventory Management is the linking of distribution functions with H M Customs and Excise reporting requirements.

In line with other modules, users may define more than one operating company, but more importantly, users may define any number of Bonded Stockrooms.

Relationships With Other Modules

Drinks Bonded Inventory Management makes use of primary data held in the Drinks Inventory Management and Drinks Sales Order Processing modules.

It is within Drinks Inventory Management that details of items are held, including litres per case and bottles per case.

Drinks Inventory Management also contains a database of codes and descriptions used to hold such details as country of origin, ports of entry, goods category (E.g.: Wine, Gin, etc.). This description database is used to validate data entry and ensure consistency in the data recorded.

The status of Warehouse / Stockroom codes - Duty Free (Bonded) or Duty Paid are defined within Drinks Sales Order Processing. Similarly, the status of customers (Export, Duty Paid, etc.) are defined within Drinks Sales Order Processing.

System 21 Production Applications recognise Bonded Stockrooms for Production Receipt only. If you are using the System 21 Production Applications in conjunction with Drinks Bonded Inventory Management, Bonded Stockrooms should not be defined as:

- Issuing stockroom on Production Routes or Production Orders.
- Issuing stockroom on any Transaction Booking in Production.
- Shop Floor stockrooms.

All Item/Stockroom Details must be defined using the Drinks Item/Stockroom Details Maintenance. In particular, all shop floor component stockroom balance must be defined in the Drinks Application before use in Production.

All Item master details must be defined using the Drinks Applications. The Production item master, 'based on' facility can only be used after the Inventory Item Master has been defined in the Drinks Application.

Maintenance

Company Profile

As with all products, Drinks Bonded Inventory Management may be used by a number of companies, each with differing requirements. A profile of each company using the system is maintained, detailing such things as the name of the company and certain processing options.

Bond / Stockroom Profile

Customs and Excise Bonds, throughout the United Kingdom may be defined within Drinks Bonded Inventory Management. Export and other Duty Free locations may also be defined to the system in order to ensure that the supply of goods causes the production of the appropriate despatch documents and the relevant tax liability, both EEC and UK taxes.

It is possible to operate Duty Paid and Duty Free stockrooms within the same company. Provision is also made for controlling broken cases by defining bottle stockrooms within a Bond.

To maintain independence from other module time periods, each Bond has its own calendar, which holds critical dates relevant to the production of Customs and Excise reports and the triggering of period end processing.

There is no significant restriction to the number of stockrooms defined within Warehousing and Drinks Inventory Management all within the same Bond.

Reference Data

The following H M Customs and Excise reference data is defined within Drinks Bonded Inventory Management:

- Commodity Codes/Tax Types.
- Preferential Duty Rates.
- Preferential Groups.
- Quota Duty Rates.
- Item Variants/Customer Items.
- Rotation Details.
- Commercial Value Duty Rates.

This data defines the tax rules and values necessary for the calculation of H M Customs and Excise duties and the reporting of EEC Commodity Codes and Excise Tax Type codes.

Each item defined within Drinks Inventory Management is also defined within Drinks Bonded Inventory Management in order to specify the associated tax codes, duty status, spirit strength (where relevant) and country of origin.

Identical products sourced from different countries, or with varying spirit strengths, may be assigned the same item number. Each variant of the same item may be given unique tax codes/strengths as appropriate.

Processing

The main transaction types recognised by H M C & E are:

- Goods Receiving.
- Despatch.
- Stock Losses (write-offs).
- Stock Gains.
- Stock Counting.
- Payment of Customs Duty within Bond.

The goods receiving processes are performed within either Drinks Inventory Management or Drinks Purchase Management. These processes have been enhanced to accommodate the logging of additional data when receiving goods into a Bond.

Similarly, the despatch processes performed within Drinks Warehousing have been enhanced to accommodate the production of clean despatch notes and where applicable, the necessary duty free documentation.

Recording losses and gains are provided by Drinks Bonded Inventory Management, and in the case of stock losses, payment or non-payment of duty is determined by the transaction reference selected.

Payment of Customs Duty within Bond, otherwise known as Marking goods in free circulation, is performed within Drinks Bonded Inventory Management.

Stock Counting within Drinks Bonded Inventory Management provides for the production of count documents, sorted by location or by rotation. After recording physical stocks, a variance report is available listing items in the sequence specified.



Note: Inventory stock counting and Warehouse stock counting provide an alternative procedure to Bond stock counting. Bond is included in both these functions. This provides the facility to stock count in warehouse defined stockrooms that are also bonded. Inventory stock counting and Warehouse stock counting are the recommended functions for stock counting.

Enquiries

Drinks Warehousing and Drinks Inventory Management provide the main source of information for enquiring on stock status, by item, and by location.

Drinks Bonded Inventory Management provides for additional enquiries, as follows:

- Rotation.
- Consolidated Audit.
- Item Variant.

The Rotation Enquiry accesses the original consignment details and Customs and Excise references as well as the Drinks Bonded Inventory Management transaction movement log.

All key reference data updates are logged and reported. In addition, it is possible to enquire on these updates.

The item variant enquiry provides for the identification of a given variant where a number of variants are assigned to the same item.

Reports

Drinks Bonded Inventory Management has its own independent logging of transactions where the transactions are relevant to H M C & E.

All necessary transaction reports are contained within a Daily Duty Run, with each report being consecutively numbered from one day to the next. Reports produced by the Duty Run are:

- Adjustments/Breakages.
- Customer Duty and Duty Free Analysis.
- Movement Audit.
- Report of Despatches.
- Report of Receipts.
- W1, W2 and W3 Stock Returns.
- W5D.
- EX46 (Beer Duty) Returns Report.
- C88A Report.

In addition, key reference data changes may be reported and W81 documents still outstanding for return can be listed.

By numbering each report, the majority of the above reports may be re-printed by quoting the original report number.

Utilities

Drinks Bonded Inventory Management contains utility functions which are intended for use at system installation time, or under special circumstances.

These utilities enable ease of software installation, and continued maintenance.

Pre-requisites

Drinks Bonded Inventory Management requires the following modules to be installed before installing this module.

- Drinks Inventory Management.
- Drinks Sales Order Processing & Invoicing.

Drinks Purchase Management, the financial modules, Drinks Telesales, Drinks Warehousing and Drinks Sales Analysis may be included with this module, but are not essential.

Basic Data

The data elements essential to this module are as follows:

- Company profiles for all modules.
- Descriptions.
- Processing Profiles within Inventory Management.
- Stockrooms / Depots in Inventory Management, Drinks Sales Order Processing and Drinks Warehousing.
- Items.
- Stockroom Details.

Additionally, the details outlined in Maintenance must be entered before this module can be made operational.

Maintenance lists all the required data elements specific to Drinks Bonded Inventory Management. The details explained are listed in order of priority for implementation.

Installing Application Manager PTF's

Application Manager PTF's must be restored and installed as QSECOFR.



Note: To install the Application Manager PTF's the system must be in a minimum state (that is with no users or subsystems / jobs running - this is important)

Use a normal User ID to create the state then sign off and sign on as QSECOFR.

At the first screen, add in library OSLPTP1 (ADDLIBLE OSLPTP1 *FIRST)

Type in MNGPTF and install the PTF as normal.

Once installed, the library and PTF object can only be removed by QSECOFR. Install this PTF then sign off and sign back in as PTFOwner for subsequent PTF's.

If the above is NOT done, PTFOwner, being inside Application Manager, will say the AM PTF is installed when it has not, as PTFOwner is using one of the objects the PTF requires, and the system will work - but will NOT have been updated.

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Chapter 3

Drinks DRP Overview



Introduction

Drinks Distribution Requirements Planning (DRP) provides the necessary data for matching customer demand with the supply of product at various stages in the physical distribution system.

A well developed DRP module enables management to anticipate future requirements in the field, deploy inventory to meet customer-service requirements, and adjust to the vagaries of the market-place.

Drinks DRP evaluates the demand at the Distribution Centres (DCs) and 'implodes' it down to the Supply Centre. In doing so, it generates supply plans for Centres at a product level. These time-phased plans, known as 'schedules', provide the information which planners need to match supply and demand.

The planner can then confirm suggested supply orders, check the feasibility of suggested changes, monitor data integrity and assess the impact of new situations.

The key to the successful implementation of DRP is the development of the planner's role within the company.

Relationship to other Modules

Drinks Distribution Requirements Planning (DRP) is a fully standardised module, and as such operates under the control of Application Manager. Drinks DRP is one of the Advanced Drinks Application Modules which extend the functionality of Base Drinks Application Modules.

The modules which are pre-requisite for the operation of DRP are:

- Drinks Inventory Management.
- Drinks Sales Order Processing.
- Drinks Purchase Management.
- Drinks Requisitioning.

The module, however, is designed to be used in conjunction with, and enhance, the Warehousing and Production modules.

At DCs, the DRP confirmation of shipment receipt allows warehousing details to be entered so that these items can be included in the warehousing put-away processing.

At the Supply Centres, items may be picked by Distribution Order, within Warehousing. A Distribution Order is an internal order for transferring goods from Supply Centre to DC, DC to DC or DC to Supply Centre. It is generated from a DRP suggestion or entered manually, and is handled as an internal order within Drinks Sales Order Processing.

If the Supply Centre is a Production site, the Distribution Orders are considered as demand within the Production system's MPS/MRP processing runs. (This is achieved by defining items at the Centre to Production).

Module Configuration

Drinks Distribution Requirements Planning (DRP) can be operated for a number of companies, the characteristics of each being maintained on control files.

Drinks DRP uses the control data stored for the Drinks Inventory Management module. However, further information is required at company level specifically for DRP requirements.

The DRP policies which can be controlled at each company are:

- Method of forecast consumption.
- Maximum number of lines per distribution order.
- Default calendar parameters.
- Default absolute forecast error tolerance percentage.
- System calculation of safety stocks.
- Period forecasting.

Consumption of Forecast

One method of assessing demand is to compare by period the sales forecasts with actual sales orders on hand and to plan on the basis of whichever is greatest, the logic being that if actual sales registered for the period exceed the period forecast, the period forecast probably understated true demand. Conversely, if the forecast exceeded sales registered to date there were probably outstanding orders yet to be registered.

Consumption of Forecast is an alternative method of assessing demand by comparing cumulative forecasts with cumulative demand. The logic being that where a period demand exceeds the period forecast it may be because demand forecast for a following or prior period had either arrived early or late - i.e. the quantity forecast is accurate but the period due is not.

Consider the following item demand:

Period Start	1 Oct '95	8 Oct '95	15 Oct '95	22 Oct '95	Total
Forecast	100	100	100	100	400
Actual Sales	150	90	30	110	380
Demand A	150	90	60	100	400
Demand B	150	100	100	110	460



*Note: Demand A uses forecast consumption,
Demand B does not.*

The mechanics of consumption of forecast are explained by following these steps:

- Sum the forecast to date.
- Sum the actual sales to date.
- Set the demand to date as the greater of forecast to date and actual sales to date.
- Sum the 'consumed demand' to date as shown in the following table, excluding the current period which is not calculated until step 5.
- Calculate the consumed demand for the current period as:
- Demand to date (from 3) - Consumed Demand to date (from 4).

Reconsidering the previous example, then:

Period Start	1 Oct '95	8 Oct '95	15 Oct '95	22 Oct '95	Total
Forecast	100	100	100	100	400
Actual Sales	150	90	30	110	380
Forecast to Date	100	200	300	400	
Actual Sales to Date	150	240	270	380	
Demand to Date	150	240	300	400	
Consumed Demand	150	90	60	100	400

Distribution Orders

The maximum number of lines to be created on a distribution order (i.e. a supply order from Centre to DC), is specified at this level.

This may be changed when the orders are created from DRP suggestions.

Calendar Parameters

A default calendar code may be entered for the company. It is used within the DRP planning runs for any Centre or DC which does not have a calendar assigned to it.

Period details are also maintained:

- Number of periods per year.
- Period Names.
- Number of days per period.

These are used by the Working Days Calendar Maintenance function, in Drinks Inventory Management, when generating a calendar.

A standard week template can also be maintained. This specifies the normal working week, where N designates a non-working day. This is displayed and used within Calendar Maintenance when generating calendars.



Note: The DRP planning runs suggest actions only on working days.

Maintenance of Reference Data

As this is an Advanced Application Module of the Drinks system, much of the primary data has already been set up as part of the base Drinks modules. There is, however, additional information which must be entered in order to obtain the maximum benefit from the modules.

There are a number of common features in the way in which this data is maintained. These are:

- The standard item search routine has been adopted, in addition to a generic DRP item code search.
- The module makes the minimum use of 'codes' and where they are employed a prompt is always available to assist in selecting the correct one.
- Selection is normally from a displayed list.

Information for the following may be maintained:

- Periods.
- Stockrooms.
- Customers.
- Supply Networks.
- Item Master Details.
- Planner Codes.
- Net Change Reason Code.
- Profiles, Forecasts and Stock Levels.

Periods

The period intervals for the planning runs are maintained per site (i.e. Centre or DC). These are specified in terms of calendar days, and may be of variable length. Up to 46 periods may be specified.

The DRP planning runs assess the supply and demand falling into each of these periods, beginning at the start date for the particular run.

Stockrooms

Any number of Inventory Stockrooms may be defined to a single Centre or DC.

If there is only one stockroom per site, it may be advantageous to assign the stockroom code to the Centre or DC code also.

For multiple stockrooms, the DRP planning runs extract stock, supply and demand information for all stockrooms at the selected DC or Centre. This is done within one execution of the run.

A stockroom can only be assigned to one Centre or DC.

Customers

Customer numbers are given to each DRP defined stockroom, to enable a name and address, etc. to be established, allowing Distribution orders to be progressed through the Drinks Sales Order Processing module. These are valid customers from within the Sales Order Processing module with a delivery sequence code of '001'. These customers are used to hold the internal distribution orders, which have been raised for supply to that particular stockroom.

Supply Networks

A Supply Network must be set up for each 'level' of supply within a company. Typically, the Centre of one Network is a DC supplied by an alternative Centre within a different Network.

Any site may be defined to any number of Networks, using the same DC or Centre code.

A Network is simply given a code, description, a Centre, and all DCs to be supplied by this Centre.

Item Master Details

Additional item information is needed for Drinks DRP to be able to control how it's supply is to be administered. The two primary requirements are:

- How much is to be ordered when a net requirement has been calculated?
- Where is the main source of supply?

The first requirement is satisfied by specifying an order policy, and the appropriate quantities.

The second requirement is satisfied by specifying whether the item is purchased locally, or purchased/manufactured centrally. If the item is supplied centrally, a valid Centre code and stockroom defined to this Centre must be entered. Any distribution order lines are then created for this central stockroom.

Item master details must be entered for the item at each DC from where it is sold. Separate details must also be maintained at the Supply Centre, if the Item is centrally supplied.



Note: If the supply Centre is a production site, these items should be defined to the Production System and planned via its MPS facilities (after the DC demand has been evaluated and passed down to the Centre in the form of distribution orders). Otherwise, the items at the Centre are defined to DRP and the central supply plan created within it.

Planner Codes

At each Centre and DC, codes are maintained for each planner who will use this module.

Personal details are held for the planner, together with a cross reference to his/her purchase officer number in the Purchase Management module.

This planner code is assigned to items, for which he/she is responsible, in the item master details.

Forecast Manipulation

Sales Forecasts may be entered at item group (minor) level and then spread on a time phased basis over defined time bands down to period, weekly and daily levels in stages either by:

- Interactively selecting definable seasonal profiles.
- Invoking automatic spreading.
- Direct entry and manipulation of forecasts and spread indices.

The percentage spread of sales amongst items within an item group is maintainable. This is known as the item group profile.

From the item group profile and item group sales forecasts, time phased item level sales forecasts can also be generated automatically and then maintained.

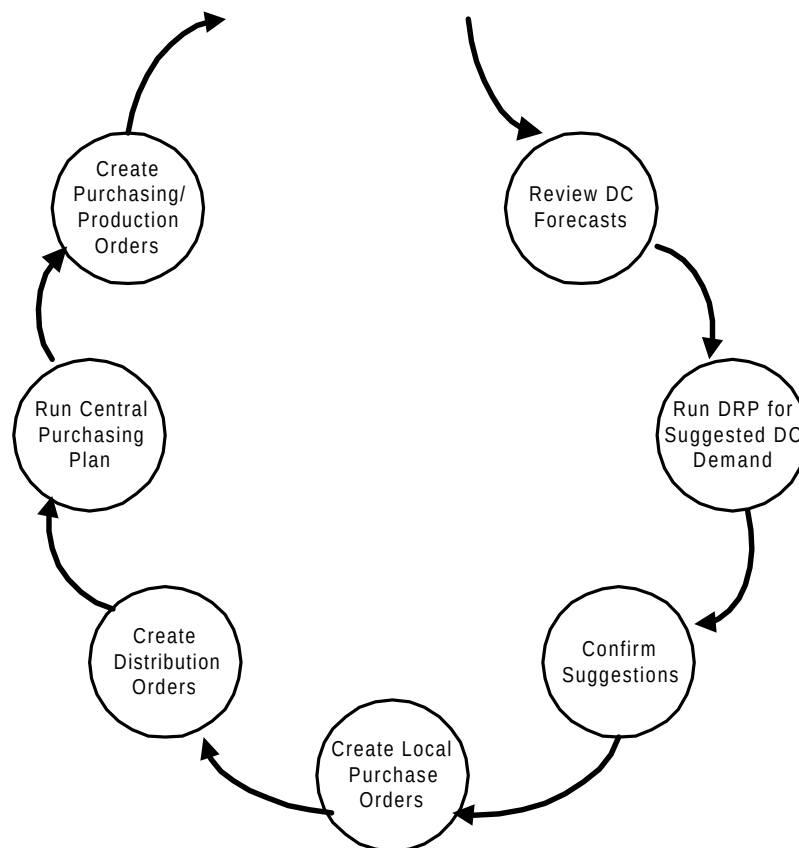
It is also possible to build item level forecasts directly even if the items do not belong to a defined item group or where they are not included in the group level forecast.

Stock 'forecasts' may also be entered in order to specify stock building requirements. Creating demand in addition to sales, in order to build stocks covering future periods when supply would be constrained and insufficient. Typically this is where there is a highly seasonal demand and a belief that suppliers will not have the capacity to meet the requirements unless they are smoothed and pulled forward.

Processing

The DRP Cycle

The following flow diagram may be used to show the progress of the DRP cycle:



Review DC Forecasts

The stock and sales forecasts are reviewed and updated for relevant items at the DC.

This is done via the Drinks DRP Forecast Maintenance options.

Evaluate DC Demand

The supply and demand figures are assessed for all DCs in a specified network.

New supply orders from the Centre or from external suppliers, are suggested.

Amendments to existing supply orders are also suggested. All previous supply suggestions are deleted. This DC run is initiated via Drinks DRP Processing.

Confirm Suggestions

Once the DC Run has been reviewed and accepted, the suggestions are converted to requisitions. This is done via the Drinks Requisitioning module.

These may be amended within Requisitioning before the actual supply, i.e. before purchase or distribution orders are created.



Note: All outstanding requisitions sourced from DRP for the DC stockrooms are discarded when this option is taken, and new ones added from the latest DRP suggested orders for the DC.

Create Local Purchase Orders

The purchase requisitions created from Drinks DRP can be converted into purchase orders on the relevant external suppliers.

This is done within Drinks Requisitioning. The purchase orders are transferred into the Drinks Purchase Management module.

Create Distribution Orders

The distribution requisitions, i.e. those for supply from a Centre, can be converted into distribution orders.

This is done within Drinks Requisitioning. The distribution orders are transferred into the Drinks Sales Order Processing module. The order lines are placed against the Centre stockroom defined to the item in DRP.

Distribution orders can also be entered directly into the Drinks Sales Order Processing module without first creating requisitions. This is done via distribution order entry or amend. By specifying the 'from' and 'to' stockrooms, the link will automatically be created between the two stockrooms, and an internal sales order will be created for the customer which has been defined for the stockroom, which will receive the supply.



Note the following points:

- The distribution order is treated as an internal sales order, so no invoice details are raised. The customer is the one defined to the Stockroom which will receive the supply.
- On confirmation of assembly, the distribution order lines are added to the Drinks DRP shipments in-transit file.
- On receipt of distribution order lines at the stockroom, the goods are confirmed as received via the Drinks DRP processing menu.

Run Central Supply Plan

The supply and demand figures are assessed for the selected Supply Centre. New purchase orders from external suppliers are suggested. Amendments to purchase orders are also recommended.



Note: If the Centre is a production site, the items at the Centre must be defined to Production not Drinks DRP, and the Centre run should be an MPS run not a DRP one. Otherwise, this Centre run is self-contained within DRP.

Create Purchasing / Production Orders

If the Centre run was within Drinks DRP, the requisitions can be created from DRP Suggestions and subsequently made into purchase orders (via the Drinks Requisitioning module).

If the Centre run was within Production, the purchase requisitions can be created and subsequently converted into purchase orders (via Requisitioning).

Also, production orders can be created from MPS Suggestions within the Master Production Scheduling module.

Processing Options

Drinks Distribution Requirements Planning allows a considerable degree of flexibility in the way in which items may be selected for re-planning in the DRP run processing options (DC, Centre and Network planning runs).

Three distinct run types are available as follows:-

Full regeneration

All DRP items are re-planned for the selected network or Centre.

Net Change

A subset of items are selected for re-planning on the basis of changes in the supply, demand, stock and/or replenishment parameters of those items since they were last planned. This is achieved through the use of net change triggers.

Triggers are set throughout the Customer Services and Logistics modules under a set of defined reason codes.

A net change 'reason' may be defined as a type of business transaction which potentially affects the supply, demand, stock and/or replenishment parameters of a particular item.

The reason codes currently set up are shown in the following table:

Code	Description	Module where Triggers Set
01	Forecast vs. Actual Comparison	DRP
02	Forecast Generation	Forecasting
03	Forecast Maintenance	DRP
04	Distribution Item Master	DRP
05	Unplanned Inventory Transaction	Inventory Management
06	Requisition Maintenance	Requisitioning
07	Unplanned Issue or Receipt	Inventory Management/Warehousing
08	Purchase Order Maintenance	Purchase Management
09	Distribution Order Maintenance	Sales Order Processing/Requisitioning

Example

A purchase order is raised in Purchase Order Management for replenishment of item #1 at stockroom S1.

If stockroom S1 is attached to a Centre or DC in DRP, and item #1 is defined as a DRP item at that Centre or DC, then a net change trigger will be written for that particular location/item/reason code combination (provided that trigger has not already been set).

When net change triggers are reviewed for a Centre or DC prior to submitting a net change planning run, the number of triggers set for each reason code is displayed.

Using this information, the planner may select to process some or all of the items which have set triggers under any of the defined reason codes.



Note: When a particular item is re-planned at a particular DRP location (Centre or DC), all net change triggers are deleted for that location/item combination. This will occur irrespective of the DRP run type chosen for processing.

Selective Processing

A subset of items are selected for re-planning on the basis of the selection of ranges of DRP items, DRP Planners, Inventory minor item groups, Inventory cost/usage elements and/or preferred suppliers.

These selections may be made prior to submitting any of the DRP Planning Runs (DC, Centre or Network runs).

An item will only be re-planned at a particular Centre or DC under the following conditions:

- It is within the range of items selected, and
- The DRP planner assigned to the item is within the range of DRP planners selected, and
- The Inventory minor item group to which the item belongs is within the range of Inventory minor item groups selected, and
- The Inventory cost/usage element calculated for the item is within the range of cost/usage elements selected, and
- The preferred supplier defined on the Inventory item/stockroom details is within the range of preferred suppliers selected.

DRP Cycle Summary

This represents a one-level DRP cycle run. To accommodate multi-level, this cycle may be repeated, or partially repeated, for each required network. A supply Centre in one network can be defined as a DC in another network.

Confirm Shipment Receipt

This is the day-to-day functional part of DRP, as distinct from the planning runs.

When distribution order lines are confirmed as assembled from supply stockrooms, they are added to a shipments in-transit file. At this point they are considered to be in-transit between the two stockrooms.

On receiving the shipment, confirmation of receipt is done via the relevant DRP processing option. This enables order lines to be received 'en bloc', or selectively, with or without amendments.

The quantity of items recorded as despatched from the 'From' stockroom must be confirmed as received. This may be done across any number of shipment receipts until the full quantity is confirmed. If there is a discrepancy, the full despatched quantity must be received and an Inventory stock adjustment done (with an appropriate reason for the difference).

The details of each shipment received are output to a report, on confirmation taking place.

Warehousing details may be entered if the receiving stockroom is defined as a warehouse to the Drinks Warehousing module.

The Inventory stock figures are updated, and movement records created. This transaction is regarded as a 'transfer in' to the receiving stockroom. Similarly, distribution order lines confirmed as assembled at the supply stockroom are treated as 'transfers out' (within history and movement records).

On receiving an item, the costs are updated, based on the cost held on the in-transit record in Drinks DRP.

Enquiries

Enquiries can be grouped into one of three categories:

- Planning.
- Static Information.
- Status.

More simply, these can be regarded as:

- What is to be done?
- What are the parameters?
- Where are things?

Planning

All supply and demand information generated by any of the DRP planning runs may be viewed via the Schedule Enquiries.

There are separate DC and Centre schedule enquiries, which are almost identical in content. Separate enquiries allow restriction of access if required.

Static Information

The ordering policies and parameters may be enquired on for each Distribution Item, at any selected Centre or DC.

Status

The current stock situation is shown for any item/stockroom combination, via the Drinks Inventory Management Enquiries.

The items in transit between stockrooms are shown in the Shipments In-Transit enquiry. This gives all distribution order lines despatched by the supplying stockroom but not yet confirmed as received at the receiving stockroom.

Reports

As part of the general policy of the modules, selection and sequencing parameters are available before a report is run.

In general, standard reports are printed on standard listing paper with 132 print positions and 6 lines to the inch.

All reports are printed with the procedure or program number in the top left and the page number and date of run in the top right of the report.



Note: The schedule and valuation reports both have 198 print positions.

As with the enquiries, the reports can be grouped into Planning, Static Information and Status.

Implementation Guide

This section is intended to be used as a guide during the planning and implementation stages of Drinks DRP.

It describes pre-requisites of the module, the basic data requirements, a recommended implementation procedure and how to find your way around the system.

Each implementation will be different; therefore, the various stages need to be thought through and an implementation plan produced. This should allow for the training of those who will be using the module, for the identification of the required configuration, and for the necessary data to be entered and validated.

Prerequisites

For the full operation of the Drinks DRP module the following modules should be installed:

- Drinks Inventory Management.
- Drinks Sales Order Processing.
- Drinks Purchase Management.
- Drinks Purchase Requisitioning.
- Drinks Warehousing.
- Drinks Bonded Inventory.
- Forecasting.
- Scheduled Orders.
- Production.

Module Configuration

To enable the Drinks DRP module to be functional, it is necessary to define the network(s) and the relationships that enable the module to identify how to process each item within the network(s).

The data considerations are considered for each function in turn and are presented in the logical order required to satisfy the inter-dependency of functions.

The following is a summary of the functions considered:

- Company Profile.
- Calendars.
- Periods.
- Stockrooms.
- Customers.
- Networks.
- Planner Codes.
- Distribution Item Masters.

If forecasting is required:

- Item Profiles.
- Seasonal Profiles.

If sales forecasting is required:

- Item Group Forecasts.
- Item Sales Forecasts.

If stock building is required:

- Item Group Stock Levels.
- Item Stock Levels.

Company

This must be defined for each company using Drinks DRP.

It requires company profile to have already been set-up in Drinks Inventory Management.

This defines the default calendar, the maximum number of lines on each Distribution Order, whether consumption of forecast is required and forecast error tolerance.

Calendars

All calendars to be used within the DRP company must be defined via the Working Days Calendar Maintenance function in Drinks Inventory Management (refer to the Maintenance section in Drinks Inventory Management).

Periods

For each centre or DC to be handled by DRP, the number of days in each period must be defined. These are used to establish the intervals within the DRP run for this centre or DC.

Stockrooms

For each centre or DC within DRP, all stockrooms to be included must be defined. These stockrooms must be defined to Drinks Inventory Management.

The Centre or DC must have had periods specified previously.

Each stockroom can only be defined to one centre or DC. Each stockroom must be assigned an SOP dummy internal customer number, which will be used to reflect distribution orders which have been raised for that particular stockroom.

Networks

The relationships of centres or DCs must be specified within a network. Each centre must have had periods and stockrooms defined previously. Each DC must have had periods and stockrooms defined previously.

Multiple networks may be defined for a company. Sites may be included in more than one network, typically as a centre within one level and a DC in another level.

Distribution Item Master

For each centre or DC, all items to be included in the DRP run must be defined. Re-ordering rules and source of supply details are defined.

Items must be defined to the local stockroom, within Drinks Inventory Management.

The Centre or DC must be defined to at least one network.

A centrally supplied item does not necessarily have to have an order policy defined at the centre. This is only required if it is to be included in the DRP run for the centre.

Customers

This associates each DRP active stockroom with an internal “customer” code allowing transfer requirements between stockrooms to be executed through distribution orders created for the “supplying” store against the demand raised by its “customer” store.

Net Change Reason Codes

This controls which operational transactions can set net change processing flags and will affect the efficiency and run times of DRP processing in net change mode.

Item Group Profiles

The percentage sales of each item within each item group may be defined. This can be done for any centre or DC.

Item Group Forecasts

Sales and stock forecasts can be maintained for each item group within each centre or DC.

These may be in terms of value or quantity. An annual forecast is entered and spread over the weeks in the specified year.

Item Sales Forecast

These can be generated from the relevant item group forecasts and profiles. Facilities are available to maintain forecasts manually.

Item Stock Levels

These may be generated from the relevant item group profile and the specification of a target stock quantity and range of dates. Facilities are available to maintain these manually.

Implementation Procedure

After installing the software, the recommended steps for implementing Drinks DRP are outlined as follows:

1. - Create customer records for each stockroom, within the module. They must be additional and different to the existing customers, and have a delivery address number of 001.
2. - Ensure the necessary processing profiles are present in Drinks Inventory Management.
3. - Create the DRP Company Profile record, using the same company code as the one defined to Drinks Inventory Management.
4. - Create DRP calendars for this year, and any subsequent years.
5. - Design the DRP networks, and the method (how/when) of processing.
6. - Create the DRP period records for each centre and DC.
7. - Create the DRP stockroom records for each centre and DC.
8. - Assign the internal customer number to the stockroom within DRP Customer Maintenance.
9. - Create the DRP network records.
10. - Create the DRP planner records.
11. - Ensure that the item is defined to all stockrooms (at centres and DCs) via Drinks Inventory Management.
12. - Create the Distribution Item Master records for every centre or DC which stocks or sells the item.
13. - Create item group profiles.
14. - Create seasonal profiles.
15. - Create item group forecasts.
16. - Create item sales forecasts.
17. - Maintain the generated sales forecasts (where appropriate).
18. - Enter item group stock level parameters and create item stock levels (if stock building is required).
19. - Maintain the generated item group stock level forecast (where appropriate).
20. - Set up net change reason codes (if net change DRP is to be used).



Note: Steps 13, 14, 15 and 16 are not required if the sales forecasts are to be exclusively created and transferred from the Forecasting module. However, if seasonal profiles are maintained (step 14) then the Forecasting module will apply them as part of the transfer into DRP forecasts.



Note: DRP can be run based on actual demand only, i.e. excluding forecasts.



Note: Only steps 1 to 12, inclusive, are mandatory.

A Recommended Path

This Drinks DRP product information is designed to take you through the stages of setting up and maintaining the module.

A summary of each section is given below:

Overview

- An overview outlining the scope of the Drinks Distribution Requirements Planning module, its functions and its relationship to other modules.
- An Implementation Guide gives general information on getting around the system.

Maintenance

The options to be taken when setting up your Drinks DRP. The section explains how to set up:

- Company Profile: how each input field (parameter) will affect the working of that company. Some settings will mean that fields shown on screens within this Product information do not appear on the screens you see on your screen. You can simply ignore such fields, although their inclusion in the Product information will make you aware of the many facilities available to you which you may or may not choose to use.
- Distribution Networks: This includes specifying distribution centres and their relationship in the supply chain, associated stockrooms, internal customer codes, item supply rules, calendars, planner codes etc. This reference data is used to support the companies logistics planning and operational activities.

Forecasting

This section explains how to:

- Create a supply plan for individual distribution centres, supply centres or whole networks.
- Plan selectively, through net change or on a full regenerative basis.
- Manage distribution orders and receipts, ad hoc order creation, order amendment and registration of receipts against orders.

Processing

This section explains all the different processing options available within Drinks DRP.

Enquiries

This section explains the available enquiries covering reference data set-up, results of planning runs and distribution order details.

Reports

This section explains the available management reports relating to reference data, results of planning runs, and distribution order details.

Utilities

This section explains the Utility functions available within Drinks DRP.

Planning and Preparation

Consideration should be given to the definition of the supply chain network and flows of products between them, particularly the relationship between distribution centres and stockrooms. Multiple stockrooms can be associated with a distribution centre for planning purposes, yet for any item only one stockroom is defined as the primary receiving/issuing store for planning purposes.

Entering Basic Data

You must prepare your module by entering the following basic data:

Company Profile

This is a record which contains control and parameter information for the operation of your company within the module.

Periods

This defines for a Centre/DC the structure and scope of the forecasting periods which will be used for planning purposes.

Stockrooms

This defines the stockrooms which are associated with a Centre/DC and controls which stock balances, demands and supply orders are considered during a planning run.

Customers

Defines internal customer codes associated with stockrooms for distribution centres in order to generate order details and despatch documentation to support stock transfers between Centres/DCs.

Networks

Defines the supply chain planning relationship.

Distribution Item Master

Defines by item and DC/centre the re-supply rules used for planning.

Planner

Defines the person responsible for planning an item or range of items.

Using Drinks Distribution Requirements Planning

When you have set up the basic data, you can start using Drinks DRP.

The system will be able to access data maintained through other modules - e.g. from Drinks Inventory Management - stock; from Drinks Purchase Management - supply from external sources; and from Forecasting (if installed) - Item and Item Group sales forecasts.

If there are outstanding transfer orders between distribution centres, it will be necessary to register details manually using the ad hoc Distribution Order Maintenance functions. Alternatively, if the number of orders are significant and are held on an existing computer system, it may be more cost effective to transfer data using a conversion routine commissioned for the purpose.

Installing Application Manager PTF's

Application Manager PTF's must be restored and installed as QSECOFR.



Note: To install the Application Manager PTF's the system must be in a minimum state (that is with no users or subsystems / jobs running - this is important)

Use a normal User ID to create the state then sign off and sign on as QSECOFR.

At the first screen, add in library OSLPTP1 (ADDLIB OSLPTP1 *FIRST)

Type in MNGPTF and install the PTF as normal.

Once installed, the library and PTF object can only be removed by QSECOFR. Install this PTF then sign off and sign back in as PTFOwner for subsequent PTF's.

If the above is NOT done, PTFOwner, being inside Application manager, will say the AM PTF is installed when it has not, as PTFOwner is using one of the objects the PTF requires, and the system will work - but will NOT have been updated.

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Chapter 4

Drinks EDI Application Interface

Overview



Introduction

The use of Electronic Data Interchange (EDI) can bring your organisation many measurable benefits:

Speed

EDI sends and receives documents quickly. There is none of the delay associated when mailing documents.

Accuracy

Since EDI transmits documents electronically, there is no need to re-enter the information, thus reducing keying errors.

Cost Savings

The quick turn-around of documents reduces inventory overhead and increases the available cash flow. EDI also reduces mailing costs.

Productivity

Employees are no longer needed to enter documents or address, stamp and mail envelopes, leaving them free to perform other tasks.

The System 21 Drinks EDI solution has two closely integrated components. These are:

- The System 21 Drinks EDI module
- Premenos EDI enabler

Together, these products satisfy the requirements of a successful EDI installation, namely:

- Controlled Application Interfaces
- Standard Message Format Support
- Conversion Facilities
- Communications Management Facilities

EDI provides support for the most widely-used Message Standards and Value Added Networks. It will also give mailbox access and document conversion facilities. The Drinks EDI module supplies the facility to import and export documents - in a controlled fashion - to and from the standard Sales Order Processing and Purchase Management modules.

Overview

You can use System 21 EDI to import and export of documents to and from Sales Order Processing and Purchase Management. These documents, traditionally sent and received in paper form, are exchanged as electronic messages.

The application will support:

- Inbound Sales Orders
- Outbound Acknowledgements
- Outbound Pick Notes to Third Party Trading Partners
- Outbound Advice of Despatch
- Outbound Sales Invoices
- Outbound Purchase Orders
- Outbound Sales Catalogues
- Outbound Product Catalogues
- Inbound Purchase Order Acknowledgements
- Inbound Advice of Despatch from Suppliers and Third Party Trading Partners
- Inbound Third Party Stock Balances
- Inbound Third Party Stock Adjustments
- Inbound Product Activity

The application can be used in two ways.

The application is designed to work very closely with the Premenos EDI enabler, EDI/400. This caters for the conversion of messages into and out of standard message formats. The Drinks EDI module adds new function for users of Sales Order Processing and Purchase Management in the shape of direct calls to EDI. So, for example, one interface option will allow the preparation of electronic purchase orders, and will also invoke a routine in EDI to convert those orders into standard message formats for onward transmission to suppliers. This close-coupled link to EDI removes the need for repeated manual intervention in the conversion and transmission process.

The second potential use for the interface module is as an electronic batch transaction facility. For example, it is common in certain industries for sales orders to be captured by the field sales force on portable microcomputers. Traditionally, these have then been re-entered onto the central Sales Order Processing application. With System 21 EDI, this is no longer necessary. Using existing facilities, the orders can be loaded up onto the host system, and taken into the order bank, in a controlled fashion, using the Drinks EDI module.

This module applies the same validation logic to inbound and outbound messages as is used in the conventional operation of the system. Full exception and audit reporting is provided.

Premenos EDI

Premenos EDI provides the following functions:

- Reformatting of messages between the internal format of System 21 and the formats of the major international EDI Standards.
- Communication modules to enable direct and straightforward connection to all the principal Value Added Networks.
- Support for point-to-point communications where a Value Added Network is not in use.
- Full transaction logging, error recovery and security features.

Support Of EDI Standards

EDI will support the following national and international EDI Standards:

- ANSI X12
- INCOME
- EDIFACT
- ODETTE
- Tradacoms
- TDB
- US

In addition, Premenos EDI contains a Standard Modification Tool, which will allow modification of Standards already defined to the product, and definition of new Standards.

Value Added Network Support

Premenos EDI is supplied with a module enabling connection to the Premenos Information Network. In addition, further communication modules are available to enable connection to any of the following Value Added Networks:

- INS/TRIDENT
- AT&T Easylink
- GEIS network services
- McDonnell Douglas network services
- Control Data/Redinet
- Sterling/Ordernet Version 3
- Kleinschmidt network services
- TranSettlement/Transend
- General Motors/GMNET

As well as the Value Added Networks (VAN) listed above, EDI will allow direct point-to-point communications between systems, where a VAN is not used.

Relationship To Other Applications

The following applications are pre-requisite to the Drinks EDI module:

- Drinks Inventory Management
- Drinks Sales Order Processing (for Sales documents only)
- Drinks Purchase Management (for Purchasing documents only)
- Application Manager

The application is designed to be able to add translated documents into the Mailbox Send Queue in the EDI application automatically. This requires, however, the trading partner being defined to both Drinks EDI and Premenos EDI.

Application Configuration

To set up the additional data required for sending and/or receiving documents via EDI, you need to create and maintain certain elements.

The main elements created and maintained within Drinks EDI are:

- Documents
- Trading Partners
- Location References

The main elements created and maintained within Premenos EDI are:

- Translation Maps
- Code Translation Tables

This documentation describes the Drinks EDI component. For more information about the set up and use of Premenos EDI, see the Premenos User Manual.

Documents

All document types to be sent via EDI must be defined in the Application Interface, for example, Purchase Order, Sales Invoice. Within this, the document ID must be specified for each EDI message standard used.

These definitions will be shared by all companies defined to the application.

Trading Partners

All trading partners - customers, suppliers or third parties, who are to be communicated with via EDI must be defined in the Application Interface.

Within this, the document types to be sent to each partner must be selected from those defined above. At this point you specify if the document is to be printed and/or sent via EDI for this trading partner.

Further details must be defined for the Trading Partner in the EDI application. These are required to support the document translation and communication functions in EDI.

Location References

Where delivery is required to multiple locations, a set of agreed location reference codes must be maintained in order to establish the correct delivery address.

Translation Maps

A translation map is required for each trading partner/document combination, whether they are sent or received. This is used by EDI to map data sent via EDI from the Application Interface database into the appropriate EDI message standard, and vice-versa for data received.

Code Translation Tables

A code translation table is required to convert codes, e.g., Units of Measure, Sales Tax, into the equivalent codes recognised by the appropriate message standard when sending documents.

Conversely, they are used to translate EDI standard codes into codes for receiving documents.

For more details on setting up trading partners see Trading Partners Maintenance and Third Party Trading Partners Maintenance.

Processing Cycle

The following example is provided to illustrate how the EDI processing cycle is supported by the Premenos EDI enabler. The example given is that of an incoming sales order. The procedure for outgoing messages is similar.

Although each step can be executed separately, the products can be configured to allow steps 1, 2 and 3 to be combined into one option leaving step 4 to be executed separately.

Step 1 Access Value Added Network

Having agreed with the applicable electronic trading partners which VAN is to be used to exchange messages, you can define it to Premenos EDI. This definition tells Premenos EDI how the connection to the VAN should be established.

Premenos EDI supports binary synchronous communications with all the networks for which communications modules are provided. The selected protocols can be used over leased or dialled lines. In the case of dialled connections, either autodial or manual dial is supported. During set-up, other parameters concerning communications with the network will be recorded. Premenos EDI stores these parameters with the telephone numbers for dialled connections.

For this example it is assumed that EDI has established the to the AS/400.

Step 2 Transfer Documents

Once the communications session is started, Premenos EDI will use the previously defined parameters to control the conversation with the network. Premenos EDI will then collect any messages in the network mailbox and transfer them down to its own mailbox on the AS/400. It also checks if there is any outbound mail, for example, acknowledgements that should be sent, and if there are it will transfer them up to the network mailbox. Premenos EDI will then distribute these to the appropriate trading partners. Premenos EDI maintains an on-line log containing the details of each communications session.

Once the transfer process is complete, Premenos EDI will - if appropriate - disconnect from the network.

The received message will now be sitting in the EDI mailbox. It can be displayed, printed or deleted while it is there. It can also be translated and moved into the Drinks EDI module.

Step 3 Translate To In house Format And Files

Before Premenos EDI can successfully translate an incoming order out of its EDI format and into the in-house Drinks EDI format, a number of definitions must have been set up within Premenos EDI:

- **Trading Partner Transaction Type**

This defines a unique business relationship regarding the two trading partners concerned in the transaction of a particular document, in this case an order. Premenos EDI uses this information when handling received messages. The information is also used when addressing and sending outbound messages.

Premenos EDI also uses the transaction type to identify the translation map that

should be used to translate the document (whether inbound or outbound). The transaction type records other information regarding the relationship that has been agreed with a trading partner, such as the network over which the document should be exchanged, the trading partner's network ID, and version and release values for the standard used.

- **Application Interface File Definitions**

The Drinks EDI module files that will receive the incoming order must be defined to Premenos EDI as 'user files'. During translation, Premenos EDI directs the translated data to these files.

- **Translation Map**

The relationship between the incoming Tradacoms order and the Drinks EDI module files has to be defined. To do this, a 'map' must be created. This map lies at the heart of the translation process. Premenos EDI moves data contained in the Tradacoms standard order into the corresponding Drinks EDI module files. A map is required for all EDI documents that are to be sent or received. This is true of all EDI standards.

- **Code Translation Tables**

EDI standards will often have pre-defined codes for certain data elements. These must be translated so as to be accepted as valid. Similarly, if your trading partner uses different values (e.g. UOM, delivery address or product codes), they must also be translated into values acceptable to the particular application. Hence code translation tables. Premenos EDI uses these tables to translate standard and trading partner-specific codes into values that are acceptable.

The translation process takes all these elements into account. When completed, the translated order will be written to the appropriate Drinks EDI file.

Step 4 Application Interface

Once Premenos EDI has successfully translated the incoming order and placed it in the Drinks EDI module file; a Drinks EDI option can be executed to place it on the Sales Order Processing order bank. This interface program performs the same validation upon the incoming orders that is applied normally to orders entered in to the system via the keyboard. Exceptions will cause the order to be suspended for further investigation. In the case of major exceptions, the order will be rejected. Full exception and control reports are provided.

The logic described in this example is applied to all inbound or outbound documents supported by Premenos EDI and the Drinks EDI module. In the case of outbound documents, for example purchase orders, most of the validation will already have been carried out by the application generating the document. For outgoing documents, Premenos EDI and the Drinks EDI module examine the validity of the document as an EDI message, deciding whether they should be sent via EDI and/or printed.

Third Party Trading Partners

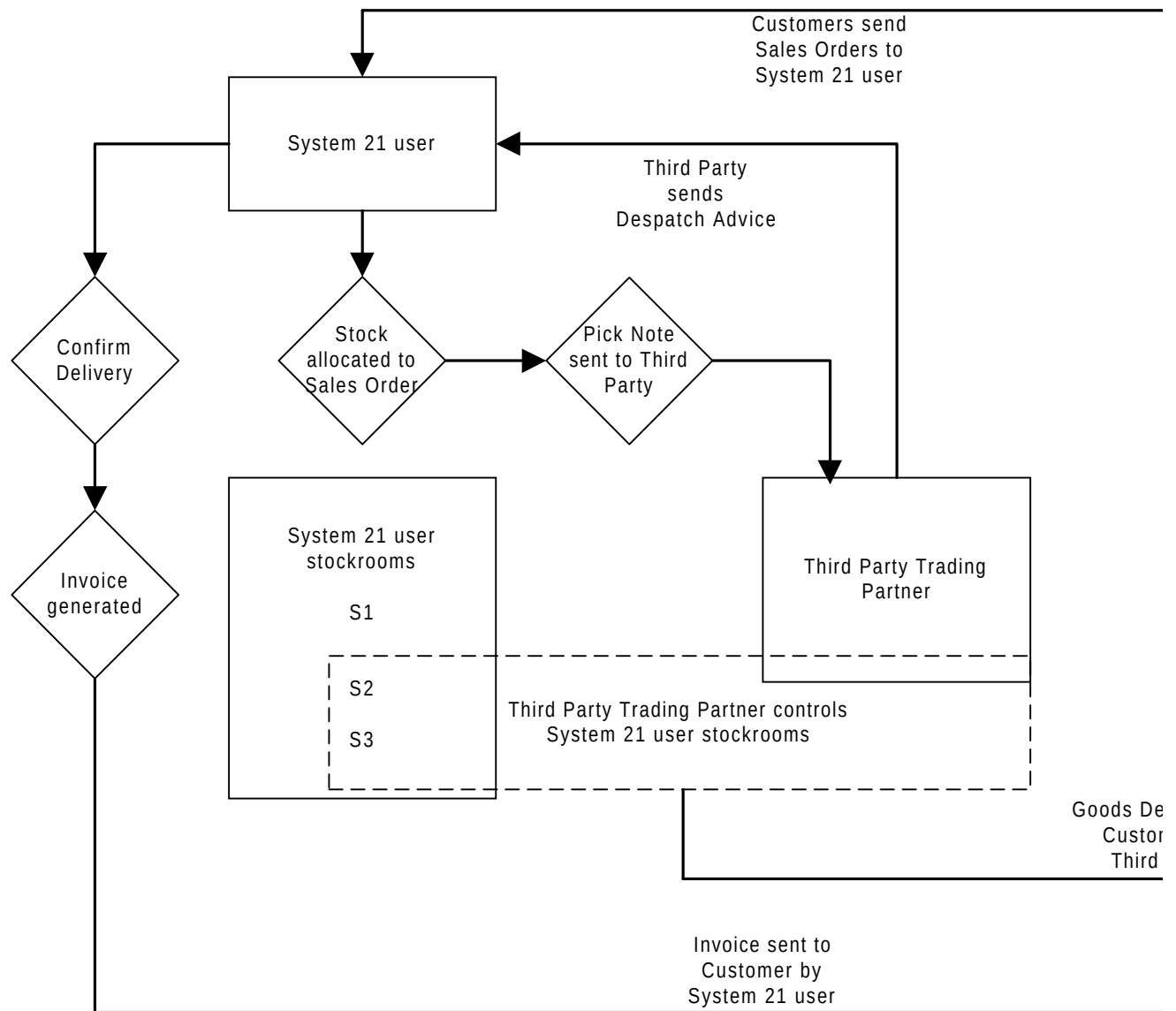
Drinks EDI includes facilities to transmit and receive EDI documents from Third party trading partners. Third party trading partners are organisations which manage stockrooms for the organisation using System 21.

The System 21 user takes orders from customers and sends picking notes to the third party trading partner. The third party trading partner manages the picking and despatch of the goods to the customer and sends despatch advises back to the System 21 user.

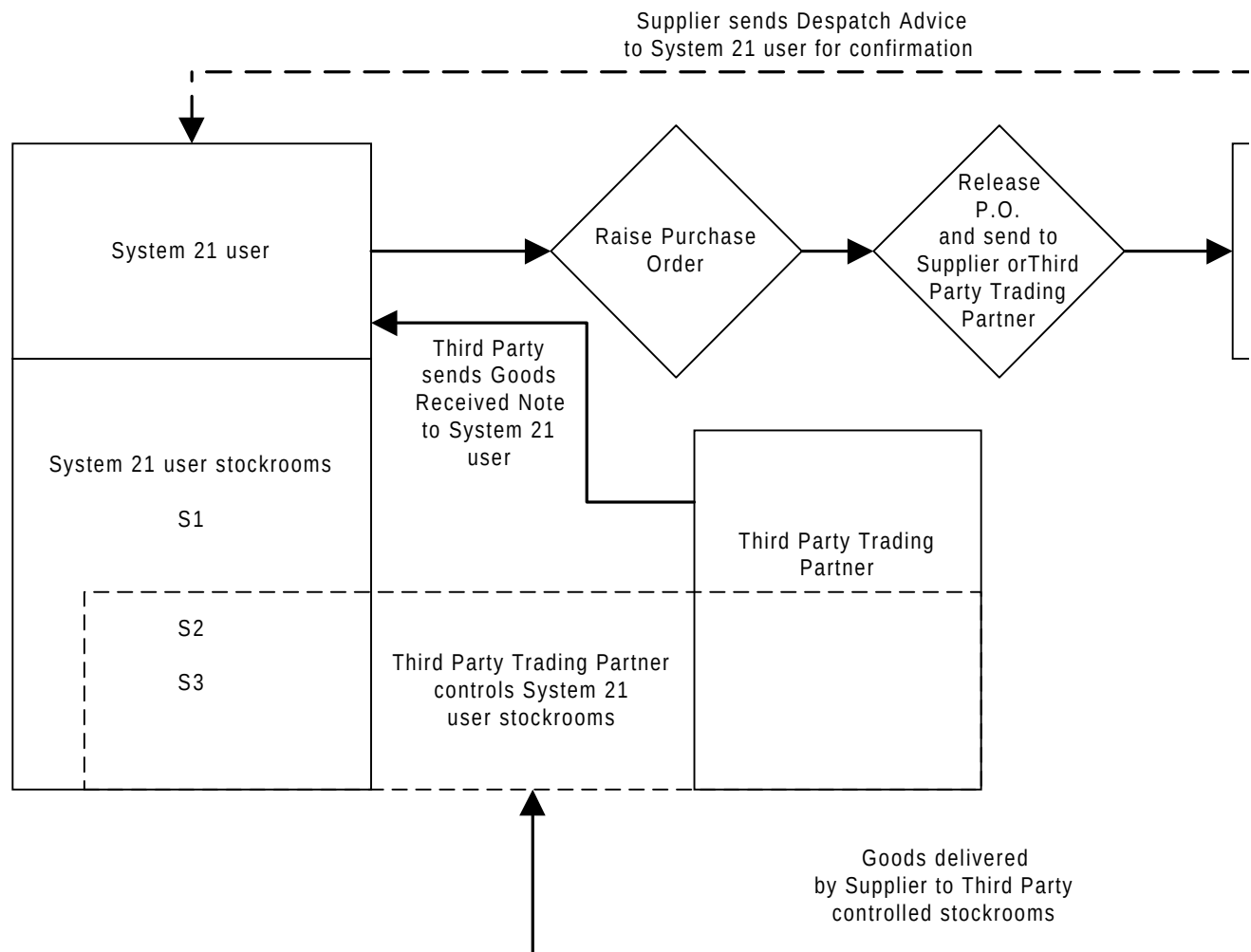
Similarly, the System 21 user places stock purchase orders with suppliers who deliver the stock to the third party controlled stockrooms. The third party trading partner then sends goods received notes back to the System 21 user.

The following diagrams illustrate these scenarios:

EDI and Customers



EDI and Suppliers



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Chapter 5

Drinks Inventory Management

Overview



Introduction

The world of commerce can be divided into organisations which provide goods and those which provide services. All those concerned with the acquisition and supply of goods are required to record, count, manage and account for inventory. It is one of the fundamental needs of all such companies. A system to keep proper control of Inventory is a pre-requisite for buying decisions, answering customer queries and deciding the production programme.

Different organisations require different levels of detail and support for Inventory Management decisions, and indeed this might vary within the same organisation. However, the basics of defining items, recording movement, even calculating balances and providing valuations will be common to all such companies.

Drinks Inventory Management provides a wide spectrum of facilities for the recording, valuation and management of Inventory. These facilities are the bed-rock on which the Drinks Distribution and Production Systems are built.

The module may be installed in a simple organisation which views its Inventory as a single logical unit, or with equal ease in a multi-depot organisation with separate raw material, finished goods and component stores. Multiple stockrooms or stores may be created, with the ability to maintain different stock investment policies in each. This is achieved without data redundancy as the same item definition is used throughout.

Relationships to Other Modules

Drinks Inventory Management is a fully standardised system and as such operates under the control of System Manager.

There are no pre-requisite modules for this module (apart from System Manager), moreover this module is a pre-requisite for all the Drinks Distribution and Production modules.

Although the module is designed to operate as a fully integrated module, it can be operated in a very simple fashion as a stand-alone system, including facilities to record sales and purchase activity as well as providing inventory recording and control.

Overall Implementation Considerations

Before setting up Drinks Inventory Management there are some fundamental issues to be considered:

- How do you wish to use Drinks Inventory Management and other modules?
- How many Drinks Inventory Management companies do you intend setting up?

The next two sections discuss these two issues in turn.

Drinks Inventory Management and other Modules

What are the functions which you intend Drinks Inventory Management to fulfil? For example are you intending to use Drinks Inventory Management on a stand-alone basis, and to record all stock movements through its own procedures?

If this is the case then this would simplify the implementation, as you would only need to be concerned about the set up requirements for Drinks Inventory Management.

If, however, you are installing other modules, then your implementation needs to take account of the requirements of those modules. As Drinks Inventory Management is a pre-requisite for all the Distribution and Production modules of Drinks, you can appreciate the need to consider its use in relation to the other modules.

Where Drinks Inventory Management is installed with other Drinks modules it provides:

- The basic database definition of items, stockrooms and code descriptions.
- The central repository for information on stock holding, whether at stockroom or lot level.
- The central audit of stock movements and history.
- The source of costing information for the valuation of movements and stock holding.
- The other Drinks modules therefore use Drinks Inventory Management as in the following examples:
 - Drinks Purchase Management uses the Inventory item definition; holds 'on-order' information as a stockroom balance quantity; and posts movement transactions to Drinks Inventory Management for receipts and returns.
 - Drinks Sales Order Processing uses the Inventory item definitions; makes use of parameters defined on the descriptions file; holds back order and allocation quantities as stockroom balance fields; and posts movement transactions to Drinks Inventory Management for customer issues and returns.
 - The Production modules use the Drinks Inventory basic item definitions; hold 'on-order' and allocation quantities as stockroom balance fields; and post movement transactions to Drinks Inventory Management for works order issues and receipts.

In a full Drinks implementation, it can therefore be seen that Drinks Inventory Management provides both basic data definitions and a transaction repository for a number of other modules.

This is, of course, in addition to the functions which are only available within Drinks Inventory - i.e. the stock management and stock taking facilities, and the stock adjustment transactions.

When planning your implementation it is therefore important that you consider:

- Which other modules do you plan to install?
- What requirements, in terms of data, will these modules look to Drinks Inventory Management to fulfil?
- How will the various stock movement requirements of the business be satisfied- by Drinks Inventory Management, or by one of the other modules?
- Will any other modules require an interface to Drinks Inventory Management?

Drinks Inventory Management Companies

Drinks Inventory Management, like all other Drinks modules, allows the simultaneous operation of discrete companies. Multiple companies are used for many reasons, but the major uses are either organisational, or for testing purposes.

A decision to set up multiple Inventory companies for organisational reasons may very well be taken because you require separate inventories. It is more likely, however, that multiple Inventory companies are required because you have separate operational organisations.

For example, you may require separate selling organisations to be reflected in separate 'companies' in the Drinks Sales Order Processing module. In a standard installation, this would require separate Drinks Inventory Management companies to be created.

Drinks Inventory Management companies interface on a one-to-one basis with companies in the following Drinks Modules:

- Purchase Management.
- Requisitioning.
- Sales Order Processing.
- Sales Analysis.
- Telesales.
- Distribution Requirements Planning.
- Production.
- Warehousing.

It can be seen, therefore, that any decision about the use of companies in Drinks Inventory Management needs to be taken in terms of the broader implementation.

Module Configuration

Having decided how you will use Drinks Inventory Management in conjunction with other modules and the companies you will use, you need to plan and implement the setting up of the basic data required for the module's operation.

The main details you will need to create or define fall into the following areas:

- Company Profiles.
- Stockrooms.
- Stock Weeks Matrices.
- Usage Profiles.
- Descriptions.
- Items.
- Stockroom Details.
- Alternatives.
- Kits.
- Calendars.

The maintenance of these elements is covered in detail in the Maintenance section of this Product Information.

Maintenance

As with all the modules, Drinks Inventory Management can be operated for a number of companies, the characteristics of each being maintained on a control file.

The module is controlled by setting up data for the company and then for each stockroom within the company. Stockrooms may be added after the initial implementation of the module.

The maintenance functions of Drinks Inventory Management enables the creation and amendment of master files and data which are fundamental to its operation. The module will then build the necessary transaction and movement histories as work progresses.

There are a number of common features in the way in which data is maintained, these are:

- The standard item and description search routines.
- A standard method of selecting codes from a displayed list.

The following data can be maintained:

- Standard Codes and Descriptions.
- Item Master Details.
- Alternative Items.
- Kit Lists.
- Stockroom or Balance Details.
- Calendar.
- User Stockroom Authorisation.
- Item Containers.
- Negativity Control.
- Tax Kits.
- Business Entity Names and Addresses.

Company and Stockroom Profiles

Certain policies may be set up as a default at the company level. These are:

- Costing method: Latest, Average, Standard or First In First Out.
- General Ledger codes.
- The period for usage calculation: weekly or monthly.
- Stock Management Policy factors:
 - Method of calculation.
 - Re-order quantity factor.
 - Stock carrying rate.

- Supply order placement cost.

These policies and parameters will be used throughout the operation of the module unless overridden at the level of the item or at the time of the transaction.

It is necessary to define each of the stockrooms where stock will be held. Four important policies can be set at this level:

- Firstly, the stockroom may be excluded from valuation, e.g. for consignment stocks.
- Secondly, certain transactions may be excluded from use in the stockroom.
- Thirdly, purchase officers authorised to process Purchase Orders against the stockroom.
- Finally, a value usage matrix can be created to manage the stock investment policy of the stockroom. Nine value/usage bands may be created and target minimum and maximum weeks of stock defined.

The module will automatically calculate average usage based on user-defined profiles. In order to make this calculation two factors must be defined:

- Whether usage is to be calculated on a weekly or monthly basis.
- Which periods are to be taken into account for the average usage calculation. You will need to decide how many of these profiles should be set up to reflect the different demand patterns in your business.

The weekly or monthly time period is set up on the Company Profile. A number of profiles may be maintained detailing which of the sixty previous time periods will be included in the calculation.

Standard Codes and Descriptions

Descriptions or parameters file is used by the system in most modules for a number of purposes. Primarily, it enables codes to be set up with standard descriptions. These codes cover such elements as item groups, item types, units of measure and reason codes.

The major type, or subject headings, are set up automatically if you use the Copy Company utility to create your company data initially. This provides for validation at the time of data entry and also the display of descriptions on both screens and reports. In some specific instances a rate is also stored, for example, in the case of Value Added Tax percentage.

The module has a small number of standard parameters that must be present for its successful operation, and these should be set up before continuing with further data set up.

The Drinks Inventory Management Descriptions file is the one used by all the Customer Service and Logistics modules. The standard parameters held on this file therefore include those required by all Logistics & Customer Service modules.

Item Data

Drinks Inventory Management is designed to have a flexible data structure, but without incurring data redundancy. In order to achieve, this there is an Item Master record which identifies the item to this module and indeed to all modules. This holds the static descriptive and classification data.

The Item Master details can be grouped into the following areas:

- Description and unique item number.
- Six different analysis codes - selection and sequencing is usual on these codes.
- Units of Measure (UOM) - three may be defined for each item. These should be set up in the descriptions file.
- Dual unit capability.
- Costing method, costs and default General Ledger codes. The costing method specified at item level overriding the default specified at Company level.
- Shelf life and storage information.
- Precision of inventory recording - single balance, batch/lot number or serial number.
- Supersession details.
- Search families.
- Drinks Industry Specific Details - volume, storage.

If more data is required in Drinks Inventory Management or any other module then a record of that information is set up and maintained in the originating module.

The following are examples of the additional data

- Drinks Inventory Management.
 - Stockroom Balance Records.
 - Lot Or Batch Records.
 - Extended Internal And External Text.
 - Kits.
 - Alternatives.
 - Search Family Codes.
- Drinks Purchase Management.
 - Item/Supplier Profiles.
- Production Modules.
- Production Profile.
- Drinks Warehousing.
 - Item/Warehouse Profile.
- Drinks Distribution Requirements Planning.
 - Item/DRP Profile.

In this way it can be seen that Drinks requires the entry and maintenance of only that data necessary to run the operational modules in any company's system.

Stockrooms

For any item, one or more stockrooms may be defined. A stockroom is a discrete area within a company where stock is recorded and controlled separately from other company stocks.

Depending upon the type of company a stockroom may be used to define divisions, depots, warehouses, stores, an area within a store or even van stock. If such distinctions are not required a single stockroom should be created to record the total company stock of the item.

The stockroom balance information is concerned with:

- Units of measure at the stockroom which will be used to express stock balances
- Drinks Inventory Management policy and control - reorder policies
- Balance data
- Costs
- Who is your preferred supplier?

Serial / Lot / Batch Control

The ability to track items at batch or lot number is an important feature of Drinks. All modules can perform inventory movements at the level of lot number. The control of the use of this facility is exercised at item level within the Drinks Inventory Management module.

Serial numbers are treated as a special instance of batch control, in that the module insists that a movement is limited to a quantity of one and the serial number is defined. Serial control should be specified for items with the same stock and issue unit only. It would not make sense to specify serial control for items packed in cases.

The facility to record stock at batch level can be used to record stock held at locations within a warehouse.



Note: It should be emphasised that if the full features of warehouse control are required, then Drinks Warehousing should be installed.

Alternative Items

For any item, one or more alternatives may be nominated. When the relationship is created, it is possible to state whether or not the relationship is reversed. This facility is used, during stock sourcing, by Drinks Sales Order Processing functions to offer customers alternatives if an item is not currently available.

Kit Lists

A kit of items may be set up to be used in Drinks Sales Order Processing. This is a single level kit with a single parent and any number of components. The quantity of components required can be maintained.

This can be processed as a sales kit within Drinks Sales Order Processing.

Where kits are sold, updates to Drinks Sales Analysis need to be considered - should details of the Whole Kit, Parent Only or Components Only be passed?

Calendar Control

Drinks Inventory Management must concern itself with dates, week endings and period endings, in order to perform reconciliation, usage calculations and information analysis.

Both week end dates and period end dates can be maintained for all operational years, and should be set up before processing begins for a new year.

A working days calendar can also be established which will be used by the system to calculate order due dates etc..

User Stockroom Authorisation

Although a user may create a stockroom and then attach items to it, they are not permitted to actually carry out any transactions until they are authorised.

For security purposes - to prevent users adjusting stock, ordering and receiving stock when inappropriate - user stockroom authorisation must be given.

Item Containers

The product can be stored in various containers, e.g. bottles, cans, cases, crates. These are defined in two groups: primary containers (referring to the unit closest to the liquid) and secondary containers (referring to the unit holding the primary container).

The purpose of this option is to monitor the storage of products and the conversion factors of returned goods.

Negativity Control

To incorporate flexibility of stock availability, this option permits over-allocation of an item (thus resulting in Negative Available Stock). This allows the generation of picking documentation for an order before actually having stock available in the stockroom.

Tax Kits

Tax Kits comprise various products (components) sold as one item. When an item is sold, it has tax charges attached to it. However, when these are packaged as a kit, they have a single tax attached to the header.

The feature of tax kits is to show the number of components of each item, which will be used as the basis for calculating the tax ratio for each item.



Note: Tax Kits are supported within US Bonded Inventory and state profile functions only.

Processing

Once all the basic data has been defined, the initial stock balances should be set prior to commencing processing.

There are four main activities in the operation of Drinks Inventory Management .

- Movement Transactions.
- Stock Counting.
- Stock Management.
- Periodic Processing.

The first two functions are concerned with performing the stock recording aspects, the third is concerned with deciding what stock should be where, and the fourth with building the database to aid management decisions. As the movement transactions are applied to the balances interactively, any displayed balance reflects the latest information in the system. Supply and despatch decisions can then be made in greater confidence.

Drinks Inventory Management can be installed in isolation; however, if Purchasing, Production and Sales Systems are installed most of the movements will be performed in these operational systems and Inventory Management will deal exclusively with counting, housekeeping and stock management decisions.

Initial Stock Balance Take-On

Once all the basic data has been set up, you are ready to set the initial stock balances prior to processing. This task may be undertaken as part of a conversion from another system, but where this is not the case the following inventory movements can be used:

- Physical Stock - use the Sundry Receipt option to set the initial shelf stock.
- Allocated Stock - use the Allocation Adjustment option to set any existing allocated stock level.
- Frozen Stock - use the Frozen Stock Adjustment option if you currently have stock which is unavailable for issue.
- On Purchase Order - use the Record Purchase Order option to reflect the current supply situation.

It is worthwhile entering all these movements with a narrative indicating "INITIAL SET-UP", so that they may be readily identified in the future. Making use of a standard procedure for this exercise means that a full audit is maintained in terms of movement records.

Movement Transactions

The purpose of a Drinks Inventory movement transaction is to record an action within the module and to calculate the effect on the stock balance. In its simplest form a Sundry Receipt booking straight into Drinks Inventory increases the physical stock.

A Customer Order Issue, however, will not only reduce the physical stock but also reduces the balance of the stock allocated to orders. The following movement types are available:

- Record purchase order.
- Sundry Receipt.
- Customer order issue.
- Sundry Issue.
- Adjustment to physical stock.
- Adjustment to allocated stock.
- Adjustment to frozen stock.
- Purchase order receipt.
- Bottle Receipt.
- Expense Account Adjustments.
- Transfer out to another stockroom.
- Transfer in from another stockroom.
- Transfer In and Out for a single item.
- Transfer In and Out for multiple items.
- Transfer In and Out for a single frozen item.
- Transfer In and Out for multiple frozen items.

Each of the movements updates the appropriate balance fields on the item stockroom balance. If the item is defined as being batch lot or serial controlled, the additional control number must be entered. A subset of the balances are maintained for the lower level record.

Costs may be entered with the movement. These depend upon the movement type and the costing method. The database will be updated appropriately.

There are four ways of valuing stock movements. These are:

Average Cost

The average cost of stock in the stockroom is recalculated everytime a receipt is made. This average cost is used to value issues.

Standard Cost

The standard cost for the item is either 'rolled over' from the Production module or directly maintained. This cost is used to value all movements, both receipts and issues.

FIFO Cost

This is the acronym for First In First Out. Each receipt for the item is maintained as a separate balance and as an issue is made it is consumed. The first receipt to arrive is the first receipt balance to be used for issues. The cost of the issue is taken from the receipt balance. The FIFO sequence is maintained by time as well as date. If the item is batch controlled then the FIFO operates within batch.

Latest Cost

The latest cost for a particular item is the cost of the last item received into the inventory.

The default or preferred method is set on the company control record. This, however, can be finally controlled at Item level. All costs are kept in base currency, correct to five decimal places. The latest cost of all items is recorded and the average cost calculated whatever the costing method. If, for example, the valuation method is FIFO this can be simply compared with the average and latest cost on an enquiry screen.

For each Inventory movement a record is written to a transaction file. This provides a full audit trail of movements. The information held includes:

- Movement type.
- Supplier or customer.
- Quantity moved.
- Value of the movement.
- Resulting stockroom balance.
- Batch/Lot number.
- Date and time of movement.
- Person responsible.
- Terminal used.

The movement week and period details are determined from the calendar and period files and set to either the current or next week/period.

The movement history may be held on the system as long as necessary, but not less than one month, because it is used to prove the closing balance at the end of the period. It is available for both enquiry and reporting to assist investigations into stock inaccuracies and provide the basis of activity analysis.

Stock Counting

The module provides a simple to use stock counting procedure which incorporates the cycle counting methodology. This enables the automatic creation of count recommendations. The following steps are involved:

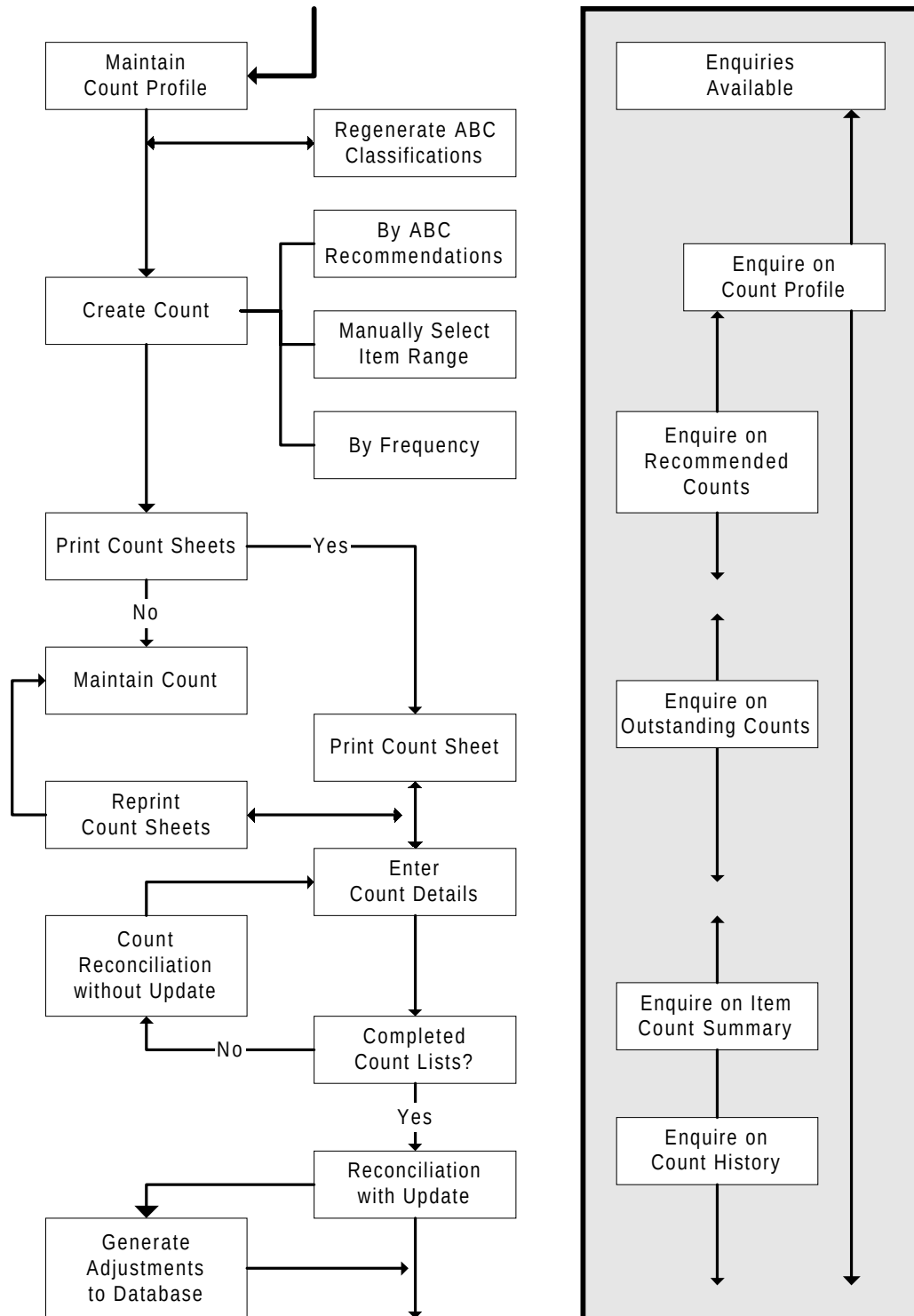
- Count creation - manually by item ranges or automatically on a time based cycle.
- Review / maintain count recommendations.
- Request printing of stock count sheets.
- Enter counted stock figures.
- Reconcile counted stock.
- Post adjustments if applicable.

If Drinks Warehousing is installed, all processing is assumed to be in the default warehouse and additional functionality allows stock count requests to be based on a physical cycle of warehouse locations or areas.

In Drinks Inventory Management, counts may be requested via two distinct methods:

- Time Based Cycle of ABC Classification
- Manual Requests by Item Selections

The following diagram represents the data flow through the Stock Counting functions:



Time Based Cycle of ABC Classification

This method automatically suggests items that require counting within a given stockroom, based on a predefined next due date. This date is defined from parameters set at the item and stockroom levels. The item/stockroom has a classification (A, B, C or Z), defined on the stock weeks matrix with an override classification that can be manually maintained. In addition, there are annual count objectives defined for each stockroom.

Manual Requests by Item Selections

This method requests counts by item range which can be selected on the following criteria:

- Item number.
- Item type.
- Item class.
- Item group major and minor.
- Stockroom.

Once counts have been created they are considered to be recommendations only, detailing items. These counts may be both reviewed, modified and deleted.

The module records the stock level of the selected item(s) at the start of the count. This enables everyday processing of movements to continue while stock is being counted, and reconciliation to take place on completion of the count. Stock count sheets are then produced at the required level of detail, i.e. all levels of inventory records are exploded for the selected items.

To facilitate the management of the count workload, the count can be partitioned by list within counts, by specifying a maximum number of instructions per list. Once the count sheets are printed the count is considered to be outstanding.

The total quantity of physical stock of each item counted is entered from the stocktake sheets. This data is validated and a report produced.

Until the stocktake is deemed complete, a reconciliation report of physical stock versus computer stock figures is available. This would normally be selected by the same parameters as used when requesting the original stock count sheets. The report highlights the differences between physical and computer figures, both actual quantities and value variance.

On completion of the stocktake the module offers the option to generate automatic adjustment of any discrepancies. Any variances outside the tolerances defined on the stockroom count profile are designated as count errors.

Once the count sheets have been requested, no stock movements should take place for the selected items until after the physical count has been entered and reconciled.

To assist in the reconciliation of any discrepancies, reports are available giving summary or detail information of stock movements, with particular options for detailing Negative Stock Balances, if required.

Stock Management

The system offers a number of stock management techniques including Material Requirements Planning (if production is installed) and Drinks Distribution Requirements Planning (DRP). Drinks Inventory Management, even in isolation, can be used to operate an order point stock management policy. The main factors in this policy are:

- Average usage.
- Reorder point and maximum stock.
- Reordering rules.

Average Usage

The usage of an item is held on the Stock History file, and is maintained either weekly or monthly according to the usage cycle specified on the company profile record. Average usage is re-calculated during week or month end processing, as appropriate.

The usage profile defines which of the preceding weeks' or months' usage are to be included in the calculation of average usage. The item stockroom balance record holds the code for the usage profile which will be used in the calculation of average usage.

Typically usage profiles will be set up to represent the following:

- Three months moving average.
- Twelve months moving average.
- Seasonal moving average. (This would be achieved by taking the previous month and the "next" month last year).

Care is taken to ensure that the average is only calculated from the start of the item's life even though the profile indicated that previous data should be included. This is to ensure that the average is not distorted by the absence of historic data.

Monthly usage should be used only where the period end dates match week ending dates.

Reorder Point and Maximum Stock

The parameters of maximum stock, reorder point, reorder quantity and economic order quantity may be maintained for each item in each stockroom.

Alternatively, by using the historical usage information maintained as a result of all movements, the module can calculate these figures. These calculations are based upon grouping items into the categories defined on the stock weeks matrix.

The definition of these groups is held on the stock weeks code matrix which is updated as part of the Company Profile Maintenance procedure.

Limits are set to define the boundaries for high, medium and low usage and value. Minimum and maximum stock holdings, expressed as weeks at average usage, are assigned to each of the nine categories.

The Minimum Stockholding In Weeks is the number of weeks' stock that will be left after the lead time has expired, and therefore, represents a safety stockholding. Safety stock is a measure of how likely the lead time and average usage are to increase.

When the procedure to calculate reorder point, maximum stock, etc., is run, the module reads the stockroom records and re-assesses, for allowed items, the reorder point and maximum stock quantities.

The system assesses where this item falls on the value axis of the stock weeks matrix based on its cost. It then determines where it falls on the usage axis based on its average usage.

Having assessed which of the nine categories this item falls into, the minimum and maximum stockholding (in weeks) are taken from the matrix and the following calculations performed:

Reorder Point = (Lead Time + Minimum Stockholding) x Average Usage

Lead time and minimum stockholding are expressed in weeks.

Maximum Stock = (Lead Time + Maximum Stockholding) x Average Usage

Lead time and maximum stockholding are expressed in weeks.

Reorder point and maximum stock are held on the item stockroom balance record.

Since average usage is used in the calculation procedure, it is best run after the week end or month end processing procedure in which average usage is re-calculated.

The module is also able to calculate an Economic Order Quantity as follows:

$$EOQ = \sqrt{\frac{2 * AU Y * OPC * IC * SCR}{100}}$$

where:

EOQ	=	Economic Order Quantity
AUY	=	Average Usage Per Year
OPC	=	Order Placement Cost
IC	=	Item Cost
SCR	=	Stock Carrying Rate %

Reordering Rules

The module supports three different reordering policies:

ROP/Max

When expected stock drops below the reorder point, order up to the maximum stock.

ROP/ROQ

When expected stock falls below the reorder point, order the reorder quantity.

Up To ROP

When expected stock drops below the reorder point, order enough to take the stock up to the reorder point. For example, if $ROP = 0$, this rule ensures that goods are only reordered when there is demand for them (a customer or Production order).

Available / Expected Stock

These are calculated as follows:

Available Stock = *Physical Stock - Frozen Stock - Allocated Stock - Picked Stock*

Expected Stock = *Available Stock + Stock in Transit + Stock on Supply Order - Stock on Back Order*

Periodic Processing

Although Drinks Inventory Management is a transaction based system which records events as they happen, many of the decisions concerning stock levels and raising and amending orders are based upon the performance of an item over time.

In order to do this, it is necessary to be able to view previous periods' activity. This is achieved by maintaining history files, not only of the transactions, but also summarised by type of transaction. These are maintained by running weekly, monthly and year end procedures.

Packaging Requirements

Packaging Requirements provides a complete set of facilities for analysing and reporting of packaging information. This information will help you to produce the packaging statistics that need to be submitted to the appropriate authority. You use the information produced to complete the standard documentation provided by the authorities.

You use Packaging Requirements to enter information about how much of each type of packaging is used when a product is shipped to a domestic customer over a specified period.

Enquiries

The enquiries in Drinks Inventory Management allow a multi-layered view of an item. These layers are:

- Company stock summarised by stockroom.
- Full details of the current balance, usage, and cost at a stockroom.
- The breakdown of a stockroom balance into the batches or lots that comprise the stock holding.
- The movements that gave rise to the present balance.
- The summary of activity for previous periods.
- Expense Account balances.

In addition, the reference files are supported by a full range of enquiries.

Reports

The reports produced by Drinks Inventory Management can be classified as:

- Status.
- Audit.
- Valuation.
- Movement Analysis.
- Action.

Status reports are provided on the master files and particularly on the item file. Audits with before and after images are printed on request. These include all changes since the previous print.

Installing Application Manager PTF's

Application Manager PTF's must be restored and installed as QSECOFR.



Note: To install the Application Manager PTF's the system must be in a minimum state (that is with no users or subsystems / jobs running - this is important)

Use a normal User ID to create the state then sign off and sign on as QSECOFR.

At the first screen, add in library OSLPTP1 (ADDLIB OSLPTP1 *FIRST)

Type in MNGPTF and install the PTF as normal.

Once installed, the library and PTF object can only be removed by QSECOFR. Install this PTF then sign off and sign back in as PTFOwner for subsequent PTF's.

If the above is NOT done, PTFOwner, being inside Application manager, will say the AM PTF is installed when it has not, as PTFOwner is using one of the objects the PTF requires, and the system will work - but will NOT have been updated.

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Chapter 6

Drinks US Bonded Inventory

Overview



Introduction

Drinks Bonded Inventory Management provides the wine and spirit distribution industry in the United States, with an efficient method of controlling stocks in a duty free environment.

One of the key benefits of Drinks Bonded Inventory Management is the linking of distribution functions with Duty reporting requirements.

In line with other modules, users may define more than one operating company, but more importantly, users may define any number of Bonded Stockrooms.

Relationships with Other Modules

Drinks Bonded Inventory Management makes use of primary data held in the Drinks Inventory Management and Drinks Sales Order Processing modules.

It is within Drinks Inventory Management that details of items are held, including gallons per case and bottles per case.

Drinks Inventory Management also contains a database of codes and descriptions used to hold such details as country of origin, ports of entry, goods category (E.g.: Wine, Gin, etc.). This description database is used to validate data entry and ensure consistency in the data recorded.

The status of Warehouse/Stockroom codes - Duty Free (Bonded) or Duty Paid are defined within Drinks Sales Order Processing . Similarly, the status of customers (Export, Duty Paid, etc.) are defined within Drinks Sales Order Processing.

System 21 Production Applications recognise Bonded Stockrooms for Production Receipts only. If you are using the System 21 Production Applications in conjunction with Drinks Bonded Inventory Management, Bonded Stockrooms should not be defined as:

- Issuing stockroom on Production Routes or Production Orders.
- Issuing stockroom on any Transaction Booking in Production.
- Shop Floor stockrooms.

All Item/Stockroom Details must be defined using the Drinks Item/Stockroom Details Maintenance. In particular, all shop floor component stockroom balance must be defined in the Drinks Application before use in Production.

All Item master details must be defined using the Drinks Applications. The Production item master, 'based on' facility can only be used after the Inventory Item Master has been defined in the Drinks Application.

Maintenance

Company Profile

As with all the modules, Drinks US Bonded Inventory may be used by a number of companies, each with differing requirements. A profile of each company using the system is maintained, detailing such things as the name of the company and certain processing options.

Bond / Stockroom Profile

Customs and BATF Bonds, throughout the United States may be defined within Drinks Bonded Inventory Management. Export and other Duty Free locations may also be defined to the system in order to ensure that the supply of goods causes the production of the appropriate dispatch documents and the relevant US tax liability.

It is possible to operate Duty Paid and Duty Free stockrooms within the same company. Provision is also made for controlling broken cases by defining bottle stockrooms within a Bond.

To maintain independence from other module time periods, each Bond has its own calendar, which holds critical dates relevant to the production of Duty reports and the triggering of period end processing.

There is no significant restriction to the number of stockrooms defined within Drinks Warehousing and Drinks Inventory Management modules all within the same Bond.



Note: Drinks US Bonded Inventory is not currently supported with Drinks Warehousing.

Reference Data

The following Customs and Excise reference data is defined within the Drinks US Bonded Inventory module:

- Commodity Codes/Tax Types.
- Preferential Duty Rates.
- Preferential Groups.
- Quota Duty Rates.
- Item Variants/Customer Items.
- Rotation Details.

The above define the tax rules and values necessary for the calculation of Customs and BATF Excise duties.

Each item defined within Drinks Inventory Management is also defined within Drinks Bonded Inventory Management in order to specify the associated tax codes, duty status, spirit strength (where relevant) and country of origin.

Identical products sourced from different countries, or with varying spirit strengths, may be assigned the same item number. Each variant of the same item may be given unique tax codes/strengths as appropriate.

Processing

The main transaction types recognized for Excise reporting are:

- Goods Receiving.
- Dispatch.
- Stock Losses (write-offs).
- Stock Gains.
- Stock Counting.
- Payment of Customs Duty within Bond.

The goods receiving processes are performed within either Drinks Inventory Management or Drinks Purchase Management. These processes have been enhanced to accommodate the logging of additional data when receiving goods into a Bond.

Similarly, the dispatch processes performed within the Drinks Sales Order Processing module have been enhanced to accommodate the production of clean dispatch notes and where applicable, the necessary duty free documentation.

Recording losses and gains are provided by Drinks US Bonded Inventory, and in the case of stock losses, payment or non-payment of duty is determined by the transaction reference selected.

Payment of Customs Duty within Bond, otherwise known as Marking Goods In Free Circulation, is performed within Drinks US Bonded Inventory.

Stock Counting within Drinks US Bonded Inventory Management provides for the production of count documents, sorted by location or by rotation. After recording physical stocks, a variance report is available listing items in the sequence specified.



Note: Inventory Stock Counting provides an alternative procedure to Bond Stock Counting as Bond is included in this function. Inventory Stock Counting is the recommended function for stock counting.

Inquiries

Drinks Warehousing and Drinks Inventory Management provide the main source of information for inquiring on stock status, by item and by location.

The Drinks US Bonded Inventory module provides for additional inquiries, as follows:

- Rotation.
- Consolidated Audit.
- Item Variant.

The Rotation Inquiry accesses the original consignment details and Customs and BATF references as well as the Drinks US Bonded Inventory transaction movement log.

All key reference data updates are logged and reported. In addition, it is possible to inquire on these updates.

The item variant inquiry provides for the identification of a given variant where a number of variants are assigned to the same item.

Reports

Drinks US Bonded Inventory has its own independent logging of transactions where the transactions are relevant to bond movement reporting.

All regular transaction reports are contained within a Daily Duty Run, with each report being consecutively numbered from one day to the next. Reports produced by the Duty Run are:

- Adjustments/Breakages.
- Customer Duty and Duty Free Analysis.
- Movement Audit.
- Report of Dispatches.
- Report of Receipts.
- C88A Backup Report.

In addition, key reference data changes may be reported and Duty Dispatch documents still outstanding for return can be listed.

By numbering each report, the majority of the above reports may be re-printed by quoting the original report number.

A number of other reports are available by request:

- Tax Drawbacks.
- Daily Dispatches.
- Daily Transaction Summary.

Utilities

Drinks US Bonded Inventory contains utility functions which are intended for use at system installation time, or under special circumstances.

These utilities enable ease of software installation, and continued maintenance.

Pre-Requisites

Drinks US Bonded Inventory requires the following to be installed before installing this module.

- Drinks Inventory Management.
- Drinks Sales Order Processing.
- Drinks UK Bond Inventory.

Drinks Purchase Management, the Financial modules, Drinks Telesales, and Drinks Sales Analysis may be included with this module, but are not essential.

Basic Data

The data elements essential to this module are as follows:

- Company profiles for all modules.
- Descriptions.
- Processing Profiles within Drinks Inventory Management.
- Stockrooms / Depots in Drinks Inventory Management and Drinks Sales Order Processing.
- Items.
- Stockroom Details.

Installing Application Manager PTF's

Application Manager PTF's must be restored and installed as QSECOFR.



Note: To install the Application Manager PTF's the system must be in a minimum state (that is with no users or subsystems / jobs running - this is important)

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Chapter 7

Drinks Sales Order Processing

Overview



Introduction

The recording and progressing of a company's sales orders is a basic commercial activity. It could be argued that it is the most important, for if a company ceases to satisfy its customers, it cannot expect to continue to survive.

Computer systems have been used for many years to help companies record and manage their customers' orders. Increasingly, service is being used as a way of differentiating a company from its competitors. In order to achieve this 'Right First Time' philosophy in all dealings with the customer, a flexible and comprehensive Sales Order Processing module is required.

Drinks Sales Order Processing has a breadth of functions, which not only enable it to be used by a variety of commercial organisations, but also to change as a company grows and develops in response to a changing environment. To facilitate the growth and expansion of a company, the package has incorporated multi-currency and European functionality. European functionality calculates the correct VAT and identifies the payment terms for the order.

The module is designed to support a rapid 'data entry' style of order entry for use when very few changes or overrides are required. Order entry can also be performed whilst conversing with the customer which supports the greatest level of flexibility including a prompt to assist in offering an alternative item or sourcing from another depot.

Although the module contains a variety of pricing and discounting routines, in certain circumstances it is necessary to enter a negotiated price or discount. The order will be suspended if non standard conditions, such as zero pricing or credit check failure, arise during entry. This allows order taking to continue unhindered, but errors to be trapped.

Day to day decisions are supported by a range of enquiries, which enable stock availability to be projected into the future, customer credit to be examined and orders to be displayed by customer's reference, item number and account.

Relationships to Other Modules

Drinks Sales Order Processing is a fully standardised module.

Careful and detailed planning prior to the introduction of the new module is important. When Drinks Sales Order Processing is installed, two major areas must be considered. These are:

- Have the pre-requisite modules already been installed; and, if so, are they set up in a way which is suitable for the operation of Sales Order Processing?
- How will the functions and facilities of Drinks Sales Order Processing be used to satisfy the company's basic needs?

The following modules are pre-requisites to Drinks Sales Order Processing:

- Drinks Inventory Management
- Accounts Receivable

Normally, Sales Analysis would be installed with Sales Order Processing to provide flexible enquiry and reporting on the sales activity of the company.

What Does It Do?

The fundamental purpose of Drinks Sales Order Processing is to record and control your sales orders. There is a direct relationship between Drinks Inventory Management and Drinks Sales Order Processing. The company must be defined on the Inventory Management order for it to be available on Drinks Sales Order Processing. Similarly, Drinks Sales Order Processing raises invoices for all despatches made from the company and it expects to post them to the customers' accounts in Accounts Receivable.

There is, therefore, a simple relationship between the modules for one company; that is, the modules of Drinks Inventory Management, Accounts Receivable, Drinks Sales Analysis and Drinks Sales Order Processing must share the same two character company code.

A number of Drinks Sales Order Processing functions depend directly on data held in the Accounts Receivable and Drinks Inventory Management modules. These are as follows:

- The currency of the Drinks Sales Order Processing module is determined by the currency setting for the Accounts Receivable company.
- The currency of a customer is determined by the currency setting on the customer's Accounts Receivable account. However, this can be changed at order level.
- Drinks Sales Order Processing may only sell sales kits which have been set up and maintained within the Drinks Inventory Management company.
- Only alternatives set up in the Drinks Inventory Management company will be prompted as replacements for shortages during sales order entry, stock allocation is usually performed by examining the order and choosing the stockroom/depot for the order line. The items must be defined to a valid Drinks Sales Order Processing depot.
- Sales made for kits of items can update Drinks Sales Analysis in a number of ways. These options are controlled on the Item Master record.
- The Analysis Codes on the Item Master record are not only used within Drinks Inventory Management for reporting, but also form the basis of Drinks Sales Analysis. Considerable care must be taken to ensure that the coding structure which is set up will meet the analysis needs for the foreseeable future, as the regeneration of the Drinks Sales Analysis database is time consuming.

Additionally, it is possible to use other modules to improve the control and operation of certain processes:

- Drinks Transport Planning provides the ability to assign customer deliveries to loads. This enables bulk picking lists to be requested and processed.
- Drinks Distribution Requirements Planning enables, among other activities, the ordering, despatch, and receipt of, internal orders from one company's Depot to another.

- Drinks Warehousing provides control systems for the running of a warehouse. This enables picking and marshalling to take place with the specification of locations (shelves/racks/bays etc.) plus pack control.

Using Drinks Sales Order Processing

It is essential that detailed discussions take place which review the facilities offered by the module and that decisions are made as to how each stage of the order cycle will be handled. For example:

- In what circumstances will Sales Order entry be used?
- In what circumstances will Telesales order entry be used?
- How will pricing/discounting be carried out?
- How will pick lists be raised, and how will they be confirmed?
- Under what circumstances will order acknowledgements be sent?
- What use will be made of the priority allocation rules?

All the above are fully discussed in the body of this product information. Some of the decisions require control data to be set up in the modules in order to implement them; others are a matter of agreed procedure; all directly affect the service which you provide to your customers.

Module Configuration

As with all the modules, Drinks Sales Order Processing can be operated for a number of companies, the characteristics of each being maintained on a control file. The module is controlled by setting up data both for the company and for each depot. This will normally occur after the Inventory and Accounts Receivable companies have been created. The Accounts Receivable, Drinks Inventory Management, and Drinks Sales Order Processing all use the same company codes for interfacing.

Certain data and policies may be set up as a default at the company level. These are:

- Company name and address.
- Document reference numbers for orders and invoices.
- Period and week numbers.
- Defaults for additional customer details.
- Borders printed on documents.
- Nominated fields for use as search arguments for customer selection.

These policies and parameters will be used throughout the operation of the system unless overridden at customer or order level.

When Drinks Inventory Management is set up, a number of stockrooms can be created. These will be created for a number of purposes, only some of which may be concerned with sales and distribution. Any stockroom from which sales are to be made must be designated as a depot and defined as such within Drinks Sales Order Processing. As well as address and contact information, allocation parameters can be maintained for each depot.

The other essential factors that need to be considered before the order process can be fully operational are:

- Company profiles.
- Depot profiles.
- Price & discount lists.
- Customer details.
- Descriptions.
- Items.
- Containers.
- Alternatives.
- Kits.

Company Profile

The module requires defaults to be set up prior to undertaking the order process. These can be defined in the company profile, and will apply to all the customers within this company. The issues that need to be addressed are:

- Will you wish generally to allow back orders and part deliveries?
- What is the default priority which you wish to give to new orders, and what are the steps by which that priority is to be incremented when allocation fails?
- Do you want to allow allocation to a level where available stock is negative?
- Do you, as a rule, wish to price orders at order, or despatch time?
- Which fields in the customer database do you wish to use to form part of your customer search facility?

Module Reference Data

The following reference data can be maintained:

- Standard Codes and Descriptions.
- Customers.
- Depot Profiles.
- Prices and Discounts.
- Delivery Note Messages.
- Trailer Details.
- Credit Controllers.
- State & City Profiles.

Standard Codes and Descriptions

A descriptions or parameters file is used by Drinks in most modules for a number of purposes. Primarily, it enables codes to be set up with standard descriptions. This provides for validation at the time of data entry and also the display of descriptions on both screens and reports. In some specific instances a parameter or number is also stored, for example, the case of value added tax percentages.

The module has a small number of standard codes and parameters that must be present for the successful operation of a specific module. Some of these are maintained in Drinks Inventory Management as it is the base module for both Distribution and Manufacturing modules. Maintenance, however, can be performed from most modules, including Drinks Sales Order Processing. There are codes specific to Drinks Sales Order Processing which you will need to set up - e.g. customer classes, cash discounts, extra charges, sales analysis groups etc.

Customers

The information held in the system for customers is of equal interest to those managing and collecting the debt as to those recording and progressing sales orders. The maintenance routines in each module reflect their specific requirements. They both, however, create and maintain a common database with access to common and exclusive information. For example, Drinks Sales Order Processing provides functions to control stock allocation, pricing and sales analysis coding.

The structure of the customer information can be manipulated to match the structure of the customer's organisation. Customer accounts can be set up as single accounts, or as 'statement accounts' with many 'invoice to accounts', each of which may have many 'delivery accounts'.

Statement Account

This is shared with Accounts Receivable. This is created in Accounts Receivable, the data held at this level includes credit details, Accounts Receivable parameters and statistical codes.

Invoice Account

If the statement account address is not the same as the invoice address, a separate invoice account needs to be set up in Drinks Sales Order Processing. This account does not have sales orders assigned to it. Instead the despatch account contains a field in which you can identify an invoice account. The invoice account will contain the address of the customer where the invoice for those deliveries should be sent.

Despatch Account

Many despatch addresses may be set up for an account. This is done by adding a three-character suffix to the eight-character statement account code.

Additional Information

Each account to which items are delivered may have additional data to act as defaults during order entry. It includes data on sales depot, price list, discount list, allocation priority, back order parameters, part deliveries and analysis codes. This enables different parts of a customer's organisation to have different commercial terms and be serviced from a different depot. In Drinks Sales Order Processing extra details are held for sales business control and Customs and Excise (Bond).

Depot Profiles

Depot profiles provide details of stockrooms within the company which are allowed to have sales orders raised on them. There is a Maintenance and an Enquiry function available, allowing you to set up, maintain and enquire upon the stockroom profiles of those stockrooms assigned to Drinks Sales Order Processing as depot.

The most important items of information are as follows:

Allocation Priority

The default priority for orders to be despatched from the stockroom.

Allocation Time Fence

The allocation time fence is a period of time in days. If the delivery due date is less than the current date plus the time fence, allocation will be attempted.

Prices and Discounts

In order to get the full benefit from Drinks Sales Order Processing, pricing and discounting should be performed by the module. This reduces errors, and hence credit notes and customer irritation. The system provides for pricing to be performed at both order entry, using customer and item criteria, or at despatch. Alternatively, prices and discounts may be set manually. Many price and discount lists can be set up. This may be necessary for a number of reasons, for example, different market sectors, customers or multiple currencies. Discounting can be based upon quantity or value and may be given in terms of percentage or value. A discount may apply to an item, a range of items or the whole order. Customers may be entitled to special discounts depending on their method of payment and the time it takes them to pay. However, certain considerations must be examined before setting up the price list:-

- Who, within your organisation, will be allowed to maintain lists? This authority is specified on the price/discount list profile which must be set up for each list.

- How many lists do you require? Will you wish to set up lists which are unique to individual customers, or for use on special orders?
- Within your discount lists, will you be able to specify discounts for groups of items, or are they to be specified for individual items? Will you use whole order discounts?

Effectivity dates can be used to control the module of new prices and discounts.

Price Lists

A price list can be used throughout the company or for an individual customer or for a customer group.

The item or item group entries within a price list have an effectivity start date so that price changes may be entered onto the system in advance of their introduction.

Global increases by percentage can be applied to an individual price list. A new list may be created by copying an existing list.

Discount Lists

A discount list can be applied throughout a company, or to an individual customer, or to a customer group, in a similar manner to price lists.

Discounts can be based on quantity or value breaks, either in the form of a percentage or an amount.

A discount can be allocated to an individual item, or alternatively the same discount can be given to all items in a discount group.

A discount group is an attribute of an item and is set up in Item Maintenance to group related items for discounting purposes.

Delivery Note Messages

There is a maintenance option allowing special messages to be set up for printing exclusively on delivery notes. These messages can relate to specific customer attributes - for example:-

- Region.
- Territory.
- Depot.
- Division.

Trailer Details

This option allows the set-up and maintenance of Trailers - detailing numbers, owning centres and service details - which can be referenced in Order Entry/Amendment, Tagged Goods Returns and Uplift Processing.

In conjunction with Drinks Distributed Requirements Planning (DRP), information regarding the last two locations (and associated dates) of any trailer can be enquired upon, enabling you to know when a trailer's service is due, and where that trailer is located (at which internal depot).

If Drinks DRP is not attached, the trailer number can be used at Confirm Assembly time to note which trailer orders/loads were used. The number

entered during Confirmation of Assembly prints on the Delivery Note for your information.

Credit Controllers

This maintenance option allows users to be authorised as Credit Controllers for Suspended Order Release.



New controllers can added by typing the User ID and name in the input fields at the bottom of the screen and pressing **Enter**.

State & City Profiles

The State & City Profiles are used throughout the Sales Details of Drinks Sales Order Processing to provide restrictions in the following areas:

- Buying Lists.
- Taxation State.
- City Code.
- Tax Group.

Order Processing Cycle

Drinks Sales Order Processing has six main procedures:

- Enter order details.
- Stock allocation.
- Pricing, discounting and credit checking.
- Pick items from stock and despatch.
- Confirm Delivery. (This is detailed in the Picking & Despatches Section).
- Raise invoice.

Each one of these procedures has a number of tasks each with a large number of options.

Enter Order Details

The Drinks System provides two major types of order entry - Telesales or Sales Order Entry. During Sales Order Entry there is the ability for rapid data entry from an order pad, for example, and there is the ability to be more selective at order entry (e.g. examining stock availability).

There are three phases:

- Order header.
- Order lines.
- Extra charges.

There are also two alternative types of order:

- Tagged Goods.
- Uplift.

Order Header

The customer is identified and the standard defaults such as pricing, allocation rules, currency, supplying depot and trading terms are retrieved. The currency of an order may be changed to any currency specified in the General Ledger if the customer is able to place multi-currency orders.

Order Lines

Sales Orders are entered one item at a time with opportunity to discuss availability and offer alternatives. In this instance, stock allocation is normally interactive, taking into account the required due date for the order line. Drinks has function whereby stockrooms can be linked together providing multiple stockroom allocation if required.

Extra Charges

Standard extra charges may be held on the descriptions file. These may be viewed and added to an order during the closing procedure. The actual charge may be retrieved from the file or entered specifically for the order.

Order Acknowledgement & Proforma Invoice

As a way to inform customers that their orders are being processed you have the option to print out acknowledgements.

Customers may also be defined as Cash with Order, with the ability to create a Proforma Invoice so as to obtain payment prior to allocation / picking / despatch.

Stock Allocation

When an order line is considered for allocation, whether interactively or in batch, the due date is compared with the time fence for the depot (this time fence is the number of days required to prepare and deliver orders to the customer). Thus stock is allocated as late as practical and maximum flexibility is retained. During batch allocation it is necessary to sequence order lines for allocation to enable high priority orders to be met. The priority of an order can be taken from the customer or entered at order time. If low priority orders are not satisfied their priority can be increased automatically. This means that at some time their priority becomes the highest and they take precedence.

During stock allocation you may find stock shortages, so it is possible to identify alternatives. There is also a feature whereby allocation can take place even though there is a shortage up to a certain level. (This is called negativity).

Alternative items and kit lists are used within Drinks Sales Order Processing, but are set up and maintained in Drinks Inventory Management. If you do set up alternatives, it is important to decide whether a relationship is reversible. Where kits are used, the issues relating to the update of Drinks Sales Analysis need to be addressed - should details of the whole kit, parent only or components only be passed? The indicator governing this update is maintained on the item definition in Drinks Inventory Management.

Pricing, Discounting and Credit Checking

In order to get the full benefit from computerised Sales Order Processing, pricing and discounting should be performed by the system. This means that it must have a fundamentally flexible approach to pricing and discounting. The actual price and discounts charged are a function of the trading relationship with the customer, therefore, the trading currency is assumed to be the prime currency of the customer's account. This information is part of the additional data held for customers.

It is possible to set up Price / Discount lists based on various combinations of: Item, Item Group, Customer, or Customer Group.

The various price and discount lists are searched in priority sequence to determine the actual price and discounts which will apply to a particular order line.

In some cases the prices charged on the invoice are dependent upon the date the order is received. In other instances the price and discount is determined at the time of despatch. The Drinks Sales Order Processing system provides for these decisions to be made for the company in general, for the customer or specifically for the order.

Prices and discounts are defined as follows:

Price

In the prime currency of the customer account.

Taken from a price list at order entry or despatch.

Expressed in the selling units of the order (multiplied by a conversion factor on the price list if required).

Discount 1

A percentage or value.

A discount for the item / item group as given on the discount list.

A variable discount depending upon the value or quantity volume of the item sold.

Discount 2

A variable discount depending upon the value of the whole order.

Credit Checking

Credit checking does not prevent the entry of an order into the module. However, orders that fail a credit check are suspended, i.e. are ignored by stock allocation, and have to be released.

Credit checking is performed when:

- The order is entered, in which case the outstanding debt is compared with the credit limit and the credit stop flag is checked.

- Allocation takes place, when the outstanding debt and the current outstanding allocations are both considered.

A customer may be within a hierarchy.

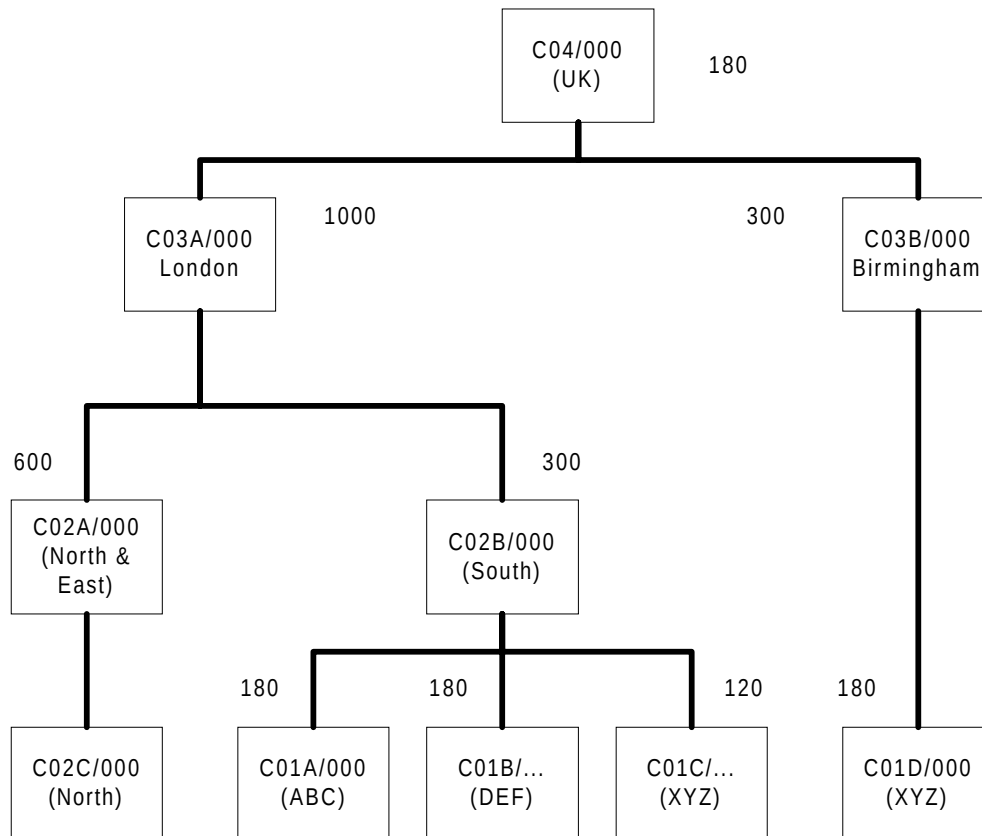
The module provides for the storage of two credit limits - commercial and insured. The commercial value is used for credit checking purposes.

Orders for customers who have exceeded their credit limit are suspended with the code 'CL', and for customers who have been placed on credit stop with the code 'CS.'

Hierarchy Credit Checking

The credit check and account summary balance update functions within Drinks Sales Order Processing, take account of any payment hierarchies in which the customer is defined.

Consider the following hierarchical relationship:



*Note: Credit Limits are shown in **bold** typeface.*

When the credit checking process takes place, it is performed at each level. (Refer to the diagram whilst following the example.)

Examples:

Example 1:

- ABC place an order for £180:
 - C01A/, C02B/, C03A/ and C04/ credit limits are checked.

- If credit check passes, stock allocation takes place and available credit is reduced by the order value.
- ABC place another order for £50:
 - First order not yet cleared, therefore available credit is currently at £0.00.
 - CO1A/ fails credit check. The order is suspended and reason code 'HL' is assigned to it.
- DEF place an order for £180:
 - CO1B/ credit limit is checked and passed.
 - When CO2B/ credit limit is checked the order is suspended, code 'HL'.
 - The reason for this is that the credit limit for CO2B/ has been reduced to £120 after ABC placed their order (account is still outstanding).

The credit checking process will also examine the status of the customer's account. The account may be flagged to indicate it is on hold for a number of reasons, e.g. too many outstanding debts, legal proceedings in progress. If this is the case higher up in the hierarchy, it will affect the customers that are defined in the lower levels.

Example 2:

- Account CO3A/ is stopped and ABC place an order for £50:
 - CO1A/ and CO2B/ accounts pass the credit checking process.
 - The order is still suspended as the higher account CO3A/ is on hold. This will be indicated by the suspension code 'HS'.

Or

- Account CO4/ is being taken to court and ABC place an order for £50:
 - Account CO1A/ CO2B/ and CO3A/ all pass the credit checks.
 - The order is again suspended as the higher account CO4/ has been flagged as status 'L'.
 - At order entry the suspension code 'HT' will be assigned to the order.



Note: The suspension codes can be viewed by the Description Enquiry in the Sales Order Maintenance menu. They are held in the Description file, major type 'SUSP'.

Hierarchy Customer Account Structure

The hierarchical account structure is a new feature incorporated within Drinks Sales Order Processing. It is an expansion of the two level structure, whereby, you can have a parent account with a lower level of ordering customers. For example, Giles' HQ is the parent customer and the Giles' retail shops are the second level of customers.

The system allows you to have up to 4 different levels of customers:

Level 4:

This is the highest level. It can be used to identify a parent establishment, which is likely to receive summaries of lower level activities, e.g. UK HQ. However, it is not a mandatory account and you are not permitted to assign any orders to it.



Note: You can have vertical and horizontal branches of level 4 attached to existing level 4 accounts.

Level 3:

Although no orders can be assigned to this account level, this is a mandatory account, e.g. London Office. It is used for financial account posting into the General Ledger, using the Accounts Receivable balance.



Note: You CANNOT have vertical branches of level 3. But you can have horizontal accounts of level 3 attached to a level 4 account.

Level 2:

This is an optional account, e.g. South London Office. No orders can be assigned to it. Its purpose is purely financial for cash allocation. Refer to the cash allocation section of Accounts Receivable for more information.



Note: You can have both vertical or horizontal branches of level 2 attached to level 2 or 3 accounts.

Level 1:

This is the lowest level of account possible. All orders are assigned to customers of this level, e.g. ABC. It is mandatory for Drinks Sales Order Processing. Accounts Receivable Ledger will be updated with postings from these accounts, through the invoicing jobs. Refer to the invoicing section for more details on invoicing.



Note: You CANNOT have vertical branches of level 1. But you can have horizontal accounts of level 1 attached to level 2 or 3 accounts.

To set up and maintain hierarchy accounts refer to the customer maintenance section of the Accounts Receivable Product Guide.

The main impact of hierarchy accounts for Drinks Sales Order Processing is credit checking. This takes place at order entry and allocation, and is affected by all the levels of accounts for that customer. This is discussed earlier in the Credit Checking section of this product information.

Picking and Despatching

Selection is provided to ensure that only the picking documents required are actually printed. The section can be for a single order or load or for a bulk pick list. This allows stock to be allocated to an order well in advance of despatch but the documents to be printed only when action is required. This is particularly useful in dealing with large export consignments. When a picking note is printed all allocations, irrespective of when they were made, are included.

This stops documents being produced unnecessarily. If the Drinks Warehousing module is installed, it must be used to despatch orders from warehouses in a similar manner. It is then possible to print consolidated picking lists sequenced by location.

When the order has been physically despatched the module needs updating. A number of options and facilities are provided.

- The despatches are assembled i.e. taken from the stockroom where they have been picked to the stockroom from which they will be delivered. This enables items from different stockrooms to be gathered for a single load.
- Delivery notes are printed.
- The assembled despatches are delivered and the delivery is confirmed. It may be that some organisations will carry out this process on return of the delivery advice note from the customer - i.e. on Proof of Delivery.
- Despatch alterations may take place either during confirmation of assembly or during confirmation of delivery. This enables, for example, the amendment of quantities because of shortages during picking, or breakage during delivery.

For lot / batch / serial controlled items details of lots / batches must be specified to the despatch lines. This provides the system with information for stock management and item traceability. These features are useful to locate the source of an item sent out to customers. For example, if a damaged case of whiskey has been delivered to a customer, instead of freezing all stocked whiskey, it would be more effective to identify the whiskey batch/lot source and freeze only those from that particular batch/lot. Orders can be altered so that another stockroom / depot can be used for despatch items.

Invoicing

There are a number of ways to request an invoice. These are:

- Confirm the assembly or delivery of an order.
- Request a sundry invoice - with stock update.
- Request a sundry invoice - without stock update.

There are also requests for credit notes that operate in an identical fashion to the requests for sundry invoices, and can be generated for Uplift orders and Tagged Goods returns.

When an invoice or credit note is generated in the system, prices and discounts are either taken from the order, as in Confirm Assembly, or created during entry using standard rules. There is a special facility to produce a credit note that is based on an invoice. This can be used to reverse a previous posting that was perhaps raised in error.

Having generated the invoice or credit note a procedure is run to post the transactions to Accounts Receivable and the General Ledger, and to print documents. Invoices and credit notes are printed as two separate documents.

An invoice will be raised and printed in the prime currency of the customer's account. Postings will be in both prime currency and the base currency of Accounts Receivable. The data that is passed to Drinks Sales Analysis will be in the base currency of the company.

Invoices can be presented to customers as:

- One invoice per despatch.
- One Invoice per order.
- One invoice per day.
- One invoice per week.
- One invoice per period.

The level of consolidation is defined for each customer invoice account.

This means numerous despatches to many delivery addresses can be consolidated on a single invoice. Each despatch is detailed on the invoice at line level with charges as applied.

Orders raised with an invoice address override are not consolidated and will produce an invoice for each despatch.

Credits and sundry invoices are not consolidated and a separate document is produced for each one raised.

The system determines when an open invoice is to be closed, posted to Accounts Receivable and printed during the invoice print procedure. This is based on:

One Invoice Per Despatch (And Sundry Invoices And Credits)

Processed during the invoice print following creation.

One Invoice Per Order

Processed during the next invoice print run.

One Invoice Per Day

Processed during the first invoice print after the date of consolidation.

One Invoice Per Week

Processed during the first invoice print after the Inventory week-end date for the week of consolidation.

One Invoice Per Period

Processed during the first invoice print after the Inventory period-end date for the period of consolidation.

Bills Of Exchange

Bills of Exchange may be created by Drinks Sales Order Processing as part of the invoice run, one proposed Bill of Exchange being sent to the customer for each invoice. This Bill of Exchange may be signed by the customer and returned, or they may issue their own Bill of Exchange, possibly to cover several invoices. This is then registered on the Accounts Payable module and may be allocated against invoices in the normal way. The exposure is monitored until the Bill of Exchange is cleared.



Note: Bills of exchange will only be printed if the Payment Method on the Bank Detail screen (Accounts Receivable Customer Maintenance) is set to 'E'.

Enquiries

The Enquiries in Drinks Sales Order Processing are designed to provide rapid and complete access to the data contained within the system and to display it in an efficient and ergonomic manner.

A significant part of the work done in a busy sales office is answering queries.

These are typically regarding:

- The status of an order.
- The prices being charged and discounts given.
- The date on which a delivery can be expected.
- Invoice or credit note queries.

The system provides a comprehensive range of enquiries to view:

Orders By:

- Order.
- Customer.
- Item.
- Cross Reference (customer reference).
- Despatch notes.

Invoices By:

- Invoice.
- Order.
- Customer.
- Item.

Stock Availability

Time-phased expected stock position.

Stock Position

Stock holding at each depot.

As well as these day-to-day enquires, the following module reference data can be displayed:

- Customers.
- Items.
- Price & Discount Lists.

Reports

Reports can be grouped into status, exception and planning reports, as follows:

Status:

- Customers.
- Items.
- Product Summary.
- List of Orders.
- Freeloaders' Sales.

Exception

- Unconfirmed Picking Notes.
- Unconfirmed Documents.
- Non-Returned Tagged Goods.
- Suspended Orders.
- Suspended Order History.
- Orders With Zero Price.
- Gross Margin Exceptions.
- Selling Price Overrides.
- Zero Value Invoice Lines.
- Confirm Delivery Amendments.
- Credits by Delivery Date.

Planning

- Pick Lists.
- Outstanding Orders.
- Back Orders.
- Stock Versus Outstanding Orders.
- Wanted Trailers.
- Trailer Location.
- Customer Container Tracking.
- Depot Container Movements.

Initial Data Take-on

Once all the basic data has been set up, you are ready to use the module to process sales orders. You may wish to convert outstanding sales orders from another module - this may be done by specially-written programs. Alternatively, you may decide to continue to process existing orders on your old module, and enter new orders, from a given date, into the new module. By this method you may gradually run down orders on the old module and build the order bank on the new, but great care must be exercised over the updating of the inventory figures.

Preparation

Preparing to use Drinks Sales Order Processing requires careful planning and preparation. Your existing system procedures and data need to be transferred to the module.

Entering Basic Data

You must initialise your module by entering the following basic data:

Company Profile

This is a record which contains control and parameter information for the operation of your company within the module.

Statement Account

A customer must be set up within Accounts Receivable before any sales orders can be posted to it. When the basic data has been created you are in a position to enter transactions.

Invoice Account

If the customer's address, defined in Accounts Receivable is not to be used for the invoices, a separate invoice account needs to be set up. This is created using Drinks Sales Order Processing, and is discussed later in the customer maintenance section.

Currency Exchange Rates

If you have multi-currency customers you must set up the valid currency exchange rates. These are set up in the General Ledger.

When you have set up the basic data and the Drinks Inventory Management module is in play, you can start using Drinks Sales Order Processing.

Installing Application Manager PTF's

Application Manager PTF's must be restored and installed as QSECOFR.



Note: To install the Application Manager PTF's the system must be in a minimum state (that is with no users or subsystems / jobs running - this is important)

Use a normal User ID to create the state then sign off and sign on as QSECOFR.

At the first screen, add in library OSLPTP1 (ADDLIB OSLPTP1 *FIRST)

Type in MNGPTF and install the PTF as normal.

Once installed, the library and PTF object can only be removed by QSECOFR. Install this PTF then sign off and sign back in as PTFOwner for subsequent PTF's.

If the above is NOT done, PTFOwner, being inside Application manager, will say the AM PTF is installed when it has not, as PTFOwner is using one of the objects the PTF requires, and the system will work - but will NOT have been updated.

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Chapter 8

Drinks Purchase Management

Overview



Introduction

As price and variety continues to increase in the marketplace, managing the procurement of goods becomes ever more important. A comprehensive purchase management system is necessary for controlling a cost effective and accurate supply of items. Drinks Purchase Management provides the necessary information and facilities in the following key areas:

- Order Creation.
- Order Follow-Up.
- Goods Receiving.
- Quality Assurance.
- Invoice Matching.
- Centralised Purchasing.
- Performance Analysis.

You tailor Drinks Purchase Management to your company's specific requirements using profile and parameter files. The module is multi-company and multi-currency.

Relationship to Other Modules

The module is designed to be used in conjunction with the following modules:

- Drinks Inventory Management.
- Accounts Payable.
- Cobwebb.
- Drinks Requisitioning.
- Drinks Warehousing.
- World Trade.

The company profile is used to identify which modules are interfaced.

Pre Requisites

For the basic operation of the Drinks Purchase Management module, the System Manager, Accounts Payable, General Ledger and Drinks Inventory Management are pre-requisites.

If Purchase Orders are to be sent directly to the Supplier via a Facsimile transmission, then the Cobwebb Fax module is a pre-requisite. This handles the actual transmission of the fax, once it has been created via Drinks Purchase Management, and is available from your software support organisation.

It is advisable to review the Implementation sections of the Drinks Inventory Management and Accounts Payable Product Information prior to implementing this module.

Drinks Inventory Management

Before using Drinks Purchase Management Drinks Inventory Management must be installed.

Drinks Purchase Management uses the Drinks Inventory Management Item Master file to specify items, and Drinks Inventory Management stockrooms to locate them.

Drinks Purchase Management writes inventory movements, and maintains actual cost details in the Drinks Inventory Management module.

All items and stockrooms to be included in Drinks Purchase Management must be defined to Drinks Inventory Management.

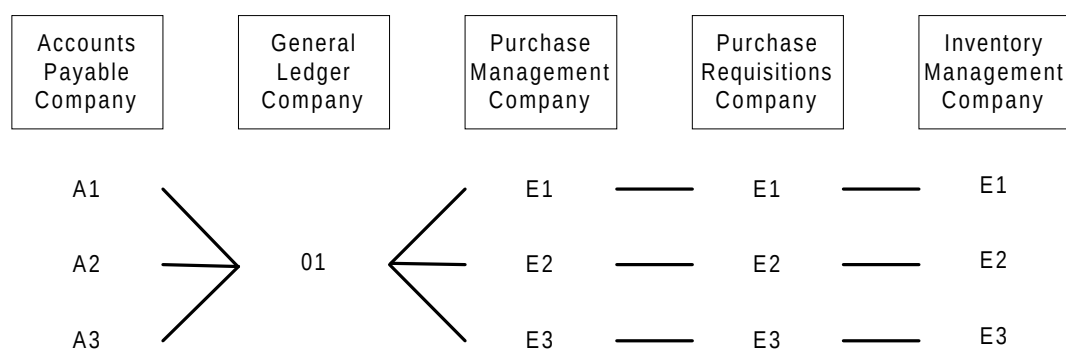
When an order is confirmed in Drinks Purchase Management, the on-order stock figure is updated in Drinks Inventory.

When a receipt or transfer into stores is made in Drinks Purchase Management the on order stock figure is reduced and the physical stock updated by the same quantity in Drinks Inventory.

General Ledger and Accounts Payable

The Drinks Purchase Management module is fully integrated, on-line, with Accounts Payable. Drinks Purchase Management gains access to the Accounts Payable master files via the General Ledger.

For example:



In this example, anyone working in Drinks Purchase Management companies E1, E2 or E3 would be able to raise orders on any suppliers in Accounts Payable companies A1, A2 or A3.



Note: The company code used in Drinks Requisitioning and Drinks Inventory Management must be the same as that used in Drinks Purchase Management.

Supplier information such as supplier code and address are picked up from the Accounts Payable Supplier Master file.



Note: If a Drinks Purchase Management company is linked to several Accounts Payable companies, the supplier references must be unique across all the Accounts Payable companies.

Multi-Currency

A Drinks Purchase Management company becomes multi-currency by being linked to a multi-currency General Ledger company.

This means that suppliers can be:

- Multi-currency, i.e. trade in any currency available to the General Ledger company
- Single currency, i.e. trade in the base currency of the General Ledger company

If invoice matching is to be used, all un-approved invoices must first be posted to the purchase ledger log. The invoices may then be matched to one or more receipts, made against orders in Drinks Purchase Management.

While matching is taking place, it is possible to flag the invoice, in Accounts Payable, with the department who are holding it for approval.

An option is available in Accounts Payable to run a report, listing all the invoices currently on the ledger and matched with receipts in Drinks Purchase Management. These matched (approved) invoices can then be posted to the ledger using the appropriate Accounts Payable option.

Drinks Requisitioning

Drinks Purchase Management is fully integrated with Drinks Requisitioning. The Drinks Requisitioning company profile details are set up in the Drinks Purchase Management company profile.

The Drinks Requisitioning module shares master file data with and creates order details in the Drinks Purchase Management module.

Drinks Requisitioning gets item information and current stock balances from Drinks Inventory Management and uses these, along with the inventory re-order policies, to produce suitable purchase requisitions. These requisitions can then be converted to purchase orders and dealt with in the usual way within Drinks Purchase Management.

Purchase requisitions (and hence purchase orders) can also be produced from recommendations available in the Drinks Distribution Requirements Planning package.

Cobwebb Fax Module

Once purchase orders have been confirmed, they can be sent directly to the supplier via a facsimile transmission. To do this the Cobwebb Fax Module must be attached to the system.

Warehousing

Drinks Purchase Management performs internal checks to determine:

- If the Warehousing module is installed.
- If the Company / Stockroom being processed is defined to Warehousing.

If these conditions apply, when goods are received or transferred into stores a window is displayed for Warehousing information to be entered. The goods are then automatically processed by the put-away routines in Warehousing, which decide where the goods are located.

World Trade

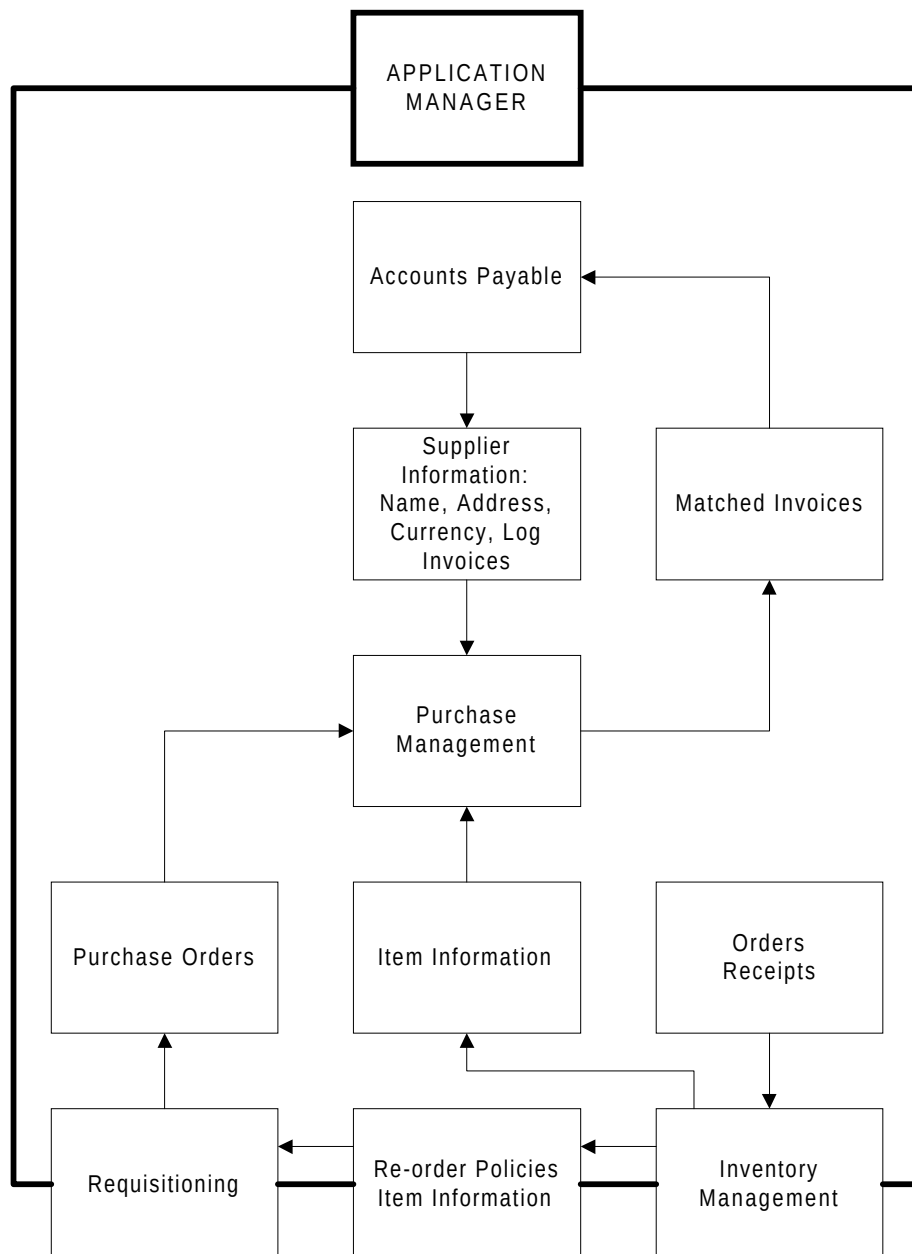
Drinks Purchase Management performs internal checks to determine:

- If the World Trade module is installed.
- If Intrastat reporting is required for the trading partners.

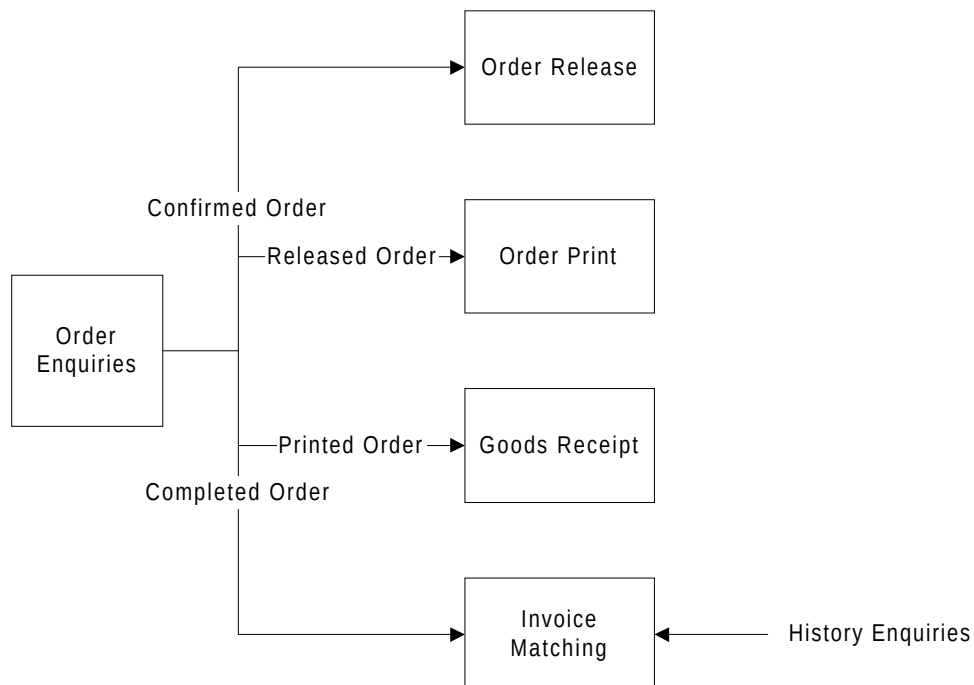
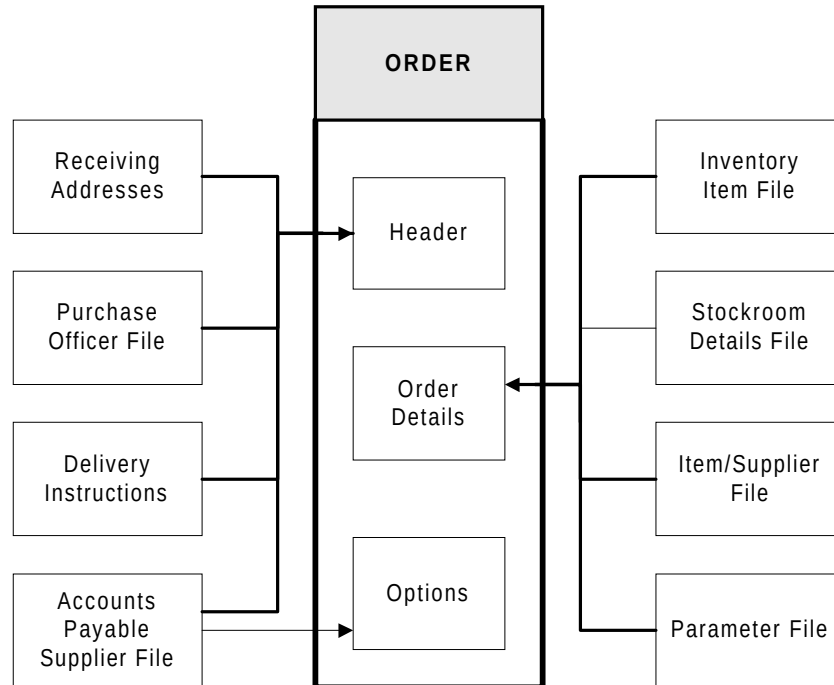
If these conditions apply, when goods are received or returned, a 'Mode of Transport' field is displayed, which specifies how the goods are moved.

These receipt and return transactions will call the World Trade programs, which create EC movements records. These will be used in the World Trade reporting routines. When performing invoice matching the EC movement records are updated.

Feature Integration



Drinks Purchase Management Interfaces



Configuration

As with all modules, Drinks Purchase Management can be operated for a number of companies, the characteristics of each being maintained on the company profile.

The primary information maintained on the company profile is used to:

- Improve efficiency of data entry.
- Provide the parameters for the generation of document references.
- Provide specification of the technical environment.
- Enable set up of ranges for data integrity checking.

This primary information consists of:

- Company name, address, phone and fax.
- Default supplier address code.
- Default receiving address code.
- Default currency rate codes for orders, receipts and invoices.
- Output queues for reports, orders, GRNs / labels and rejection notes.
- Interfaces to other modules.
- Order numbering.
- Goods receipt note (GRN) numbering.
- Rejection note numbering.
- Purchasing officer number range.
- Requisitions options (where Drinks Requisitioning is installed).
- Default goods receiving booking-in-point.
- Receipt time fence number of days.
- Dummy items (for delivery instructions).
- Dummy supplier (for receiving addresses).

Implementation Procedure

After installing the software, the recommended steps for implementing Drinks Purchase Management are outlined below:

- Define company profile options.
- Create company profile.
- Define parameter and sundry codes file.
 - Design the units of measure table (using 'UOMC' and 'GUMC' parameters)
 - Define stockroom codes (for non-stock orders)
 - Define order classifications
 - Define schedule order types
 - Define scrap reason codes
 - Define user controlled fields for order entry
- Create parameter and sundry codes.
- Define user authority values, authoriser and default stockrooms.
- Define and create currency rates (unless these have already been set up in the General Ledger).
- Create purchasing officer definitions.
- Create item/supplier profiles. These may also be created at the time of order entry.
- Define and create delivery instructions sets.
- Define and create receiving addresses.
- Optionally create extended purchase text for:
 - Items only
 - Items/Suppliers
 - Suppliers Only
- Optionally set up:
 - Supplier fax numbers
 - Landed cost codes
 - Stockroom defaults

Operational Considerations

- Company Profile decisions.
 - Numbering system
 - Interfaces
 - GRN printing
- Setting of User Authority levels for each user profile.
 - Authority value
 - Authorisation Chain
 - Default stockroom
- System Maintenance.
 - Who does it?
 - How often?
 - When?
- Raising Orders.
 - Standard uses of memo fields
 - Limit on number of items per order?
 - Standard use of text
 - Establish order print routine
 - Use of order flags?
 - Order print layout
- Order Amendments.
 - Use for updates and corrections?
 - Flags for acknowledgements?
 - Update delivery dates?
 - Who does amendments and when?
- Goods Receiving.
 - Use of goods inwards and inspection?
 - What happens if no order number can be found?
 - Use of GRN notes and/or labels?
 - Over receipts allowed?
- Returns and Adjustments.
 - From which locations?
 - Item scrapping?

- Use of rejection notes?
 - Return after invoice match?
- Invoice Matching.
 - Who does it and how often?
 - Allow small differences?
 - Update item/supplier profile?
- Reporting.
 - Which ones?
 - When?
 - Standard selection parameters?
- Requisitions.
 - Will requisitions be used?
 - How often will requisitions be created?
 - From which modules will they be created?
 - Print all reports?
 - Use flags?
 - Conversion to orders?
- User Notes.
 - Prepare user notes on the system as you want to use it.
- Utilities.
 - Who is allowed to use them?
 - When should validations be run?

Maintenance of Reference Data

Drinks Purchase Management uses master file data set up in other Drinks modules. However, there are some master files which are set up specifically for the module.

Information for the following may be maintained:

- Parameters and sundry codes.
- User IDs.
- Purchasing officer names.
- Requisition authorisation.
- Item/supplier profiles.
- Delivery instructions.
- Receiving addresses.
- Supplier external text.
- Supplier fax numbers.
- User authority parameters.
- Landed cost codes.
- Stockroom defaults.

Parameters & Sundry Codes

A number of parameters should be maintained for each company. These are used to control the module and to tailor it to the company's requirements. These parameters include:

- Group unit of measure codes.
- Unit of measure codes.
- Order classifications.
- Scrap reason codes.
- Schedule order types.
- User defined fields.

User IDs

Details are held on the Inventory Descriptions file of each User that is allowed to enter or authorise orders. Against each User ID a Purchasing Officer number is specified.

Purchasing Officer Names

Detail is held of the company's officers and/or planners who use this module. This is then recorded against each order, and is displayed on the module's enquiries.

Requisition Authorisation

Limit values are established for each user to control the maximum value of an individual order, and the total amount that can be spent in any one month. Against each requisitioner, an authoriser is specified who takes responsibility for any orders which exceed the requisitioner's spend limit.

Item / Supplier Profiles

For each supplier of an item, an item/supplier profile is required. The profile includes price, ordering rules, lead time and supplier reference details.

These may be set up 'in flight' in order entry, or maintained as part of the initial data setup.

A cumulative total of orders and receipts are also maintained by the module for each item/supplier profile.

Delivery Instructions

A set of delivery instructions may be maintained for each company. Each set of instructions is identified by a three character code and comprises up to three lines of text.

The delivery instruction code can be selected at order entry, and is subsequently printed on the purchase order.

Receiving Addresses

A set of receiving addresses may be maintained for each company. Each one comprises a name, and up to five lines of address details.

The code may be selected at order entry, to specify the address to which the goods are to be sent. Otherwise, it defaults to the receiving address code set on the company profile.

Supplier External Text

For each supplier, up to 99 lines of text may be maintained. At order entry, this text can optionally be selected for printing on the order.

Supplier Fax Numbers

Fax numbers for a supplier can be maintained, to be used when a facsimile of the purchase order is to be automatically sent to the supplier.

User Authority Parameters

Access to Drinks Purchase Management procedures is controlled by the standard authorisation features of System Manager. The module does provide an additional level of user authorisation within certain procedures.

Authority levels may be set for system user profiles. These authority levels limit the ability of the user to:

- Receive an order greater than a specified value.
- Under receive an order and specify that the order is complete.
- Over receive an order.
- Match a purchase invoice at a price greater than that specified for the order.

The authority levels are set as absolute values, or as percentages of the relevant order line value.

A default stockroom is set up, to be used when this user is processing data.

Landed Cost Codes

Landed costs may be added to purchase order lines using landed cost codes.

Stockroom Defaults

Stockroom defaults can be set up for the module.

You can set up and maintain the stockroom name, stockroom address, phone/fax numbers, contact name and receiving address. Goods received note (GRN) generation, numbering and printing controls are also set up.

Processing

The normal day-to-day processing in Drinks Purchase Management can be divided into three types of tasks:

- Creating orders.
- Receiving goods.
- Matching invoices to goods received.

Creating Orders

Purchase orders can be created by two different methods:

- By generating purchase orders from requisitions via the facility in the Drinks Requisitioning module; or
- By entering the purchase order directly into the Drinks Purchase Management module via order entry.

Order Entry

The entry of a purchase order can be broken down into three stages - Header, Item lines and Options.

The following information can be specified for the order header:

Order Class

Specifies if the order is a stocked order, non-stocked or service order.

Order Type

Defines whether the order is of a normal (single delivery date per line), scheduled, or blanket type.

A 'Scheduled' order is a firm commitment with a supplier for quantities to be delivered on specified dates. Multiple deliveries are expected for each line. A 'Blanket' order is similar to a scheduled order but the commitment to quantities and dates is only provisional. It is processed in the same way as a scheduled order within this module.

Other details specified on the order header are as follows:

- Supplier.
- Supplier address.
- Order date & delivery date.
- Order number.
- Purchasing officer.
- Stockroom & delivery instruction code.
- Department.
- Shipping code.
- Discount.
- Job Number.

When adding items to the order, the standard Drinks Inventory Management search is available to identify and select the correct item.

The suppliers' item reference, units of measure, price, and discounts are defaulted for the item. However, for non-stocked orders there are no defaults for price or units.

The following options are available when completing each order:

- Enter further orders or return to the menu.
- Print the order.
- Use existing external supplier text or not.
- Add new text for printing on the order, i.e. external text.
- Add new text for display only, i.e. internal text.
- Cancel the whole order.

Full amendment facilities are available on outstanding orders, and an audit trail is provided of amendments made.

Receiving Goods

All purchases received must be covered by a purchase order.

To enable the correct purchase order to be processed, all outstanding orders by item or supplier can be viewed. Furthermore, if the item code and supplier code are unknown, searches are available for these. Obviously, the purchase order number may be entered directly, if known.

Goods may be received in up to three locations:

- Goods inwards.
- Inspection.
- Stores.



Note: Only the stores option is available in a bonded stockroom.

Items may be subsequently moved from their original receipt location using the Transfer Goods Location option in this module.

For stock items, Drinks Inventory Management is only updated when receipt (or transfer) is made to stores.

In recording the receipt, the whole order may be received in its entirety, except for scheduled orders. Alternatively, the receipt can be done line by line, with partial and over receipts possible.

The user's authority is checked before under/over delivery can be accepted.

When goods are received in Drinks Purchase Management, they are valued in Drinks Inventory Management at the order price, since no invoice price is available at this stage. The invoice is usually matched at a later date and valued in the General Ledger account at the invoice price. If the order price is amended at invoice matching, an additional dissection is created for the price variance, thus reconciling the General Ledger stock account and the inventory value. The General Ledger code used for this is the price variance code taken from the item file in Drinks Inventory Management.

The dissections created during invoice matching overwrite any purchase log goods value dissections already entered.

Facilities are provided for the entry of batch, lot and serial numbers and header details.

Both internal order and order line text may be updated at the receiving stage.

The Goods Receipt Note (GRN) may be printed along with labels if required. GRN numbers may be automatically generated. These GRN options are specified on the company profile.

Once the goods have been received, the following facilities within this module can be used:

- Transfer of goods into or out of inspection.
- Return of unwanted goods, with optional replacement.

- Scrapping of faulty goods, with analysis by reason codes.
- Optional creation of rejection notes.
- Maintenance of landed costs.

Invoice Matching

Invoice matching is designed to 'close the loop' between the Accounts Payable module and Drinks Purchase Management by providing matching of receipts with invoices or credit notes on the Accounts Payable log.

The Invoice Matching routine performs two basic functions:

Receipts within Drinks Purchase Management are 'flagged' as having been matched with invoices. The pricing details are stored in Drinks Purchase Management for future analysis in the supplier performance and price variance reports.

Invoice Log records in Accounts Payable are flagged as matched, and dissections to the appropriate nominal codes are set up.

Invoices, credit notes and journals on the invoice log may be matched against any number of advice notes and parts of advice notes.

A report of outstanding advice notes by supplier is available to assist invoice matching.

Once invoices have been matched, there is a separate facility in Accounts Payable which must be used to transfer the invoice from the log to the Accounts Payable proper. A report of matched invoices (on the invoice log) is available to trigger release of these invoices into Accounts Payable.

Text may be entered, reviewed and amended against the invoice reference at the time of matching.

An audit trail of invoices matched may be printed if required.

Where the Invoice Log is not in use, receipts within Drinks Purchase Management may be matched using the "stand-alone" matching procedure. This procedure is similar to standard matching, but involves no interface to the Accounts Payable log.

Enquiries

Enquiries may be grouped into four categories:

- Outstanding order searches.
- Order details.
- Sources of supply.
- Financial.

Outstanding Order Searches

Multiple 'routes' are provided for identifying an outstanding purchase. Enquiries exist by:

- Item.
- Supplier.
- Cost code.
- Job number.
- Supplier item reference.
- Purchasing officer.

Order Details

Once the relevant purchase order has been identified, an enquiry exists to display details of that order. Each line can then be selected to show receipts to date along with other line details.

Sources of Supply

Enquiries are available to satisfy these questions:

'Which suppliers supply this item?'

'Which items have been bought from this supplier?'

These enquiries are known as 'Where bought?' and 'What bought?', respectively.

Financial

An enquiry exists to display the details of an invoice, including the value matched and matched receipt details. You may also enquire on landed costs for an order.

Reports

As part of the policy of Drinks modules, before a report is run, selection and sequencing parameters are normally available.

In general, standard reports are printed on standard listing paper with 132 print positions and six lines to the inch. In Drinks Purchase Management, the printing of orders, goods receipt notes and labels are made on special stationery.

The reports in Drinks Purchase Management can be grouped into one of the following categories:

- Actions.
- Status.
- Analysis.
- Audits.
- File Lists.
- Exceptions.

Actions

These reports are used to trigger actions to be taken, and are necessary to progress an order through the module:

- Release and Print orders.
- Print GRN's/labels.

Status Reports

These show the current position of purchase orders within the module:

- Order pre-print.
- Deliveries due.
- Order confirmation.
- Advice notes not invoiced.
- Accruals (receipts not invoiced).

Analysis

Selective views of purchasing activity and performance are provided by the following reports:

- Receipts and returns.
- Goods value by location.
- Price variance.
- Supplier performance.
- What bought.
- Where bought.

- Order value by cost code.
- Landed costs by GRN and item/supplier.
- Purchase commitment.
- Overdue orders by supplier.

Audits

The following audits are provided for processing functions in Drinks Purchase Management:

- Order amendments.
- Receipts and returns.

File Lists

Full file listings may be requested for the following:

- Purchasing officers.
- Receiving addresses.
- Delivery instructions.
- Parameters and sundry codes.
- User authority values.

Exceptions

These include discrepancies within the database which may need actions to rectify.

- Item/supplier profile exception report.
- Order file exception report.

Utilities

The Drinks Purchase Management module provides a number of utilities for database reorganisation and verification. The options placed on the Utilities menu are not required for the normal day to day operations of the module.

The utilities provide the following facilities:

- Copying of company data.
- Purging and reorganisation of the database.
- Item search rebuilding.
- Supplier price update.

Installing Application Manager PTF's

Application Manager PTF's must be restored and installed as QSECOFR.



Note: To install the Application Manager PTF's the system must be in a minimum state (that is with no users or subsystems / jobs running - this is important)

Use a normal User ID to create the state then sign off and sign on as QSECOFR.

At the first screen, add in library OSLPTP1 (ADDLIB OSLPTP1 *FIRST)

Type in MNGPTF and install the PTF as normal.

Once installed, the library and PTF object can only be removed by QSECOFR. Install this PTF then sign off and sign back in as PTFOwner for subsequent PTF's.

If the above is NOT done, PTFOwner, being inside Application manager, will say the AM PTF is installed when it has not, as PTFOwner is using one of the objects the PTF requires, and the system will work - but will NOT have been updated.

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Chapter 9

Drinks Requisitioning Overview



Introduction

Drinks Requisitioning enables you to create requisitions from supply suggestions or by manual entry. You can then transfer requisitions into supply orders.

The requisitions may be generated from supply suggestions created by any of the following applications:

- Drinks Inventory Management.
- Master Production Scheduling (MPS).
- Material Requirements Planning (MRP).
- Drinks Distribution Requirements Planning (DRP).

Alternatively, requisitions may be manually entered (for stocked items, non-stocked items, and services) within this application.

These are then subsequently transferred into the following supply orders:

- Purchase Order lines, or
- Distribution Order lines (for items sourced by an internal supply centre within the company as defined to Drinks DRP).

The Purchase Order lines are maintained within Drinks Purchase Management.

The Distribution Order lines are handled as internal sales orders within Drinks Sales Order Processing.

Relationship to Other Applications

The applications which are a pre-requisite for the operation of Drinks Requisitioning are:

- Drinks Inventory Management.
- Drinks Purchase Management.
- System Manager.

The input to Drinks Requisitions, i.e. supply suggestions, may be from one or more of the following:

- Drinks Inventory Management.
- Master Production Scheduling (MPS).
- Material Requirements Planning (MRP).
- Drinks Distribution Requirements Planning (DRP).

If you create Distribution Orders, Drinks Sales Order Processing will handle them as internal sales orders (from Supply Centre to Distribution Centre).



Note: At least one of the applications must be installed in order to generate requisitions, unless they are always created manually.

Application Configuration

Drinks Requisitioning is “driven” by the Company Profile of the corresponding Drinks Purchase Management company.

The Drinks Purchase Management Company Profile defines:

- Company name.
- Next Requisition number.
- Release flag and order class to be used on creation of a requisition.
- If a new order is to be created on change of Purchase officer.
- Interface parameters for Drinks Inventory Management.

For full details of the Company Profile options refer to the relevant section of the Drinks Purchase Management Product Information.

As Drinks Requisitioning does not have its own file library, conversion routines are not required within this application.

The main Requisitions transaction file (PMP17) is handled by the conversion routines in Drinks Purchase Management.

Using Drinks Requisitioning

Using Drinks Requisitioning requires careful planning and preparation. Your existing Requisitioning procedures and data need to be transferred to this application.

Configuring the Application

Companies

Requisitioning does not contain its own Company Profile record. For each company to be processed within Drinks Requisitioning, the following information must be maintained in the corresponding Drinks Purchase Management company profile:

- Default order class for rejected requisitions.
- Default release flag for new requisitions.
- New order flag default value.
- Whether or not a new order is required on change of Purchasing Officer.
- Requisition numbering options.
- Whether authorisation is required for modified sourced requisitions.

Refer to the Drinks Purchase Management Product Information for details.

Items

Items must be defined to Drinks Inventory Management.

Suppliers

The suppliers to be referenced in Drinks Requisitioning are normally defined on the Supplier Master File. This is maintained within Accounts Payable.

When requisitions are created from either Drinks Inventory Management, MPS/MRP or Drinks DRP the supplier is the preferred supplier from the Item/Stockroom record. If this is blank, the supplier will be set to the first supplier of the item from the Item/Supplier profile file within Drinks Purchase Management.

However, if the item is supplied within the company, and the Drinks DRP application is installed, the supplier is defined as a Supply Centre within Drinks DRP.

Stockrooms

Must be defined in Drinks Inventory Management.

Purchasing Officers

If items are to be controlled by their respective Purchase Officers you should maintain definitions within Drinks Purchase Management.

Authorisation

All users who are to be allowed to raise Manual Requisitions must have a Requisitioner record in the Authorisation file.



Once you have set up and retrieved the basic data, you can start using Drinks Requisitioning.

The processing options allow you to create requisitions manually or automatically, maintain existing requisitions, authorise manual requisitions and create supply orders from Drinks Requisitioning.

Implementation Procedure

After installing the software provided, the recommended steps for implementing Drinks Requisitioning are as follows:

- Update Purchase Management Company Profile options with Requisitions options.
- Check the Purchasing Officer definitions in Purchase Management.
- Check the preferred supplier in the Item/Stockroom records in Inventory Management.
- Check the item/supplier profile records in Drinks Purchase Management.
- Define and create the Authorisation records via the option in this application. These are required if requisitions are to be entered manually or if requisitions sourced from other applications require authorisation when amended.

Installing Application Manager PTF's

Application Manager PTF's must be restored and installed as QSECOFR.



Note: To install the Application Manager PTF's the system must be in a minimum state (that is with no users or subsystems / jobs running - this is important)

Use a normal User ID to create the state then sign off and sign on as QSECOFR.

At the first screen, add in library OSLPTP1 (ADDLIB OSLPTP1 *FIRST)

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Once installed, the library and PTF object can only be removed by QSECOFR. Install this PTF then sign off and sign back in as PTFOwner for subsequent PTF's.

If the above is NOT done, PTFOwner, being inside Application manager, will say the AM PTF is installed when it has not, as PTFOwner is using one of the objects the PTF requires, and the system will work - but will NOT have been updated.

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Chapter 10

Drinks Telesales Overview



Introduction

In an increasingly competitive sales situation there is greater emphasis being placed on proactive selling. One of the most potent weapons in this area is the telephone. It is no longer enough to wait for customers to call or write with the details of an order. Everything that can be done to get the order must be done. But telephone connect time is expensive, both in terms of the actual connection charge and the use of trained sales office personnel. It is essential, therefore, that each and every telephone call be as productive as possible. The economics of making the calls and supporting the sales staff with a sophisticated computer system must be measured and evaluated.

There is a wide definition of a Telesales module ranging from cold calling or telemarketing to the taking of an expected order from an existing customer for an agreed list of items.

Clearly the different types of call are conducted in a different manner. There are, however, certain common elements of support that could be provided by a computer system.

What Does Telesales Do?

The objective of the Drinks Telesales module is to provide support to the Sales Operator such that the process is completed in the minimum time with the greatest accuracy and the least disruption to the Customer and Sales Office. In order to achieve this the dialogue should take place in a structured fashion, ideally where the Buyer and Seller are using the same “script”.

Obviously this latter condition is not possible in a cold call situation; however, all the support information must be readily available to the Seller. In particular, the response time from the computer system should be such that it will not normally cause the Seller to request the Buyer to pause before proceeding. While such performance is ultimately a function of computer resources, the greatest care has been taken to ensure that screen response time is optimised for the normal method of Telesales operation.

All such systems require a list of calls to be made on any particular day. Typically this list is divided amongst the Telesales operators. Some of the calls have specific times at which they should be made, others only have the date.

Supervisory functions are required to manage and re-assign the work to be done. The Telesales module contains the following procedures:

Maintenance Functions

- Company Details.
- Operator Profiles.
- Buying Lists.
- Customer Contacts.
- Call Profiles.
- Delivery Profiles.
- Sales Prompts.
- Promotions.
- Item Families.
- Reason Descriptions.
- Cases/Pallets Conversion.

Processes

- Make Outgoing Calls.
- Take Incoming Calls.
- Manage Call Lists.
- Generate Call Lists.

Reporting and Enquiry

- Enquire on Call Lists.

- Enquire on a Whole Order.
- Enquire on Availability of Stock.
- Enquire on Promotions.
- Enquire on Call Planning Details.
- Enquire on Call Management details.
- Print Customer Details.
- Print Sales Prompts.
- Print Operator Profiles.
- Print Reason Codes.
- Print Promotion Details.
- Print Buying Lists.
- Print Daily Call Lists.
- Print Daily Operator Extracts.
- Print Operator Performance Details.

Telesales Style

Three distinct styles of Telesales are supported by the module:

- Telesales.
- Planned Delivery.
- Telemarketing.

Telesales

Telesales is where an expected order is being taken from a known customer with an established buying pattern. The module generates the call list for the day, identifying the sales operator, the time and the sales contacts. When a call is selected, the customer's buying list is displayed. Along with the list of items, the immediate ordering history is displayed. By pressing a **Function** Key, it is possible to replace the order history with price information. The module enables the entry of all the order information and on pressing **Enter** proceed to the next screen. At the end of the entry of order line information the module will display an order summary. Following the closing of the order the remaining calls are then displayed, allowing the next customer to be selected.

Planned Delivery

Planned delivery is a particular form of order entry. In this style of order entry the customer quotes his current stock levels. The module has previously calculated the average weekly demand.

From this information the quantity that should be ordered is calculated to ensure minimum stock holding with little risk of running out. This is automatically entered as the order quantity. The order closing procedures are the same as for standard Telesales. Provision is made for the adjustment of the order quantity if necessary.

Telemarketing

Telemarketing is defined as order entry to support the contacting of customers where the chances of taking an order are very much reduced. There is however, the requirement to create a call diary which is supported by the same facilities of call back and reschedule. Having categorised the account it may be appropriate to display a target list of items for that type of account.

It can be seen, therefore, that the process of referring to a call diary, selecting an account and then displaying a definable list of items can support a wide range of Telesales activities.

Relationships to Other Modules

The Telesales Module is a fully standardised product, and is one of the Base Drinks Modules.

The following Modules are pre-requisites to the operation of Telesales:

- Drinks Sales Order Processing.
- Drinks Inventory Management.

If planned delivery is to be used:

- Drinks Sales Analysis.

The objective of the Drinks Telesales Module is to build standard Sales Orders. All of the standard sales order functions can then be used to service the order. This includes batch allocation, picking, despatch and invoicing, as well as the full range of enquiries and reports. As part of the recording of the sales order, the module will perform a check on available stock and highlight any shortage conditions. If Planned Delivery is used, then it is necessary to have access to the sales history of a customer so that the average usages for the customer can be calculated; this is derived from the Sales Analysis Database.

Module Configuration

As with all the modules, Drinks Telesales can be operated for a number of companies, the characteristics of each is maintained on a control file. Before a company can be set-up, however, Drinks Sales Order Processing and Drinks Inventory Management must have been installed and configured for the company. The control information may then be maintained.

This can be divided into the following classes of data:

Company standard policy controls for:

- Telesales type.
- Contact types.
- Operator performance and rest periods.
- Buying lists.
- Target for action messages.
- Request for performance statistics.

Text:

- Operators.
- Call Profiles.
- Buying Lists.
- Contacts.
- Delivery Profiles.
- Promotions.

Description Identities for:

- Promotion types.
- Delivery routes.

It is also possible to exercise some control over the presentation of data in the all important order recording process. This is done by taking the option for "Presentation Design" from the Company Maintenance screen. Control over such things as the display of the date and the standard concatenation of item number and description is provided.

Maintenance of Reference Data

Much of the primary data has already been set up as part of the Sales Order Processing and Inventory Management modules. There is, however, additional information which must be entered in order to obtain the maximum benefit from the module. There are a number of common features in the way in which this data is maintained, these are:

- The standard item and customer search routines have been adopted.
- The module makes the minimum use of 'codes' and where they are employed a prompt is always available to assist in selecting the correct one.
- Selection is normally from a displayed list or by the entry of a code.

Information for the following may be maintained:

- Operator Profiles.
- Buying lists.
- Customer contacts.
- Call profiles.
- Sales prompts.
- Promotions.
- Item families.
- Reason descriptions.
- Cases/Pallets Conversion.

Operators

All persons who are involved in using the Drinks Telesales facilities for taking and managing calls must be identified to the module. The details which can be recorded include name and module user ID, as well as standard times; for calls, rest period and the working day, and a statement of the type of Telesales calls in which the operator is proficient. The record will also contain the degree of freedom the operator is allowed to change the sequence in which calls are to be made or to divert them to another operator.

Buying List

One aim of the Drinks Telesales Module is to provide the operator with a list of items to discuss with a Customer. In many companies it is possible to have a standard list of items which can be used as a basis for a call to most Customers. However, having agreed that the objective of the module is to fit as closely as possible to the Customers' requirements and, therefore, to minimise the call time, it is inevitable that, for certain accounts, it is advantageous to use bespoke lists. The module provides for the creation and maintenance of such lists both by direct entry or by copying part or all of existing lists. Not only is it possible to create a list at the appropriate level, but also to automatically build the description of the item that is displayed to the operator. Alternatively the

customer's item number could be entered and maintained on a Customer's Buying List rather than the in-house item number.

If a Customer's Call profile identifies 'History' buying lists, then the default buying list for the customer is reduced to only those items that have a sales history for that customer. The panels for this history buying list are then sequenced into product groups using the item's Price Sequence code.

Customer Contacts

The module provides for the maintenance of customer contacts. Any number of such contacts can be created. As well as the contact name and details, telephone extension number and comments can be stored. When a call profile is being created, the 'Prime' contact for that call is selected from the list of contacts.

Call Profiles

The whole basis of the Drinks Telesales module is to establish patterns or diaries for the calling of customers. There are a number of attributes which can be recorded which are necessary to control the frequency and nature of the calls. They can be conveniently grouped under the following five headings:

- How to contact - telephone, fax, telex numbers.
- Who to contact - preferred or prime contact.
- Whose responsibility - sales operator.
- Nature of contact - buying list, type of call, pallet or case quantities and panel type.
- When to contact - time of the day, days of the week and weekly frequency.

Full additional text facilities are provided.

Delivery Profiles

In order to get the maximum benefit from a Telesales module, it can be used to synchronise the customer contact with the expected delivery pattern. In this way, the company can make the best use of its transport expenditure and the probability of the customer receiving the goods when expected is increased.

As with call profiles the information can be grouped:

- How to contact - telephone, telex, fax.
- Who to contact - primary contact.
- When delivery is convenient - times of the day, days of the week and weekly frequency.
- Geography - delivery route, drop sequence number.

Full additional text facilities are provided.

Sales Prompts

In any sales environment, particularly where there is controlled contact with the customer, it is appropriate that certain key reminders are frequently presented to the operator. This might relate to stock shortages or surpluses, pending price changes or general messages. Each message is controlled by an effectivity date. The messages are displayed one at a time, in sequence, at the top of the

diary management and order taking screens, so that each time the **Enter** key is pressed, the prompt changes.

Promotions

Sales Promotions is a very large, complex and varied subject. This module does not attempt to support and manage all aspects of promotions. It does, however, seek to provide the basic recording of when they take place and the scope and nature of the promotion. The following information can be recorded:

- The promotion type.
- The dates when it is operational.
- What it is called and its promotion number.
- The target increase in sales.
- The constraints.
- Items which are being promoted, or 'award' items which are being offered.
- A specific customer or customer classification.

If an item is to be substituted by a promotional item, this can be defined on the promotion. This can be used to affect the replacement at order entry if the promotion is accepted.

If an item is being offered as a Free of Charge 'Award' when certain qualifying items are ordered, this can be defined as a Freeloader or Loyalty Promotion scheme, with the awards being offered automatically during Order Entry.

Item Families

The Planned Delivery style requires that a number of items are linked together into an item family for the purpose of analysing sales in generic markets. This is achieved by creating a 'family' like a 'Bill of Materials'.

For example: A family could have a base item of 'beer' and any number of promotion items or 'types'. All items both base and promotion must be complete items defined to the Drinks Inventory Management Module. Families can be set up and maintained directly or are automatically created by defining a promotion with a promotional item.

Reason Descriptions

One purpose of the Drinks Telesales Module is to set objectives for the Sales Operators and then to exercise a degree of control and measurement over their performance. If an operator is unable, either by typing in a code or selecting one from a list, to achieve the expected action at the expected time they are required to give a reason. Reason codes appropriate for the company can be set-up and maintained as required.

Cases/Pallets Conversion

This function is used to set the number of cases per pallet for a particular item/customer combination, overriding the relationship established for the item on the Inventory Item Master file. This information is used to structure the input and displayed quantities when a call profile dictates that the order is to be taken in pallet quantities.

Generate Call Lists

This is a batch run which will run on request. It will normally be run at the end of each working day to prepare the call list up to a specified date. The following actions can be performed as part of this run:

- Make an entry in the call list for all call profiles with a date, less than or equal to the specified date of the run.
- Generate a skeleton order based upon the nominated buying list for the call profile.
- Generate the prices for the customer/items on the buying list.
- Generate order history for the specified number of orders.

The first two of these will always be performed whilst pricing and order history is done if requested. The defaults for their inclusion in the run is on the company control file, but in order to balance the work load between call list generation and response times, different combinations can be tried by changing the run time parameters.

Manage Call Lists

Options are provided to manage the Call Lists. Each operator is set up with an authority level reflecting the options they are authorised to use. The following authority levels are available:

- 0 - The Operator must take the next call in sequence.
- 1 - The Operator may take any call next.
- 2 - The Operator may amend the time of the call.
- 3 - The Operator may change who is to make a call.

Operators will also have authority to option below their level, i.e. a user authorised to option 2 also has access to option 1. There are two lists created, both are sequenced by the Operator and Date. However, the timed calls are added to one and the untimed to the other. The Call List is displayed on the screen with timed calls at the top and untimed at the bottom.

The module will take the average call time for the operator, add it to the current time and if no timed calls are due by the calculated time, it will select an untimed call. This calculation is performed each time the screen is selected or the Refresh option is taken. Similarly each time the Call Selection Screen is displayed one of the Sales Prompts is displayed. Only an operator with an authority level of '3' can enter the call list of another operator to re-organise and redistribute it. If a call is selected but contact is not completed the operator is able to request call back at a specified time.

Record Order Details

Once a Customer has been selected the module will enter the appropriate style of order entry:

- Telesales.
- Planned Delivery.
- Telemarketing.

The top part of the screen will contain key customer information including contact name and extension number. The left hand side of the screen will contain the

item identification. For each item the Telesales function is able to create a 30 character identifier made up of item number and description as they wish. Order details are entered in a column; either order quantity or current stock level in the case of Planned Delivery.

On the right hand side is the previous order data for Telesales, the average order information for Planned Delivery or price data. Function keys will switch from the price screen to the History/Average screen and back. The objective of these screens is to enable the order details to be entered extremely quickly, therefore, pressing **Enter** will normally proceed to the next screen.

At the end of the item screens the module will present a summary which will:

- Display the details of the order lines taken. In the case of planned delivery it will include the calculated order quantity.
- Display the price and discount.
- Allow the entry of additional items.
- Allow the entry of promotional items.
- Perform credit check.
- Demand entry of customer order entry reference.
- Quote the order number.
- If additional charges are required an additional screen can be displayed.
- Allow entry of order date and due delivery date for the order.
- The free stock is tested to confirm that despatch can be made.
- Provide for confirmation of the next call details.

In the case of Telemarketing the buying lists can also be displayed. This includes the description of the list, e.g. Small Breweries - Nettles. The list need not be static - it might, for example, contain those items which should be pushed to a particular market sector today.

Create Sales Orders

The recording of order details will update an order work file that will have been created by a previous batch run. This will provide maximum speed and security. The next step is to create the information required to allow allocation, picking and despatch to be handled by standard Drinks Sales Order Processing functions. This update exists as a 'sleeper' in the Drinks Telesales sub-system and, when active, creates an order on the Sales Order Processing Database.

Work Planning

The module will display in bar chart form the work to be done by Operator by day. This will include time for the standard rest period. This enquiry will enable class three operators to re-plan work.

Performance Analysis

If chosen as a company control option, performance statistics are recorded. The elapsed time for each stage of the order taking cycle and the number of lines taken is recorded. The performance analysis report will then give Operator Performance information at summary or detail level between a range of dates.

Using Drinks Telesales

To use Drinks Telesales careful planning and preparation are required. Your existing Telesales procedures and data need to be transferred to the module. Consideration should also be given to improvements which could be made to current procedures by making full use of the Drinks Telesales modules' capabilities.

When Drinks Telesales is installed, four major areas must be considered.

- Have the prerequisite modules been installed and if so are they set up in a way which is suitable for the operation of Drinks Telesales?
- How will the functions and facilities of the Drinks Telesales module be used to enhance the selling activity of the company?
- Has the operation of Drinks Telesales been discussed with customers?
- Have the operators of the module had adequate education?

Relationship to Other Modules

Drinks Telesales relies heavily on the data held in other modules and indeed its objective is to generate orders in a standard form within Drinks Sales Order Processing. This module must therefore be installed and all its prerequisites and conditions must be satisfied.

The two character company code in Drinks Telesales identifies to which Drinks Sales Order Processing, Drinks Inventory Management, Accounts Receivable and Drinks Sales Analysis company it is linked.

A number of Drinks Telesales functions depend directly on data held in other modules. These are:

- While an order is being taken previous order history data can be displayed to the operator. This is extracted from previous Telesales orders on the Drinks Sales Order Processing database.
- The pricing and discounting information used in Drinks Telesales is retrieved from Drinks Sales Order Processing.
- The customer information such as supplying depot, price list, discount list and currency is retrieved from Drinks Sales Order Processing.
- Stock levels used in sourcing and availability checks are from the Drinks Inventory Management module.
- Data from Drinks Sales Analysis is used to calculate average weekly sales.

How will the Drinks Telesales Module be used?

Drinks Telesales is designed to record order requirements, quickly, while holding a conversation with a customer over the telephone. To achieve this a pre-agreed list of items is presented to the operator to offer to the customer, the only entry required being the ordered quantity. The module offers three variations on this basic theme. It is a primary requirement that these methods are fully understood so that the appropriate technique can be used with each customer. The following questions must be addressed:

- Which style of Drinks Telesales is used for each customer?
- Will standard buying lists be created, will they be customer specific, and should they be based on 'sales history'?
- Will operators work in small groups on a list of customers or will they each have their own customer list?
- Will the module be used to time and record the performance of each operator?

All of the above are fully discussed in the body of this product information.

Discussion with Customers

Throughout the manual, speed and accuracy is emphasised as a key objective of Drinks Telesales. In order to gain the maximum benefit from the module it is important that customers understand the nature of the dialogue you plan to hold over the telephone. They should understand that you intend to sell from a list and perhaps should have a copy of the list. If the Planned Delivery technique is to be used they must understand that they are expected to give current stock levels and they must have complete confidence in the re-order level algorithm used by the module.

Are the Operators trained?

As with all systems that directly impact your relationships with your customers it is vital that the only change they see is improvement. It is essential therefore that operators are trained to use the module. This is one module where it is both practical and desirable to introduce a pilot scheme with a small number of carefully selected customers.

Basic Data

Having decided how you will use Drinks Telesales in conjunction with other modules and the companies you will use, you need to plan and implement the setting up of the additional data required. The main elements you will need to create are:

- Company Profile.
- Operator Profiles.
- Buying Lists.
- Customer Contacts.
- Call Profiles.
- Promotions.
- Reason Codes.

Company Profile

The Drinks Telesales module will make use of information held on the Drinks Sales Order Processing and Drinks Inventory Management company profiles. Additional information is also required.

Defaults for the operation of Drinks Telesales:

- Type of order (telesales, telemarketing, planned delivery).
- Buying list.
- Time of pricing.
- Stock availability check.
- Names to be used in dates, e.g. January, February etc and Monday, Tuesday etc.
- Formatting at the order line entry screen.
- Controlling the logic to decide on the next call to be taken.

Operator Profiles

In many Drinks Telesales operations an operator owns a number of customers so that a rapport may be established. It is possible to define operators to the system so that when they choose to start making calls their list is displayed to them. This can be extended so that a group of operators own a list of customers. The operator can have the authority to make a decision about their work load and the sequence in which calls are to be taken.

Buying Lists

A buying list is the list of items to be discussed with the customer during a call. It can be a short customer specific list, a specific list based on that customer's history, or at the other extreme, the full catalogue of the company's item range. Care must be taken to ensure that most of the items required are on the list,

however, if the catalogue approach is used the preparation of the call list may be protracted.

Customer Contacts

In order that the sales call can be most effective it should be made to a previously agreed, named individual or contact. Text can be added to the basic details to aid the reinforcement of the relationship.

Call Profiles

A call profile is a record that a named individual in your company should telephone a named individual at the customer to discuss a list of items. This call should be made at specified frequencies and at certain times to record details of their requirements either by taking the order quantities or recording the current stock levels. There are obviously a number of points to watch carefully:

- It is not possible to make all the calls between ten and eleven on a Monday. The calls must be smoothed over the week and day as much as possible.
- Calls must be spread evenly between operators over the course of the day.
- All operators should have a number of untimed calls to fill in the blank times.
- A customer can have more than one call profile to discuss different lists, or to allow for call patterns which are not based just on a weekly cycle.

Promotions

In general promotions are to advise or act as a reminder except when an item substitution is made. In this case the promoted item is substituted if the promotion option is taken. Care must be taken when analysing sales of the base item and the substituted item.

Reason Codes

Two character reason codes can be set up to help analyse the reason for failed calls. Care should be taken to restrict the number to less than a dozen to help operators.

Cases/Pallets Conversion

A relationship can be set up between items, cases, pallets, and customers - dictating, for each item/customer pairing, the number of cases per pallet. This overrides the conversion set up on the Item Master File in Drinks Inventory Management, for order taking purposes only.

Initial Data Set-Up

Once the additional data has been set-up you are ready to receive calls and to record orders. In order to make out-going calls it is necessary to run the call list generation procedure. This will build the list of calls to make and create a rapid reference database of the previous orders for the items on the buying list for the required customers. This can be a very large task if there are:

- A large number of customers.
- A large number of lines on the buying lists.
- A large number of orders history required.

In general the production of:

- Customers.
- Buying list lines.
- Number of weeks orders

gives the number of order lines to be built into the history. It is estimated that this could be done at about 25,000 per hour although this will vary depending upon machine size and other activity.

Installing Application Manager PTF's

Application Manager PTF's must be restored and installed as QSECOFR.



Note: To install the Application Manager PTF's the system must be in a minimum state (that is with no users or subsystems / jobs running - this is important)

Use a normal User ID to create the state then sign off and sign on as QSECOFR.

At the first screen, add in library OSLPTP1 (ADDLIB OSLPTP1 *FIRST)

Type in MNGPTF and install the PTF as normal.

Once installed, the library and PTF object can only be removed by QSECOFR. Install this PTF then sign off and sign back in as PTFOwner for subsequent PTF's.

If the above is NOT done, PTFOwner, being inside Application manager, will say the AM PTF is installed when it has not, as PTFOwner is using one of the objects the PTF requires, and the system will work - but will NOT have been updated.

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Chapter 11

Drinks Transport Planning Overview



Introduction

For many companies, transport related costs form a significant portion of the total distribution budget. Increases in efficiency and reductions in costs due to effective planning and management of the transport department can have a real effect on a company's profits.

To optimise the utilisation of transport resources and to optimise load fill, accurate information must be made available to the transport department as early as possible in the delivery cycle. This enables efficient scheduling of deliveries in the short term as well as assisting strategic Drinks Transport Planning in the longer term.

Drinks Transport Planning provides a wide spectrum of facilities for the planning and day-to-day management of transportation.

Together with the appropriate Drinks Distribution modules, it provides the comprehensive solution for companies managing their own fleet and those using third party carriers or a combination of both.

General Concepts

There are four basic ways that deliveries can be achieved:-

- Own transport facility.
- Third party transport.
- Parcel service.
- Collection by customer.

Whichever method, or combination of methods is utilised, the following operational steps may be taken to plan the necessary transport.

- Build loads.
- Assign transport resource.
- Manage movements.
- Consign loads.

Walkthrough

The following steps highlight the way to integrate Sales Order Processing and Drinks Transport Planning to progress an order from its creation right through to its delivery.

- Place an order via Sales Order Processing.
- Allocate Stock (either automatically on order, or using Manual Allocation) via Sales Order Processing.
- Start the Drinks Transport Planning subsystems (so that orders appear in Drinks Transport Planning).
- Create Loads via Transport Planning.

- Build and Maintain Loads (as appropriate) via Drinks Transport Planning Processing to place orders on particular loads.
- Produce Pick Lists either via Drinks Transport Planning (for Bulk Picks) or via Sales Order Processing (for either Bulk or Individual Picks).
- Confirm Assembly by Pick Note or Bulk Pick List via Sales Order Processing.
- Optionally, confirm despatch via Drinks Transport Planning.
- Confirm Delivery by Load via Sales Order Processing.

Building Loads

When loads are being planned, be it for own transport or third party carrier, decisions regarding giving extra discount or promising a delivery date and time, may depend upon access to the current situation of the loads to the customer's area.

When items are planned on a load, a number of factors will contribute to the decision making. These factors fall into three categories:-

- Customer.
- Product.
- Vehicle.

Customer Factors

- Geographical position.
- Limits on vehicles accepted.
- Limits on container types accepted.
- Carriers accepted.
- Days of the week.
- Times of the day.
- Authorisation required for delivery.
- Exclusive deliveries.

Product Factors

- Temperature control.
- Security.

Vehicle Factors

- Maximum capacity (weight, volume, number of containers).
- Driver restrictions (HGV required etc.).
- Availability of vehicle and driver.

There is a requirement for a continuous view of the forward delivery load. The forward view should present the requirements in the appropriate units (weight, volume, number of containers) by:

Transport centre / date / time / route / vehicle type restriction.

Typically, the day before despatch (or same day) the load is finalised, the vehicle and carrier are assigned. The picking and preparation documents can then be issued.

Assign Transport Resource

This procedure obviously differs for companies using their own transport from those using third party. Using third party it is a matter of notifying the carrier of the following:-

- Vehicle requirements.
- Loading date, time and place.
- Drops.
- Required delivery dates and times.
- Weights / volume / number of containers per load.
- Product details.

The rates may then be agreed as part of the confirmation. Typically, this is a specific confirmation of a long standing agreement based on rate tables supplied by the carrier, allowing transport costs to be accurately calculated, accrued and matched to carrier invoices.

For companies using their own transport facilities it is necessary, having determined the requirements, to assign a vehicle and driver. There is a continuous review of the despatch requirements to maximise utilisation and minimise the number of part loads sent out.

Manage Movements

This includes all the tasks necessary to get the goods on the right vehicle at the right time and in the most efficient manner. This includes the production of any necessary paperwork:-

- Picking notes.
- Delivery notes.
- Load sheets.
- Bills of lading (consignment notes).
- Invoices.

The important fact here is that the load is picked as a consignment.

There can be different requirements for confirmation of the different movements, but normally document confirmation with exception is used. In the case of despatch notes, a 'clean' document may be printed prior to the load being consigned to the carrier (particularly when third party carriers are used).

Consign Loads

Once loaded, the final transport details are confirmed prior to despatch. These include:-

- Carrier used.
- Weight/volume/number of containers.

- Date and time of despatch.
- Vehicle and driver details.
- Driver instructions.
- Security details.
- Thermostat settings (for chilled and frozen compartments).

The latter three are particularly relevant for internal transport. Vehicle details normally include registrations, whilst drivers may be identified by a short name or employee number.

Security details may include a tag number, type and colour assigned to the vehicle at despatch.

The driver will normally sign a copy of the bill of lading to confirm acceptance of the load - i.e. the load has been consigned to the carrier.

Relationship to Other Modules

Drinks Transport Planning is a fully standardised Drinks module, and operates under the control of Module Manager.

Drinks Transport Planning is one of the group of advanced module modules which extend the functionality of base modules.

The modules which are pre-requisite for the operation of Drinks Transport Planning are:-

- Drinks Inventory Management.
- Drinks Sales Order Processing.

The module, however, is designed to be used in conjunction with, and enhance, the following modules:-

- Drinks Distribution Requirements Planning (DRP).
- Drinks EDI Application Interface.
- Drinks Telesales.
- Drinks Warehouse Management.
- Accounts Payable.

The DRP interface allows this module to plan transport for depot replenishment as well as for retail deliveries.

The EDI interface allows incoming sales orders received electronically to be made available for Drinks Transport Planning.

The ability to produce a consolidated pick per load (or route or carrier) is provided within Drinks Warehouse Management.

Module Configuration

As with all Drinks modules, Drinks Transport Planning can be operated for a number of companies.

Within each transport company, transport centres may be set up. These are defined by assigning a number of Inventory stockrooms to the transport centre. This allows the transport planner to manage transport on behalf of a number of physical depots.

The transport centre may also be associated with multiple sales companies, allowing the planner to manage transport across commercial companies or divisions within an organisation.

Maintenance of Reference Data

As this is an advanced application module of Drinks, much of the primary data has already been set up as part of the base modules. There is, however, additional information which must be entered in order to obtain the maximum benefit from the application.

There are a number of common features in the way in which this data is maintained. These are:-

- The module makes the maximum use of 'codes' and where they are employed a prompt is always available to assist in selecting the correct one.
- Selection is normally from a displayed list.

Information for the following may be maintained:

- Transport centres.
- Transport planners.
- Vehicle types.
- Routes.
- Route nodes.
- Carriers.
- Carrier rates.
- Areas (zones).
- Delivery profiles.

Additional defaults are also maintained per transport company. The most important of these being the point at which the transport requirements are first created within this module from Sales Order Processing:

1. Immediately after taking orders, *or*
2. On allocating stock, *or*
3. On creating a picking note, *or*
4. On confirmation of delivery.



Note: Drinks is structured to allow the picking of planned loads, which therefore requires that transport defaults are created at allocation stage (option 2).

Transport Centres

A transport centre represents a delivery depot, where transport loads are planned, picked and despatched.

In Drinks this is defined by associating one or more stockrooms with the transport centre in the Drinks Transport Planning module.

These stockrooms may span more than one sales company, allowing multi-company planning of transport for despatches.

A number of control flags are maintained per transport centre which condition the processing of loads:-

Add Orders Immediately to Load

If set to 'yes' and a suitable load is found, i.e. same route, date, transport centre and vehicle type. If sufficient capacity is available, the module automatically adds the order to this load when the transport requirements are created.

In effect, the module builds the loads, provided that the load headers are set-up in advance by the planner, by-passing the load build screen.

If set to 'no' and a suitable load is found then this load number is suggested to the planner when s/he uses the load build screen.

In either case, if no suitable load is found, the suggested load is blank and the planner must create a suitable load and then add the order to this load by using the Build Loads Screen.

Release Loads Before Goods Ready

Transport Planning maintains a running total of orders per load and checks the ready flag within Drinks Sales Order Processing against the order in Transport Planning.



Note: If this flag is set to 'no', the Transport Planning does not allow loads to be released for printing of documentation unless these totals tally.

Print BoL / Load Sheets Immediately After Load Released

Indicates that Load Sheets and Bill of Lading documentation should be printed immediately as loads are released via Load Maintenance, and not via the Print Load option.



Note: Care must be taken with the setting of this field in conjunction with the next, 'Bypass Confirm Despatch', and the use of Load Rating. If neither Rating nor 'Confirm Despatch' are being used, this field should be set to No ('0') - otherwise, when the load is released, the Load Status skips all settings (Rating and Confirmation) through to Awaiting History. A load at this setting is NOT recognised in Drinks Sales Order Processing for picking.

Bypass Confirm Load Despatch

If set to 'no', each load must be confirmed as despatched individually via the screen function.

This date and time stamps the load on departing the depot.

Load Numbers

A sequential range of load numbers may be maintained per transport centre with a user-defined prefix.

Alternatively, a single range may be maintained per transport company.

When creating new loads, the automatically assigned load number may be overtyped.

Transport Planners

For security reasons each user of the Drinks Transport Planning module must be defined as a transport planner.

This allows a user ID to be authorised to one or more transport centres. He/she is allocated a default centre which the module automatically logs them into. The centre description is shown at the top of all screens.

A planner may change to any other transport centre by using the appropriate menu option. He/she is presented with a list of centres that are authorised to them.

The following control flags are maintained per planner:-

Release Load

Set to 'yes' ('1') to allow the planner to release loads for printing of documentation and processing.

Override Capacity Errors

Set to 'yes' ('1') to allow the planner to build loads over the capacities defined to the vehicle type.

Routes and Nodes

Routes must be maintained which represent a journey between two geographical locations, undertaken by at least one carrier (internal or external).

The route is defined by a code, description and optionally an origin and destination.

If specified, the origin and destination must be defined to the module as nodes, i.e. geographical start and end points for the route. The origin and destination will be the same if the journey starts and ends at the same location.

A default carrier and/or ship time and/or vehicle type may be maintained for the route. On creating a load for this route, these defaults will be added to the load.

Bills of lading are normally required for routes covered by external carriers (for internal fleet a load sheet is normally sufficient). The requirement for a BoL, its format and number of copies are maintained per route.



Note: The default route and drop sequence are then associated with delivery points via Delivery Profile Maintenance in this module.

Vehicle Types

These can be (optionally) maintained if capacity checking is required or if analysis by vehicle type is considered important.

A vehicle type code and description is held, together with a maximum weight and/or maximum volume load capacity assigned to it.

If a vehicle type is assigned to a load, the module will output an error if any specified capacity is exceeded.

Carriers

Carriers must be maintained, whether internal or external, by associating a code and name, as well as an address, with each carrier.

The following details may also be maintained for each carrier:

Carrier Type

User defined in the Drinks Inventory Management Descriptions file.

Contact Name

For information only.

Phone & Fax Number

For information only.

- Rating Required
- Rate Method

Rate Code

For external carriers in particular. The parameters to 'rate the load', i.e. calculate transport charges, are specified here.

These may be overridden once a load has been created.

Carrier Routes

If validation of carrier route combinations is required, then the routes each carrier covers are defined here, together with any route specific rating parameters.

Text

Any carrier specific details may be maintained for the transport planners information.

Carrier Rates

If rating of loads, i.e. calculation of carrier freight charges, is to be performed by this module then sets of rates must be maintained (and associated with carriers).

Each set of rates is associated with a code and also an expiry date. Future rates may be set up to be used automatically when current rates expire.

Four methods of rating are available:-

1. A charge based on the load gross weight, maintained in a table.

A surcharge value or percentage may be specified on top of this table value to accommodate unforeseen charges (e.g. government fuel tax increase).

A fixed rate per drop is also applied, with a minimum/maximum drop charge for the whole load.

A minimum load charge is used if the final value is less.

2. The same as for 1, except that the charge is based on the gross weight of each drop.

3. A charge based on the gross weight dropped into each area contained in the load.

For each area the following are maintained:-

- Fixed charge per unit of weight.
- Surcharge value or percentage.
- Drop minimum charge.
- Drop maximum charge.
- Area minimum charge.

4. As for 3, except that the charge per area is not fixed but maintained in a table based on gross weight.



Note: Each of the rating methods may be based on load volume or total number of containers rather than load gross weight.

Areas

Areas may be defined by a code and description to allow the grouping of load drops into areas (or zones).

The area code is then assigned to the appropriate delivery points, allowing load documentation and rating to be split by area.

Delivery Profiles

Each customer delivery point to be considered must have a delivery profile set-up for it.

The following details are maintained:-

- Default Route.
- Default Drop.

Default Carrier

These details are defaulted and recorded against each order for this delivery point.

Area

The area or zone used for splitting the drops for documentation and rating purposes.

Customer Exclusive Load

If set to 'yes', the module will ensure that any load built for this customer will not contain orders for other customers (based on the eight character customer account and three character delivery sequence).

Delivery Confirmation

If set to 'yes', the processing screens will indicate to the planner that this delivery point requires confirmation of a delivery slot at the customer's depot before the load can be released.

Delivery Days / Times

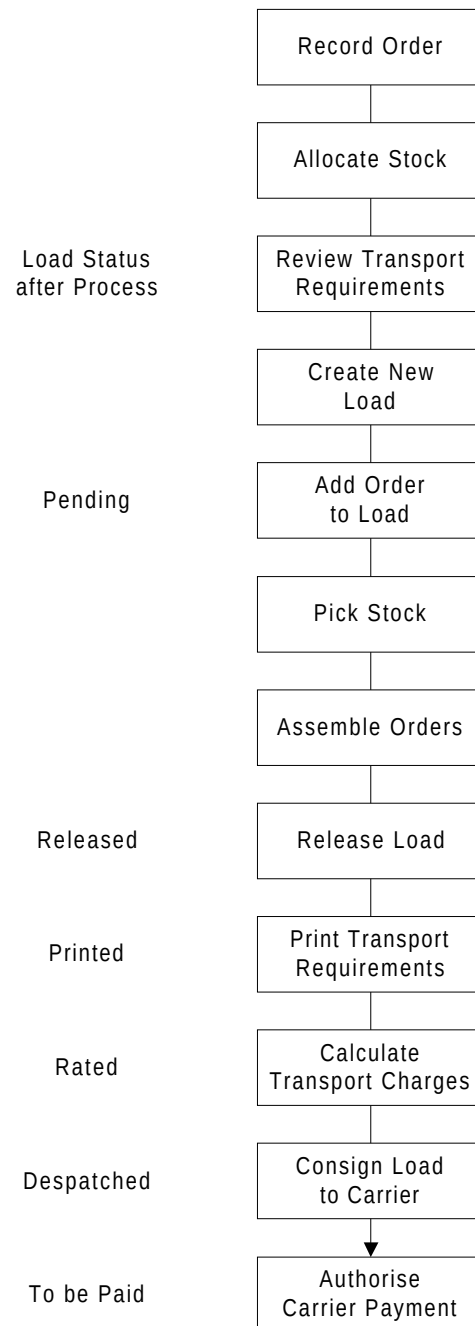
The days of the week and times within each day, when the customer accepts deliveries. (Used for memo purposes only in Drinks Transport Planning). In Drinks Sales Order Processing allocations and Drinks Telesales, entry in these fields will set the delivery date to the next acceptable delivery day in specific circumstances.

Text

Any text relevant to the transport planner may be maintained against the delivery point (for internal purposes only).

Processing

The business processes are best represented by the following flow diagram.



However, the full flexibility of Drinks Transport Planning requires further explanation.

The transport requirements of orders may be transferred from any Drinks Sales Order Processing option immediately after taking the order, on allocation of stock, creation of pick notes or on confirmation of despatch. Any under/over pick

or despatch confirmation will be automatically reflected in Drinks Transport Planning.

The building of loads may be automated, if required, for specific transport centres. The transport planner need only create the pending load headers in advance, and the module will then add the appropriate orders (up to any specified maximum capacities defined for the vehicle type).

The consignment of loads to the carrier may be done manually, via the confirm load despatch screen, or automatically after printing (and rating where appropriate) the load.

The matching and authorisation of carrier invoices is only required where the load has been previously rated.

At the appropriate point, the load is closed and copied to history for future analysis.

Review Transport Requirements

In Drinks Transport Planning, the Load Build Screen presents the planner with all the information necessary to best assemble orders onto loads.

Once an order has been recorded, the following details are made available via the Load Build screen:

- Gross weight.
- Volume.
- Number of containers.
- Sourcing stockroom.
- Default route and drop sequence.
- Default carrier.
- Default vehicle type.
- Ship date and time.
- Customer's name and account.
- Suggested load number (if any).

Easy access is also provided via the following functions to provide more detail for the load planner:

- Pending loads prompt (i.e. loads not yet released).
- Load details enquiry.
- Order enquiry.
- Delivery profile enquiry.

The planner's attention is brought to orders having fixed or special instructions by a flashing asterisk against an order which has external text recorded against it.

Also, an asterisk is displayed against the customer if there are any delivery restrictions.

The order may then be selected to display either the Order Enquiry or Delivery Profile Enquiry respectively.

Create New Load

New load headers may be created individually on line or en masse via a batch function.

The module can automatically generate load numbers or they may be manually controlled.

The minimum amount of information required is a valid route code and ship date.

'Skeleton' load headers may be set up to represent a standard journey and the relevant one copied each time a load is created.

A load header may be created 'in flight' during load building if it has not been set up in advance.

Add Orders to Load

In the Load Build Screen, the planner may select a number of orders to be added to a new or existing load.

If a vehicle type has been specified, then the module will check that its' capacity has not been exceeded.

Facilities are provided to move the order to alternative routes and/or to re-sequence the drops.

On adding orders to loads they are automatically removed as a requirement from the Load Build Screen.

Release Load

Prior to releasing a load any final amendments are made to drops via the Load Maintenance Screen. Also, any driver, vehicle registration or security seal details may be assigned to the load.

On releasing a load, the necessary transport documentation can be printed immediately or the next time a print run is selected.

Once released a load is no longer available for planning. Its status must be returned back to 'pending' by the planner for any details to be amended prior to the load being consigned to the carrier.

Print Transport Documents

Load sheets, and optionally bills of lading, are printed for each released load. These are described in detail in the Documents section of this overview.

Details of the route, drop and load are printed on each pick/despatch note in Drinks Sales Order Processing, and the notes may be generated for a specific carrier, route or load.

If Drinks Warehouse Management is installed, facilities are provided to produce consolidated pick lists for the warehouse personnel to efficiently pick for loading of vehicles.

Calculate Transport Charges

Function is provided within Drinks Transport Planning to calculate the expected carrier charge for selected loads.

The calculations are based on the following parameters:-

- Charge per capacity unit (gross weight, volume, containers).

- Penalty charge (If below specified minimum).
- Charge per drop.
- Minimum drop charge.
- Maximum drop charge.
- Surcharge value/percentage.
- Minimum charge per area.
- Maximum charge per area.
- Minimum charge per load.

The charge rates (per unit or per drop) may be maintained as a fixed amount or in a table based on weight, volume or number of containers.

Four methods of automatic calculation are available (which can each be based on volume or number of containers rather than gross weight):-

- A charge based on the load gross weight, maintained in a table;
- A load charge based on the sum of drop charges which in turn are based on drop gross weight, maintained in a table;
- A charge based on a fixed unit rate multiplied by the gross weight dropped into each area (zone) contained in the load;
- As above except that the charge per area is based on a table of gross weight ranges, rather than a fixed rate.



*Note: Posting of Carrier Charges to Accounts
Payable has to be performed manually.*

Consign Load to Carrier

An option is provided for each load to be confirmed as despatched to ensure that it is date and time stamped on leaving the depot.

This stage may be bypassed allowing the load to be automatically consigned once the load sheet has been printed.

Authorise Carrier Payment

On receiving a carrier invoice it may be matched against the calculated charge for one or more loads.

If there is a discrepancy then only authorised users can authorise the payment.

Enquiries

Enquiries can be grouped into one of three categories:

- Planning.
- Static information.
- Status.

More simply, these can be regarded as:

- What is to be done?
- What are the parameters?
- Where are things?

Planning Enquiries

The 'Outstanding Loads Enquiry' displays all orders yet to be included on loads which satisfy the selection criteria.

This can also provide visibility of the future outstanding requirements for planning of transport, as a range of dates may be selected.

Static Information

Enquiry screens are available for the following:-

- Carrier details.
- Carrier/route restrictions.
- Delivery profile details.
- Delivery time slots.

Status Enquiries

Load enquiry screens are provided as follows:-

- Pending loads (i.e. list of loads not yet released).
- Load details (load header information).
- Load drops (all drop details for selected load).
- Load orders (all orders for selected load).
- Load consignee (consignee details for selected load).
- Load totals (quantity/value totals for selected load).

The 'Loads by Order' enquiry allows the current status of an order to be viewed i.e. which load(s), if any, it is assigned to. Direct access to the above load enquiries is provided by selecting one of these loads.

Reports

As part of the general policy before a report is run, selection and sequencing parameters are available.

In general, standard reports are printed on standard listing with 132 print positions and 6 lines to the inch.

All reports are printed with the procedure or program number in the top left and the page number and date of run in the top right of the report.

Planning / Status Reports

The 'Load Status' report provides a summary per date/route of the total capacity requirements of outstanding orders together with a view of any current loads. From this report, the planner can quickly establish which routes are under/over committed prior to building loads on the screen.

The 'Outstanding Orders' report provides details of all orders yet to be included on loads, sequenced by route/drop within date. This provides the planner with detailed capacity requirements which is of particular use where an over commitment has been identified on the 'Load Status' report.

The 'Load Details' report details all the drops and orders for selected loads.

Documents

Print and reprint facilities are available for two documents:

Load Sheets

These are printed for all released loads. The load sheet provides a list of all drops to be undertaken for each load selected (in ascending or descending drop sequence).

It serves three major purposes:

- as a marshalling document for all despatch notes included on the load sheet, particularly if the notes are from more than one stockroom.
- as an aid to loading the vehicle in the 'best' sequence for dropping.
- to be taken by the driver as an action and confirmation list.

Bills of Lading (BoL)

This is a more formal document than the load sheet and is normally produced only for selected external carriers.

The BoL is printed in any one of four formats:

- One BoL is printed per load
 - One totals line
 - List of despatch note numbers
- One BoL per drop/delivery point
 - One totals line
 - List of despatch note numbers

- One BoL per load
 - One totals line per drop
 - List of despatch note numbers per drop
- One BoL per load
 - One totals line per area
 - List of all despatch note numbers on the load

Pre-requisites

Modules

For the basic operation of the Drinks Transport Planning module, the following modules must be installed:

- System Manager.
- Drinks Inventory Management.
- Drinks Sales Order Processing.

The following additional modules make up the full complement of order capture modules which provide an interface into Drinks Transport Planning:-

- Drinks Distribution Requirements Planning (DRP) - for distribution orders.
- Drinks EDI Application Interface.
- Drinks Telesales.
- Drinks Warehouse Management.

The following financial modules provide for a full level of financial integration:

- Accounts Payable.
- General Ledger.

Data

Items

All items to be processed by Drinks Transport Planning must be defined to an associated sales/inventory stock holding company.

Customers

All delivery points to be processed by Drinks Transport Planning must be defined to an associated sales company.

Drinks Transport Planning Configuration

Data Considerations

The following data entities need to be considered during data set-up:

- Transport descriptions in Inventory.
- Company profile.
- Transport centres.
- Planners.
- Areas.
- Routes and nodes.
- Vehicle types.
- Carriers.
- Items.
- Delivery profiles.

Transport Descriptions File Entries

To enable the normal processing of the modules, there are some entries which need to be defined to the Inventory descriptions file.



Note: The Drinks Transport Planning descriptions file entries are maintained in Drinks Inventory Management under the 'Default Sales Company' defined to the Transport company profile. This enables the definition of a Transport company that need not be an existing Inventory or Sales company.

The following Description Identity Codes must be present:

CODE	DESCRIPTION
@STD	Container Headings
*STD	Container Columns
TPAR	Adjustment reason
TPBL	Bill of lading format
TPCC	Commodity code
TPCT	Carrier type
TPCY	County
TPDC	Capacity
TPIC	Creation of transport req.
TPLS	Load status
TPPM	Freight payment method
TPRM	Rating method
TPSE	Serious errors
RSNC	Reason code
TTYP	Text type
USGC	Text usage code

Low Level Codes



Note: System defined codes affect the operation of the software. They are 'recognised' by the programs. Additional codes or changes to the meaning of the standard codes supplied will require modification of the software.

With the description identity codes, various low level codes must be defined:

@STD = Container Headings (default - Code Length = 1)

There should be seven entries which have the seven categories into which the container summary will show during Build Loads. The actual codes are unimportant, but, for simplicity, use the values 1 through 7.

The description should be an abbreviated 4 character name. The limit field must contain one of the column numbers, 1 through 7.

For example:

Code	Description	Limit	
1	Kegs	1	(Kegs)
2	Case	2	(Cases)
3	Crte	3	(Crates)
4	Clnd	4	(Cylinders)
5	Palt	5	(Pallets)
6	Bott	6	(Bottles)
7	Othr	7	(Other)

***STD = Container Columns (default - Code Length = 2)**

These entries define which of the seven columns in Build Loads are shown by the Container Count. An entry is needed for each container type with the column number, 1 through 7, specified in the Limit field.

The container types are those product item classes 'PCLS', allocated to describe types of containers, and established on the Item Master for each container item.

For example:

Code	Description	Limit	
CA	Case	2	(The Case column on @STD)
CN	Cans	7	(The Other column on @STD)

@xxx = Container Headings for a Transport Centre

***xxx = Container Columns for a Transport Centre**

Using these two description entries, it is possible to specify a different structure of Container Summary in Build Loads for a specific Transport Centre, rather than using the default structure specified by @STD and *STD. The code xxx is a Transport Centre, defined under Transport Centre Maintenance.

Overrides can be specified for any Transport Centre - those not defined in this way, using the default structures.

The format and requirements of these entries is the same as for the default set.



Note: If the Transport Centre is to be used in conjunction with Container Columns in the Build Loads function, the Centre cannot be more than 3 characters long. Please refer to Processing, Build Loads - Order Selection for further details.



Note: Transport Centres can be 4 positions long. This feature is only available for Transport Centre codes of 3 characters or less. A

Transport Centre code of 'STD' will always use the company defaults.

TPBL = Bill of lading format (code length = 2)



Note: This is system defined, but you may change the description.

- 01 - One document per load.
- 02 - Document per drop/delivery point.
- 03 - One document with drop details.
- 04 - One document details by area.

TPDC = Capacity (code length = 1)



Note: This is system defined, but you may change the descriptions.

- 1 = Weight.
- 2 = Volume.
- 3 = Containers.

TPIC = Creation of transport req. (code length = 1)



Note: This is system defined, but you may change the descriptions.

- 1 - Order.
- 2 - Allocation.
- 3 - Picking note create.
- 6 - Confirm assembly.

TPLS = Load status (code length = 2)



Note: This is system defined, but you may change the descriptions.

- 10 - Pending (on hold, being planned).
- 20 - A'printing (awaiting printing or released).
- 30 - Allocated (not used).
- 40 - On pick (not used).
- 50 - Picked (not used).
- 60 - A'rating (awaiting rating).
- 70 - A'COD (awaiting confirmation of load despatch).
- 80 - A'auth.pay (awaiting payment authorisation).
- 90 - Completed.
- 95 - A'hist (awaiting drop to history).
- 99 - Cancelled.

TPRM = Rating method (code length = 2)



Note: This is system defined, but you may change the descriptions.

01 - Load and rate table.

02 - Drop and rate table.

03 - Area.

04 - Area and rate table.

TPSE = Serious errors (code length = 2)



Note: This is system defined, but you may change the descriptions.

01 - Sales order not found.

02 - Pick note header not found.

03 - Item record not found.

04 - Stockroom balance not found.

05 - Route specified not found.

06 - Time out for requirements update.

08 - Details changed after override.

09 - Global route change warning.

10 - Possible capacity problems.

TTYP = Text type (code length = 1)



Note: This is system defined, but you may change the descriptions.

K - Carrier.

C - Customer.

O - Order.

T - Transport load.

USGC = Text usage (code length = 1)



Note: This is system defined, but you may change the descriptions.

I - Internal.

P - Planner.

E - External.

Text type / usage combinations

KI - Internal carrier text.

CP - Planner customer text.

OE - External order text.

TE - External transport load text.

Company Profile

The Transport company profile defines a number of primary defaults. The following issues should be considered:

- When should transport requirements initially be received from Sales Order Processing?
- Should transport load references be created at company or transport centre level?
- What are the significant decimal places for capacity types i.e. weight, volume and number of containers?
- Order planning level i.e. header or line detail. This determines if the stockroom code at header or line level is used to determine the transport centre into which the order line requirements are to be placed.

Transport Centres

Transport centres define a delivery depot that will process order requirements and loads. The following issues should be considered:

- How many transport centres should be defined for the company?
- How many inventory stockrooms should be associated with each centre?
- Should these centres span sales companies i.e. allowing multiple company planning by a single centre?
- What is the default capacity type for the centre (weight, volume or number of containers) to be shown on panels when first displayed?
- Should requirements be assigned to loads on initial creation i.e. bypassing manual load build and allowing the system to automatically add them to suitable loads?
- Should loads be available for release prior to all the orders assigned to the load being flagged as ready?
- Should transport documentation be printed on-line on releasing the load?
- Is confirm of load despatch required?

Planners

All users must have a planner profile defined. The following issues should be considered:

- Should planners be authorised to plan loads across a number of transport centres?
- What level of authorisation should be assigned i.e. release loads, capacity overrides, payment/adjustment authorisation?

Areas

Areas or zones need to be defined for the purpose of rating and documentation. Consideration should be given as to how these areas are to relate to a transport centre i.e. geographical location or a radial pattern.

Routes & Nodes

All routes must be defined to the module together with optional start and end points. The following issues should be considered:

- Are internal or external carriers associated with routes?
- Are vehicle types a factor, i.e. do certain vehicle types run on particular routes?
- Are origins and destinations applicable i.e. movement between two locations rather than a circular trip back to the transport centre?
- Is formal documentation required for each route, i.e. a bill of lading, or is a load sheet sufficient?

Vehicle Types

Vehicle types need only be defined if analysis of transport requirements against vehicle capacities is required. The following issues should be considered:

- Internal and/or external types (as defined by carriers).
- Are discrete weight and volume capacities important (these may be set as infinite requiring manual review/control of load capacities)?

Carrier Types

All carriers must be defined to the module. The following issues should be considered:

- Internal transport or external carrier services.
- Is rating applicable?
- Are there any carrier route and/or rating restrictions?

Carrier Rates

Carrier rates need only be defined if calculation of transport charges is applicable for the business. This is generally only a feature of external transport of goods and rates will generally be communicated on a contract basis via the carrier. The following issues should be considered:

- Which of the four methods are appropriate?
- How many rate codes/effectivity dates are to be defined?



Note: Potentially a large amount of data may be required.

Items

These details are maintained in Drinks Inventory. Tare weights may be maintained against requirements but will not be assigned automatically as the requirement is added to the Transport Planning Module.

Delivery Profiles

All customer and distribution centre delivery points must be defined to the module. The following issues should be considered:

- Route and drop sequence.
- Default carrier.
- Exclusivity of loads to the customer.
- Delivery confirmation and time slots requirements.

Installing Application Manager PTF's

Application Manager PTF's must be restored and installed as QSECOFR.



Note: To install the Application Manager PTF's the system must be in a minimum state (that is with no users or subsystems / jobs running - this is important)

Use a normal User ID to create the state then sign off and sign on as QSECOFR.

At the first screen, add in library OSLPTP1 (ADDLIB OSLPTP1 *FIRST)

Type in MNGPTF and install the PTF as normal.

Once installed, the library and PTF object can only be removed by QSECOFR. Install this PTF then sign off and sign back in as PTFOwner for subsequent PTF's.

If the above is NOT done, PTFOwner, being inside Application manager, will say the AM PTF is installed when it has not, as PTFOwner is using one of the objects the PTF requires, and the system will work - but will NOT have been updated.

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Chapter 12

Drinks Warehousing Overview



Introduction

Drinks Warehousing provides different levels of support for different organisations, or indeed different warehouses within the same organisation. At the simplest level it may be used to provide a tracking system for a limited range of key items. This can be expanded to encompass all aspects of warehouse control and management.

The map of the warehouse can include proximity algorithms which are used as one of the ways of deciding where items should be located.

Picking and marshalling may either be order based or, depending on the organisational needs of the warehouse, can use the characteristics of journey, customer, and due date. Full account is taken of expiry dates, lots or batches, pallet numbers and warehouse organisation when stock is allocated to picking instructions.

The module is designed to fit into the operational environment of a warehouse, in that the minimum of data entry is required to operate it. Lists of tasks are displayed and all that is normally required is simple confirmation. The structure of the database simplifies the interface to technical advances in Drinks Warehousing such as hand-held terminals.

Relationships to Other Modules

Drinks Warehousing is a fully standardised module. It is one of the group of Advanced Application Modules which extend the functionality of Base Application Modules.

The only module which is a pre-requisite for the operation of Drinks Warehousing is Drinks Inventory Management.

The module, however, is designed to be used in conjunction with, and enhance the following modules:

- Drinks Sales Order Processing.
- Drinks Transport Planning.
- Drinks Purchase Management.
- Production Definition Management.
- Production Order Control.
- Production Schedule Control.

When Drinks Warehousing is installed and a stockroom has been fully activated as a warehouse, links are switched on between the operational modules and the warehouse that provides the additional location management and control. Thus, items received against a purchase order can automatically have pallet labels printed that include put-away instructions. Despatches to be made for sales orders recorded by the Drinks Sales Order Processing module and issues of inputs to production orders and schedules can be picked, marshalled and despatched using the enhanced facilities of Drinks Warehousing. Receipts from production orders and schedules can be made into a warehouse and put-away routines are invoked.

Module Configuration

As with all modules, Drinks Warehousing can be operated for a number of companies, the characteristics of each being maintained on control files. Drinks Warehousing uses the control data stored for Drinks Inventory Management. The precise control in this module, however, is required at the level of the Warehouse because it will be appropriate to have different policies in different parts of the organisation. When the module is installed, a warehouse may be fully configured before it is activated. This enables the proper degree of preparation and checking to take place prior to the start of full operation.

The policies which can be controlled at each warehouse are:

- The module to give instructions or to record actions.
- Check digits to be used for confirmation of actions.
- Stock rotation.
- The sequence in which action lists are produced.

All actions in the operational modules resulting in a Drinks Inventory receipt will cause the item to be automatically located in the receiving location. Similarly, when picking is required, the module will recommend that stock for a number of items from certain locations should be moved to the marshalling location prior to issue. Any locations which have been set up in the warehouse may be defined as these two locations. However, it is very strongly recommended that warehouse areas be set up so that each contains a single location which has a Location Code which is the 'normal' name for receiving and marshalling in the warehouse. These areas can be set up to satisfy the requirements of each individual warehouse.

Accuracy and discipline are the fundamentals of the Drinks Warehousing operation. It is therefore vital that, if unexpected actions are necessary, the supervisor is notified immediately. If errors are detected by the module, a message can be directed instantly to a supervisor or to a terminal if the supervisor is not currently signed on.

Each item which is managed by Drinks Warehousing requires an item / warehouse profile in order to define its rules and characteristics. Defaults can be set up for the warehouse to minimise the amount of data entry required during the maintenance of these profiles.

A user of Drinks Warehousing will normally be at a particular site and therefore it is possible to define a default warehouse. This simplifies the day-to-day operational procedures particularly for recording transactions and making enquiries.

Maintenance of Reference Data

As this is an Advanced Application Module, much of the primary data has already been set up as part of the base modules. There is, however, additional information which must be entered in order to obtain the maximum benefit from the module.

There are a number of common features to aid the maintenance of the data, these are:

- The standard item and descriptions search routines have been adopted.
- The module makes the minimum use of 'codes' and where they are employed a prompt is always available to assist in selecting the correct one.
- Selection is normally from a displayed list.

Information for the following may be maintained:

- Warehouse profiles.
- Area profiles and dimensions.
- Item/warehouse profiles.
- Packaging types.
- Location types.
- Warehouse map.
- Action rules.
- Resources.
- Check digits.
- List profiles.

Warehouse Profile

The warehouse profile is used for five distinct functions. Firstly, to set up the policies for the warehouse, e.g. should check digits be used for confirmation. Secondly, to set up the special areas for receiving and marshalling. Thirdly, to define the target for any error messages produced by the module, such as no location being suggested for the picking of stock based on the rules defined. Fourthly, to define defaults that are used in the item/warehouse profiles. These defaults are set to save time when defining the item/warehouse profiles. Finally, to activate or de-activate the warehouse.

Area Profiles and Dimensions

The purpose of setting up a warehouse is to record and manage the locations and quantities of items stored within that warehouse. Before this can be done it is necessary to define the shape and structure of the warehouse to the module.

The module treats the warehouse as a series of areas, each of which is divided into a number of locations. For example, to reflect the physical nature of a warehouse you could define three areas, one called 'Floor' which is used for the receiving and marshalling locations, another called 'Main Store' which represents

most of the aisles, rows and bays in the warehouse and another called 'Picking' which represents the pick locations.

Each area is defined using up to four dimensions, such as aisle, bay, row, etc.. The dimensions are used to build up the code that identifies individual locations. The code for each dimension may be up to six characters in length, but the final location code (the concatenation of all the dimension codes) may not exceed twelve characters.

Item / Warehouse Profile

Each item to be kept in a warehouse must be associated with a location. If the module is to be used effectively, it will make recommendations regarding where items will be put, when and from where replenishment should take place, and from where items should be picked. The management of an item will vary between warehouses in the same company. It is necessary to define to the module the parameters for the items as held in each warehouse. The information and parameters are held under five headings.

Packaging

This relates the item in inventory stockroom issue units of measure to the pack types used in the warehouse. It also defines the basis of stock rotation.

Fixed Locations

Despite the many advantages of 'random' locations there are some items which are best kept in fixed locations.

Put-Away

This defines the processing steps to be used by the module when making recommendations as to where an item should be put. This includes trying the picking locations, using the item location rule and using the area location rule.

Commit

This defines the processing steps taken by the module when making recommendations of from where an item should be picked. These steps include the consideration of stock rotation, picking location, fixed locations, item and area rules.

Pick Location

Control data for the picking location can be set up including replenishment trigger and the replenishment quantity. It is also possible to define the maximum, in a single pick, to be taken from this location before the pick is made direct from bulk.

Pack Types

Many of the movements in a warehouse are performed using pallets or containers of some kind. These can be defined to the module and then the relationship between the pack and item can be created. A default pack type must be set up for each item to obviate the necessity to enter a pack type for each movement.

Location Types

Depending on the purpose of the warehouse there will be a number of types of locations. The size, shape, and use of these will be chosen to meet particular

storage requirements including the number and distribution of pack types. This information is used by the module, together with the number of packs per location, to decide whether or not a particular receipt should be put away in a location.

When the location types have been established, their distribution throughout the warehouse areas can be defined. For example, there may be standard pallet racking which will accept all standard pallets, picking locations which are equivalent to one and a half pallets and locations on the top of the racks which are used to store rolls of packing material and cardboard boxes.

In addition to these characteristics it is possible to remove locations from use by tagging them as void, and to limit their use to single-item occupancy or to specify multi-item occupancy as being allowed.

Warehouse Map

The warehouse map assigns location types to locations. This determines the characteristics of the locations.

For example, the locations within an area set-up called 'Main Store' can be set to have a location type of 'Standard Pallet Racking' which limits the locations to being capable of storing only one pallet at a time.

Location Rules

When a warehouse movement takes place it should only ever be done so as a result of an instruction. Before the instruction is issued, a decision is made as to which is the 'best' location to be used. The 'best' location will depend upon a number of factors such as:

- The item itself.
- How it is packed.
- Does it require special conditions?
- Is the item picked from a picking location?
- Can mixed 'lots' be put in the same location?
- Must the receiving area be cleared quickly?

The warehouse operator uses considerable experience to 'unconsciously' make such decisions. It is possible to create rules in the module that, to some extent, mimic these decisions. Combinations of the following can be set up to control the recommendations for put-away, pick and replenish.

- Use the pick location.
- Use the fixed locations.
- Use an item rule. An item rule is intended to reproduce the kind of review that would be done by line-of-sight checks. For example, if a replenishment is to be performed to the picking location from the nearest full pallet or, conversely, if a pallet is to be stored as close to the pick location as possible. Creating the rule involves defining a series of locations to be tested in relation to the pick location.
- Use an area rule. This rule is intended to review a large number of locations to answer such questions as "Find the first not-full location in this part of the

warehouse which is closest to the receiving bay”, or “Select randomly a not-full location.” This type of rule may make use of the proximity data set up for an area or the randomising algorithm.

- Use stock rotation dates. These dates include expiry and arrival date.

Obviously different types of moves are conditioned by different factors. For example, stock rotation is used for picking and replenishment but not for putting away.

Resources

Resources relate to the warehouse equipment, such as trolleys and fork-lift trucks. A resource can be defined to the system and then related to pack types within a location type. For example, a resource of ‘trolley’ could be related to a pack type of ‘pallet’ in a location type of ‘floor’; whereas the resource of ‘fork lift truck’ would be related to the pack type of ‘pallet’ if the location type was ‘standard racking’ as the location may not be at ground level.

Check Digits

Check Digits or Return Codes can be used within the module to ensure that the warehouse staff have visited the defined location where the check digit is displayed. The confirmation of the action can then be by the entry of the return code or check digit. In the case of an intra-warehouse movement, both check digits must be entered. Check digit usage is controlled as follows:

- The use of check digits is requested for the warehouse.
- A set of default check digits can be set up for the warehouse.
- This may be overridden for each or for all areas.
- If no defaults are set up but check digits have been requested, modulus 23 is used as a base to generate digits.

Processing

Most of the work in a warehouse can be divided into three types of tasks:

- Putting away items.
- Moving items to optimise storage, picking and despatching.
- Picking and despatching.

One of the main functions of Drinks Warehousing is to make recommendations for each of the three tasks, and then produce instruction lists on paper and on screen. Once these tasks have been completed, they can be confirmed either by the entry of a '1' against the action, or, if check digits are being used, the entry of the appropriate digits. If check digits are not required, actions can be set to be confirmed by default. This option will still allow you to override those actions.

Actions may be changed to indicate that different locations were used when carrying out the instructions. This is necessary to keep the module up to date with what is happening within the warehouse.

In order to manage computer resources, some of the processing can be carried out in a background subsystem or may be run in batches instead of being performed interactively. Running jobs in batches can be especially useful for printing, where special stationery for work planning is required.

Receiving and Putting Away

There are a number of steps in recording the receipt of an item and putting it away within the warehouse. These steps are either the recording of specific actions or the processing and making of recommendations by the module. The recording of all external events is done by using interactive procedures. In order to manage the computer resources, some of the processing is carried out in a "continually processing sub-system". This waits for the next instructions and then carries them out. As a third possibility, work can be performed in small batches. This is particularly true where printing is involved and special stationery for work planning is required. In some instances you are provided with a choice in the way processing is performed. The steps involved with receiving and putting away are as follows:

Drinks Inventory Receipt

This is recorded in one of the operational modules of , i.e. Drinks Purchase Management, Drinks Inventory Management, Production or Drinks Sales Order Processing. These actions are interactive procedures. The result is an increase in the inventory balance at the stockroom. This must be reflected as an increase in the warehouse. The continually processing sub-system moves the item into the location denoted as RECEIVING. The warehouse and inventory are now in balance. No explicit additional action is required in the operational module to achieve the second posting. However, as Drinks Warehousing can operate in multiple packaging types, an opportunity is provided to confirm or change the pack type at the time the receipt is made into a warehouse.

The receiving sub-system performs the following functions:

- Moves the item into the receiving location.
- Determines the number of packs.
- Identifies the rules for putting the item away.
- Makes a sufficient number of recommendations to put the item away into the warehouse.
- One recommendation is produced for each unique combination of Item/lot/pack type and location.

The item is now planned out of receiving and planned into the locations.

Printing Documents

Before an action can be confirmed, an instruction must have been generated by the module. If the item is packed such that pallet labels have been requested, they will be produced; if not a list will be printed. In order to provide the proper control, these are only printed in the warehouse when requested.

Confirmation of the Action

As with all recording of actions, this procedure is interactive. There is an obvious advantage in this recording being as close to real-time processing as possible. Confirmation of the put-away can either be by entry of a single character or by a check digit which can only be found by visiting the location.

In order to guarantee the best possible response times while recording put-away transactions, the update of the database may be moved into a continuously updating sub-system. Update is normally complete within seconds of entry being finished.

Intra-Warehouse Move

Movements inside the warehouse or intra-warehouse movements are performed to improve the organisation of items in order to reduce work at more critical times.

It is necessary not only to be able to record that a move is required, but also that a move has been done. A move may be occasioned by a number of factors. The most common is letting down from bulk to a picking area. At times it may be decided to refurbish part of the warehouse which may result in the movement of items out of a specific part of the warehouse. Finally, the need for action may be so immediate that the action to relocate is taken and then reported to the module after the event. In a well planned warehouse such events will be rare.

In common with the other two types of actions, putting away and picking, a list of instructions is produced which you can see on a screen and confirm or change.

A distinction is drawn between movements generated by the module for replenishment and those manually requested. These may be produced on separate lists in order to assign the proper priority for the different actions. When confirmation is being performed, different overrides are appropriate for the different moves. For example, if a replenishment of a picking location has been requested by the module, it is not possible to change the item or the 'move to' location because the intention of the instruction is to replenish a fixed picking location.

Picking and Despatching

The initial allocation of stock to sales orders takes place in the Drinks Sales Order Processing or Production Control & Costing modules. This allocation is done against the available stock figure in the nominated stockroom but does not identify in which location the stock will be found to meet that particular requirement. This is performed in Drinks Warehousing. The particular location being decided upon by reviewing such factors as:

- The quantity to despatch.
- Stock rotation.
- Physical proximity of location.
- The practicality of picking a number of order lines together

The picking and despatching cycle has the following events:

- Request Picking Lists.
- Confirm Pick.
- Confirm Despatch or Confirm Issue.

Request Picking Lists

This is performed by Drinks Warehousing and considers requests to despatch generated from the Drinks Sales Order Processing module or requests to issue generated from the Production Control & Costing module. A series of tasks are performed which result in the printing of the documents necessary to pick and despatch the items. The first task sets up the parameters which control the others which are to:

- Select a range or group of orders.
- Sequence and combine them.
- Decide from which locations the stock should be picked.
- Print a pick list organised to suit the warehouse.
- Print appropriate marshalling lists which cross-reference picking lists and despatch or issue notes.
- Print the despatch/issue notes.



Note: Kit parent and non-stock items are not committed and do not print on the warehouse pick list.

Confirm Pick

This is essentially similar to confirmation of all the warehouse actions and can be performed by entering either the check digit or return code. It is possible to override the module instruction by changing both the location and the quantity. This will result in an error being recorded. The result of the confirmation is to transfer the stock to the marshalling location.

Confirm Assembly

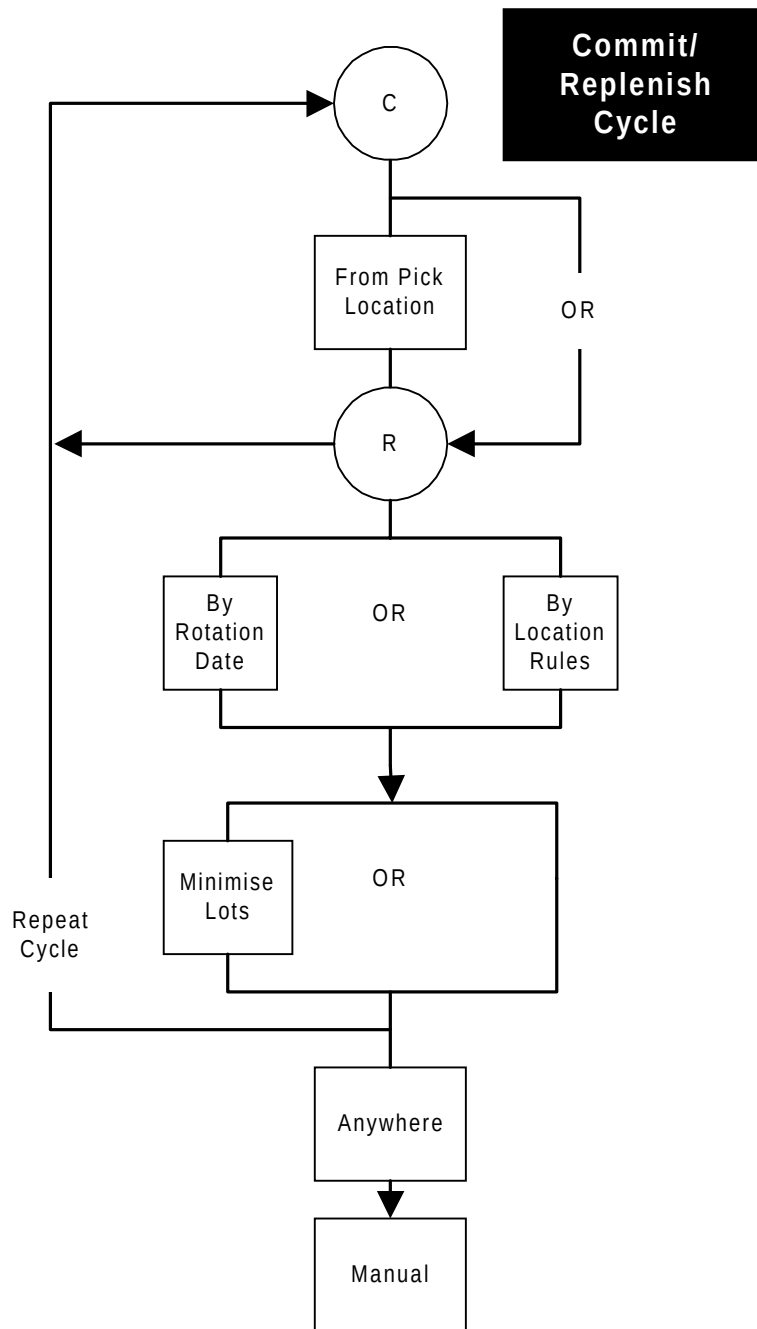
Confirmation of assembly may be performed from the sales marshalling location. This confirmation is carried out at order level using the standard picking note/despatch note as produced from the Drinks Sales Order Processing module.

Reports are available from the module to aid the marshalling of complex loads which link picking lists and despatch/issue notes. If the despatch has taken place as intended, this may be confirmed using a single function key. Provision is made for the addition of delivery and freight charges.

Confirm Issue

From the production marshalling location, confirmation of issue may be performed. This confirmation is carried out at order level using the standard shop documentation as produced from the Production Control & Costing module.

Reports are available from the module to aid the marshalling of complex loads which link picking lists and despatch/issue notes. If the issue has taken place as intended, it may be confirmed using a single function key.



The process is performed for each commit action. A commit action is at the level of Item, lot, Stock rotation date, pack type or pack number.

Enquiries

Enquiries can be grouped into one of three categories.

- Status.
- Action Lists.
- Movements.

More simply, these can be regarded as - Where are things? What is to be done, and, What has happened?

Status

The status enquiries either start from examining what is in a location or range of locations, or in which location an item is stored. Whenever a number of locations are to be displayed it may be appropriate not only to select them but also to sequence them. The most obvious sequence is the Location Code and this will be the one which is normally used; however, if empty locations are being displayed, it may be appropriate to list them by an Area or Item Rule. In this way manual decisions can be made on the same sort of basis as module decisions.

Whichever entry is chosen into the status displays, it is possible to examine:

- Item/Location Details.
- Location Contents.
- Location Details.

Action Lists

There are three types of action lists:

- Put Away.
- Move.
- Pick.

The lists which have not been finished are displayed. The details of despatch instructions sent but not yet actioned are available for enquiry with direct access to the full order enquiry within the Drinks Sales Order Processing module.

Movements

This class of enquiry includes the warehouse movements and the reported error conditions. If an action is requested but not then confirmed as instructed, an error record is written. These can be displayed. Multiple selection criteria are provided for both movements and errors enquiries.

Reports

As part of the general policy of modules selection and sequencing parameters are available before a report is run. In general, standard reports are printed on standard listing paper with 132 print positions and 6 lines to the inch.

All reports are printed with the procedure or program number in the top left, and the page number, date and time to the top right. As with enquiries, the reports can be grouped into Status, Actions and Movements.

Overall Implementation Considerations

It is of vital importance to the success of any software implementation that certain issues are considered before detailed steps are undertaken. In case of Drinks Warehousing these issues are:

- How Drinks Warehousing and other Modules should be used.
- How many warehouses should be set up.

Implementation Procedure

There are two possible implementation procedures that could apply:

- Drinks Warehousing with Drinks Inventory Management already installed.
- Drinks Warehousing with Drinks Inventory Management newly installed.

The appropriate procedure should be used as a guide.

It is strongly advised that whichever procedure is used a project plan is followed in order that the necessary data can be captured and recorded in advance of the entry of the stock count.

The basic steps for a successful implementation are:

- Master file data collection and input.
- Work load organisation.
- Suspend processing of stock.
- Initial date take-on/reconciliation.
- Resume processing of stock.

With Drinks Inventory Management already Installed

It is assumed that users are familiar with Drinks Inventory Management.

Master File Data

The data required to make the Drinks Warehousing Module functional must be defined. The amount of effort required will depend upon the number of items, locations, pack and location type details which need to be defined.

Work Load Organisation

It is essential that during the stock count exercise and the early stages of processing with the Drinks Warehousing module that the movement of stock is controlled. To help achieve this it is advisable to minimise the activities for receiving and issuing stock.

Receipts

Any receipts which have been booked into stock but have not been put away should be reviewed. The possible actions that can be performed for each receipt are:

- Put the items away, thus reducing the items at the receiving area to those not yet booked into stock.
- If the receipts were made through Purchase Management the items could be transferred back to either goods inwards or inspection. The items would then be received into stock after the activation of the warehouse.
- Leave the items at the receiving location. The stock should be recorded at Data Take-on and then moved manually after the activation of the Warehouse.

Issues

All requests for issuing stock, e.g. order despatch, should be processed such that the items to be despatched have been picked and moved to the Marshalling location. Obviously, it would make processing simpler if the items were despatched and the actions confirmed.

Leaving items at the Marshalling locations means that the full details required for Confirmation of Despatch must be entered.

Suspend Processing of Stock

The movement of stock into, around and out of the warehouse must be suspended whilst the stock count for Data Take-on is performed and reconciled.

From this point until the warehouse is activated, the processing of Drinks Inventory, Drinks Purchasing, Production and Drinks Sales Order Processing must be suspended. Outstanding transactions must be completed.

Initial Data Take-On / Reconciliation

A full stock count is required to include every item and every location in the Warehouse. The details are entered using the Data Take-On data entry programs.

The count should be reconciled to the Drinks Inventory lot and stockroom balances, discrepancies are shown on the report. Any variances should be verified. Once the count is cleared as correct, the location details should be updated using the Reconciliation with Update option. This will also make appropriate adjustments to the Drinks Inventory balances.

Resume Processing of Stock

The warehouse must be activated. This is done by taking the **F14** function key from the Drinks Warehouse Profile Maintenance option.

Transaction processing can be resumed in all areas of the warehouse. Transactions can be recorded in the modules previously suspended.

Receipts and issues are now subject to the control of the Drinks Warehousing Module.

With Drinks Inventory Management newly Installed

Appropriate training needs to be undertaken to enable users to understand both the Inventory and Drinks Warehousing Modules.

Master File Data Collection and Input

The data required to make both Drinks Inventory and Drinks Warehousing functional must be defined. Care must be taken to ensure that dependencies are entered in the appropriate order. The amount of effort required will depend upon the number of items, location, pack and location type details that need to be defined.

Work Load Organisation

It is essential that during the stock count exercise and the early stages of processing with the Drinks Warehousing module the movement of stock is controlled.

Receipts

Items that are in the receiving area should be reviewed. The possible actions that can be performed are:

- Put the items away before the stock count.
- Record, at data take-on, the items in the receiving area. Manual moves will be required after the activation of the warehouse.
- Leave the items at the receiving location, do not record the stock during data take-on. The items are received after activation of the warehouse.

Obviously, the status of stock at the receiving location must reflect the status of stock received into Inventory.

Issues

Items to be despatched should be processed through to the marshalling area. Obviously, the stock status must reflect the requests for despatch in other modules.

It is better to start with as few incomplete despatches as possible.

Suspend Processing of Stock

The movement of stock must be suspended whilst the stock count for Data Take-on is performed and reconciled.

Movement of stock can be resumed after the activation of the warehouse.

Initial Data Take-On / Reconciliation

A full stock count is required to include every item and location in the warehouse. The details can either be entered through the Data Take-On data entry programs or by recording Physical Stock Adjustments in Drinks Inventory.

If Data Take-On is used Reconciliation with Update will set the Drinks Inventory balances.

Resume Processing of Stock

The warehouse must be activated. This is done by taking the appropriate function key from the Warehouse Profile Maintenance option.

Transaction processing can be resumed in the warehouse.

Receipts and issues are now subject to the control of the Drinks Warehousing module.

Installing Application Manager PTF's

Application Manager PTF's must be restored and installed as QSECOFR.



Note: To install the Application Manager PTF's the system must be in a minimum state (that is with no users or subsystems / jobs running - this is important)

Use a normal User ID to create the state then sign off and sign on as QSECOFR.

At the first screen, add in library OSLPTP1 (ADDLIB OSLPTP1 *FIRST)

Type in MNGPTF and install the PTF as normal.

Once installed, the library and PTF object can only be removed by QSECOFR. Install this PTF then sign off and sign back in as PTFOwner for subsequent PTF's.

If the above is NOT done, PTFOwner, being inside Application manager, will say the AM PTF is installed when it has not, as PTFOwner is using one of the objects the PTF requires, and the system will work - but will NOT have been updated.